Together at the End of the World

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/31439690.

Rating:
Explicit

Archive Warning:
Graphic Depictions Of Violence

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Scorpia (She-Ra), Entrapta (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Hordak (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Princess Alliance (She-Ra) - Character, Horde Soldiers (She-Ra), Original Characters, Razz (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
catradora, Slow Burn, Alternate Story, First Kiss, First Time, Smut, Battlefields, Catra's POV, POV First Person, Blood and Injury, Minor Character Death, Scars, reflections of the past, Healing, promise a happy ending, Happy Ending, Fires, Burns, Not Overally Graphic but Warning Nessecary, Fluff and Smut, Character Death, Adora (She-Ra) Needs a Hug, Catra (She-Ra) Needs a Hug, Explicit Sexual Content, Panic Attacks, Nightmares, descriptions of physical abuse, Friends to Lovers

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Together at the End of the World

by Midnight_Owl2

Summary

What if Adora never found the Sword of Protection? What if Adora and Carta remained together in the Horde and worked their way to the top like they always promised? How would their story play out? What challenges lie ahead? Will Catra ever truly be able to tell Adora about her feeling for her?

Follow this journey written from Catra's POV as both individuals face the truth of the Hordes' destruction as well as coming to terms with their feelings for one another.

Notes

Hi everyone. This is my first ever fan fic. It's been in the works since last year. Would have completed it sooner but Uni and work got in the way. I'm so happy to finally share it with you all. I advise reading the tags, which I'll add to with each new chapter, before reading this story. If you are uncomfortable with any of them then please don't not read or read at your own risk. The story will be updated every Monday & Friday. Please let me know what you think in the comments. Hope you enjoy. :)

Catra's Unspoken Truth

Chapter Summary

Adora gets promoted.

Their final night together plays out differently compared to what happens in the series.

Catra makes a promise.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Come on Catra. This is what I've been working for my entire life. I was hoping you could be… I don't know… happy for me."

Happy for her, of course I'm happy for her. It's not that I not happy for her, it's just I never imagined that Shadow Weaver would go as far as stopping me from joining Adora on her first mission, *our first mission*; we're a team. To be fair I shouldn't have really expected anything less, not like that witch ever liked me and I know for a fact that she will do anything to stop Adora and I from… *well that doesn't matter.*

"Ugh, whatever. It's not like I even care. I just want to get out of this dump at some point before I die of boredom. I wonder what's even outside the Fright Zone anyway?"

I've haven't been outside of this prison in what feels like forever. I vaguely remember how I ended up here, but I clearly remember what happened after. I'm lucky Adora found me after Shadow Weaver discarded me like I was some sort of beast; *her words not mine*! I owe my life to Adora, she's always been there for me, like we always promised.

Seriously though I need to blow something up, take all my frustrations out on something as it's not safe to admit to Adora

how feel about her… *how I've always felt about her*. It's becoming increasingly harder to not sneak a peek at her in the showers… not that they offer much privacy anyway. *This is the Horde, what do you expect?* Her soft skin, her toned muscles, her immaculate figure, her gorgeous flow of long blonde hair that I could just run my claws through… Her eyes amaze me, those bright-blue oceans are mesmerizing. She's the definition of beautiful.

This doesn't even consider how her smile and laugh makes me feel. Her laugh creates a strange feeling in my body, almost as if something is crawling from my stomach up to my chest, causing my heart to beat slightly faster. '*It must be some sort of sickness'* I keep telling myself, even though I know there is something more to it. Downside to this is I can't tell her that as then she'll think I'm weak.

They all think I'm weak… they're wrong, they're all wrong!

It's embarrassing to admit but I'd do anything to hear her laugh, but I know for a fact that if Shadow Weaver caught me trying to make Adora happy she would... the thought of the punishment sends a chill down my spine. I don't want to have to shut Adora out again because of my feelings for her. It was too much last time when she asked how I got those *'mysterious'* red marks around my neck. No one really noticed thanks to my fur but Adora noticed, she always notices. It was the first time in many years I silently cried myself to sleep, wanting nothing more than to be held in Adora's arms. I knew should have done if I asked but we couldn't risk it, *not after last time.*

All I want to do is be able to tell Adora about my feelings for her without having to fear that my next words to her may be my last. The thought of losing her stops me everytime I try to tell her. That's why I started to shut off all emotions, emotions make you weak. '*Act like someone you're not, that will make you strong'* is what we've always been taught. Reminding myself that used to work but not anymore. As I've got older my feelings for Adora have become stronger, stronger to the point where I feel like I might explode. That would be a nightmare, not to mention the

consequences that would follow. I'm not even sure if Adora feels the same way about me, I don't want to risk our friendship over some stupid crush. Blowing something up will help me to forget it all, even if it is just for a moment. But of course, that bitch has to interfere, or so I thought…

"Well I was going to take us out on a skiff but the one I got the keys for is broke and all the others are already out. I do have a plan for getting you to Thaymor with me… that's if you're interested?"

Well that's got my attention.

"Really, you have an idea?"

"Catra."

"Alright I'm listening".

I am listening but I quickly found myself lost with my thoughts thanks to her mesmerizing blue eyes, her wonderful smile and those gorgeous, beautiful lips that I would love to feel against mine. *How could someone not get distracted when the sight before you is as attractive as this?*

"Catra… CATRA! Are you even listening to me?"

Immediately I snap back to reality. "Yes *Force Captain*" I say sarcastically, causing Adora to roll her eyes. Her smile soon fades and is replaced with a look of concern.

"Are you okay? You seemed a bit distracted?"

Oh shit, she noticed, quick think… "Yeah just got a bit bored of you waffling on. Can we just skip ahead to the actual plan already? How are you even going to get me into Thaymor without being noticed?"

"Well if you were listening you would know." Adora responds with a tiny smirk creeping up the side of her lips. *Why do I find that*

attractive?

"Come on Catra, do you want to conquer Thaymor together or not?"

I roll my eyes and lean my back over the rails edge, waiting for her to continue. Adora discusses how she has been told she'll be in lead tanker - *Of course she would be, this is her mission after all* – My mission is to hide behind the pipe's and storage area insider the tank. Once entering the Whispering Wood I'll be able to come out of my hiding spot. Adora and I will hold off our initial attack before helping the remaining soldiers take down the rebellion fortress.

"It's getting dark. We should probably be heading back to the barracks before we get caught."

Is it really that late already? I don't want this night to end. Well, I guess time really does fly when you're having fun. Or in my case, time flies when you're with the one you secretly love.

Sadly, I know tonight is going to be different. As a Force Captain, Adora now has her own quarters, which means for the first time since being a young age we'll be separated. Not that it bothers me… okay maybe it does but only a little bit. It's harder to sleep when she's not around. The other cadets take any opportunity to strike when she's not around. I don't need Adora to protect me it just makes it easier to get some shut eye knowing that no-one dares try and pull my tail whilst she's around… it's very sensitive, *another weakness*.

Adora picks up that something's bothering me. I can tell by the way she's looking at me with that sweet, innocent smile and the way her eyebrows lift with concern. I don't know how she reads me so well. Maybe it's the way my fur bristles, or the way my tail flicks, or the way my ears twitch. Even when my movements are hardly noticeable, she can always tell how I'm feeling. Adora understands me… *she always has*. It's what makes me love her more, she's just… *Adora.*

"You know my new quarters won't be ready until tomorrow. Shadow Weaver said something about making a *'few adjustments'*. Not sure what she said the adjustments are for but at least we'll still be together tonight."

Adora smiles and reaches her hand out towards me to take. I'm hesitant at first, but it's only us two up here, we can get away with anything. I should really take her hand but I've got a better idea… *lets drag this night out a little longer.* Instead of taking her hand I pounce onto her, knowing us both to the ground. I start to laugh as Adora ungracefully blows a piece of hair that has fallen out of her hair poof out of her eyes.

"Race you back?"

"You're on!" Adora laughs as I bounce of her, immediately moving to run on all fours. Adora soon follows after.

"Hey that's cheating!" I hear her call but I'm too far ahead to even care.

There's no way she was going to win, I'm the more agile person between the two of us. Being a magicat has its benefits. Its moments like this when I never want these nights to end.

--

We've been in our bunk for about thirty minutes now. I'm in my usual spot at Adora's feet; Adora is at the top of the bunk, lying on her side with her head resting on her pillow. The *'sleeping at her feet'* thing started a very long time ago. Adora started having serious nightmares and wouldn't stop sleep fighting. I'd sneak down from my bunk above hers to try and wake her up. It often ended up with her accidentally punching me as a result of being startled from her sleep. *Got to admit Adora can give a firm punch.* I soon learned that if I was going to wake her up I would have to

use my quick reflexes to either dodge or catch her hand before she could strike a blow to my face. Adora would never tell me how bad her nightmares were but she never need to. Her water eye and trembling body told me everything I need to know. I stayed by her side every time they occurred, which was most nights. We silently agreed that it would be easier for me to stay near her all night, you know… to protect her.

I'll never tell Adora but being near her makes me feel at ease. When we're together I feel like I can forget about all the shit that's going on in our lives. In the darkest days/nights, she's the light that guides me through it all, allowing me to hope and wish that someday things will get better… for ***both of us***.

When we returned to the barracks all of the other cadets were asleep meaning our arrival was unnoticed. Adora usually found sleep within five minutes of crashing her head on her pillow and I was never too far behind.

Tonight is different.

There's a chill in the air. Not a chill that you get due to cold weather, more like a chill of uncertainty and fear. Adora must be able to feel it too, I can feel her shaking underneath her blanket. I can't help but feel for sorry for her, she's under so much pressure. Not only is she expected to lead a team to conquer Thaymor but she is now the youngest Force Captain in the Horde entirety of the Hordes' history. Everyone's going to look up to her even though most of us are the same age as her.

I have to do something.

I look around to make sure that everyone is actually asleep. Some of the other cadets are very good at faking. Once I'm certain that only Adora and I are awake, I silently crawl up to the top of the bunk and lay down next. Adora looks startled…

"Catra what are you doing?"

"What does it look like I'm doing? I'm not stupid Adora. I know something's bothering you. It's not like you to not fall asleep the second your face hits that pillow."

I'm starting to think this was a bad idea but I'm reassured by the fact that she doesn't make any attempts to push me out of her personal space.

"Yeah well... I'm just a little distracted that's all."

I can tell by the way her eyes look away from me that there is more to it. Without saying a word or giving an indication of my next move I allow my arm and tail draping over her body, before slowing moving closer to her, eventually pulling her closer to me.

"Catra, we could get…"

"We're not going to get caught. I'll be back at your feet before anyone wakes up and no-one will know that I was by your side for the night."

Adora has always been one to worry. She's always believed she has to be the perfect soldier. To be honest, I can't really blame, not with the amount of pressure she's under, especially from Shadow Weaver. Adora feels like she has to train hard, follow orders, push yourself to the breaking point to be perfect in the Horde light, to be the perfect soldier. I wish I could tell her that she doesn't have to do that to be perfect, because to me she's perfect the way she is.

Adora moves closer to my body and rests her head on my shoulder. A soft smile creeps across her face. She's so close to me now, it would be so easy to lift her head with my fingers, look deep into her eyes and… *do it, kiss her, let her know how you truly feel about her, KISS HER!"*

Adora makes a quite noise, something between a hum and a giggle.

"What?" I ask, clearly very confused.

"You're purring. I haven't heard you purr in a long time."

She's not wrong. Turns out that whilst my mind was screaming at me to kiss her there and then, I hadn't noticed a purr building in my chest.

"Yeah well it's not often that we get to do this. Not after what happened last time."

Adora's smile slowly starts to fade. *What a way to ruin the moment Catra, well done.*

It was a while ago now, but Shadow Weaver once caught Adora and I like this. We'd had a long day with the monthly trails that make sure we're on track to be the Horde's best soldiers. Training was grueling that day. I fell asleep next to Adora not long after we'd bandaged up each other's wounds. I was so exhausted that I hadn't been able to wake up soon enough to get back to Adora's feet before the morning patrols. Of course that bitch only punished me but Adora has felt guilty ever since.

"I'm sorry for everything she did to you. If I had…"

"Don't say it. Adora we've been through this. What happened after she found us is not your fault."

"But I could have stopped her. I should have tried harder to get to you."

A small tear starts to run down Adora's cheek. Clearly the memory is just as painful for her as it is for me. Adora tried everything she could to get Shadow Weaver to release me from her dark clutches, even taking a hit during the process. It didn't work though, I soon found myself in that dark room where my screams of pain are never heard. I wipe the tears off her cheek and gently lift her head so she's looking directly into my eyes with her own.

"Adora you did everything you could. There was no stopping her, it just what she does. She clearly uses me to get to you. Now can you stop blaming yourself?"

I rest our foreheads together before continuing. I'm not sure if Adora's aware but this is how Magicats express that we truly trust someone, well that and the slow blink.

"Besides, when something like that happens I remember what you told me many years ago…You look out for me, and I look out for you. Nothing really bad can happen as long as we have each other."

Adora's smile reappears and she wraps her arms around my waist, pulling me closer to her. Her head leaves mine after a few moments and returns to rest of my chest. It's nice to know what it feels like to be held in a soft embrace. It's very rare that we ever get to be like this.

"Thank you" Adora says quietly. I don't need to ask what for, I think we both need to be close to each other tonight more than we both care to realise; Adora probably more than me.

"Don't get used to it. This is *not* because I like you."

Adora tightens her arms around me a little more and she tries to nuzzle herself against my fur. I could have sworn I heard her say *"soft kitty"* under her breathe. It's not long after that I her breathing slows and she starts to lightly snore.

It takes me a little while longer to get to sleep. To be honest, I'm also nervous about tomorrow. I'm not worried about hiding in the tank or scared about being risk caught. If I am caught I can deal with it, these claws can do some damage. I'm worried about Adora. I don't know what I'd do if something happened to her. Neither of us know what to expect; the Horde is very manipulative. Who knows what's out there. The thought of losing her terrifies me. Once I'm certain that she is asleep enough to not entirely process what I want to say to her, I whisper a silent promise to her…

"I will always protect you… *I Promise*".

Chapter End Notes

There you have it: Chapter 1 of Together at the End of the World. Hope you liked it. Let me know what you think. See you next week :)

The Fall of Thaymor

Chapter Summary

Catra is conflicted with her feelings for Adora.

Shadow Weaver makes Catra question what will happen at Thaymor.

Adora realizes that she has been lied to.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

I woke up a few minute before Adora this morning, which is unusual as she's always up before me. *Guess I must have sent her into a deep sleep by purring.* I made my way back down to her feet before anyone else awoke. She went to *'Force Captain Orientation'* not long after breakfast, which happened to be the brown rations this morning, yuck. In the meantime, I made my way to the vehicle bay and found the lead tanker. The area wasn't very well guarded, I had no trouble sneaking into the tank undetected. I've been here for about a solid hour now. At this rate I will surely die of boredom. It's bad enough that the memories of last night have been play over and over in my head since I awoke this morning…

You promised to always protect her. Why don't you just tell her how you feel? Why didn't you kiss her you fool!

"SHUT UP!" I scream, my claws digging into my scalp.

I'm lucky that I'm alone and the area is unguarded as I could have just blown my cover. Why does this have to be so hard? Why am I so afraid to tell her how I feel?...

Because you're afraid she won't feel the same way about you.

How much longer is this going to take? I feel like I'm going to go insane if I have to argue with my thoughts over how I feel about Adora.

Suddenly, I hear a few voices coming from outside the tanks. I can hear people shouting and engines roaring. The tank floor starts to vibrate underneath my feet. Some of the machines must be being starting up and ready to move.

"I'm proud of you Adora, you have come so far and now you're going to prove your worth and prove to Lord Hordak himself that my decision to appoint you to the position of Force Captain was a great one."

That voice sends a chill down my spine, I hear that voice in my nightmares… *Shadow Weaver.* Of all people why does she have to be here? If she finds out that I'm hiding in here there's no telling what she'll do to me…

She'll probably send you to Beast Island, she been trying to do that for years.

I instinctively move further back behind the pipes further into the darkness, trying to make myself undetectable.

"I won't let you down Shadow Weaver."

Adora? It feels like forever since I last heard her voice. Hopefully, her arrival means that it won't be too long before we actually get to set off and do something.

"See to it that you don't. This mission is very important not just for you but for the entire Horde. See to it that you do not fail."

Standard words of encouragement from Shadow Weaver, *no pressure*. I had hoped that that that was the last I'd hear of the witch's voice, but it wasn't.

"Oh and Adora… don't think too much about what you see."

'Don't think too much about what you see' what does she mean by that?

The tank door opens fully and Adora jumps down. She starts to set the controls before peering over her shoulder to make sure I'm here. A grin appears across her face. She must have seen my silhouette or my eyes, I don't know why but they shine quite bright when its dark. Another perk of being a Magicat but also another *weakness.* The engine starts to roar and we start to move.

This is going to be fun.

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"You can come out now" Adora says. Her eyes remain focused on the path in front. I creep up behind her and lean against the head of her seat.

"Care to tell me where we are exactly. Oh and how much longer is it until we get to Thaymor? I've been stuck back there for over an hour waiting for you to get a move on. Sure I got cramp in my tail from waiting for you."

I'm not complaining, I just want to tease her a little bit. I'm honestly surprised her plan actually worked. Afterall, I'm the one with the brain's.

"Oh come on it wasn't all that bad. My plan worked didn't it, we're on our first mission together… and in answer to your question we're at the edge of the Whispering Wood. The navigation system predicts we'll arrive at Thaymor in about twenty minutes. Everyone has already been given their orders by the other Force Captains that are with us so we should be able to get on with the attack when we arrive. I only need to give the order to launch the attack."

Now that I like to sound of. I wish time could fly by a bit faster. In twenty minute time I'll get to blow something up. In twenty minutes I'll be able to let my stresses loose. In twenty minutes time… *you could confess how you feel about her and catch up on lost time by making out!*

"Catra?"

"What?"

"I asked if you wanted to take the wheel. Are you okay? You look a bit off, your cheeks are burning up."

My cheeks do feel a bit hot, but not because I'm unwell. Adora tries to place the back of her hand against my head, attempting to check my temperature. I bat her hand aside, insisting that I'm fine…

"Of course I'm fine, just a bit warm in here. Some of us have fur you know. It's like a heated blanket under all of this."

Adora chuckles and smiles. I'll never get bored of hearing her laugh and seeing her smile.

"So do you want to take the wheel or…"

She should know she doesn't need to ask. Adora doesn't even get to finish her sentence as I jump into her lap and take the wheel.

"You could have of at least let me move before you parked your arse!" She giggles as she started to push me forwards so she could maneuver herself out of the chair.

"Oh come on, I was just getting comfy."

I miss the loss of contact. Since last night my want to be closer to Adora had gotten strong. Who knew I missed cuddling up to her so much.

"Well that's a surprise. You're not exactly the type of person who strikes me as a *'lap cat'*."

"Seriously, again with the cat jokes? That's low even for you. If I wasn't driving right now I would have whooped your ass and thrown you out of the tank for that."

Adora starts to laugh as she moves to the tanks front window to get a better view of what lies ahead. She takes in the view in all its glory. Who knew the world outside the Fight Zone looked so green. To be fair, my attention is direction elsewhere.

"Nice view isn't it."

"Certainly is."

W*hat are you doing! Keep your eyes on the path ahead! You don't want to get distracted! You have plenty of time to watch her in all her glory later!*

I shake my head trying to erase the *'distraction'* from my mind. If my cheeks weren't on fire before they certainly were now.

"Uh… how much longer until we get to Thaymor? I can't wait to blow something up".

"Shouldn't be too long, about five more minutes. Don't worry I promise to let you blow something up. But remember, after that we're here to observe and ensure that all goes well, I can't let Sha…"

"DON'T YOU DARE! Don't even think about mentioning that name on this mission. I know that witch wants you to do well and all but this is not about her. This is your moment so own it."

My voice is stern and my pupils are nothing more than a sharp line. Adora turns to face me, I think she got my message loud and clear. A gentle smile appears across her face and she is now walking towards me.

"You're right, you're right. I'm sorry. This is ***our mission.*** I shouldn't be bringing her into this".

'Our mission'? Did I hear that right, '*our mission*'? I'd never thought that Adora would consider this mission to be an ***us*** thing. This was after all a mission appointed to her. Adora seems to notice that I'm a bit shocked at the statement. She chuckles slightly and suddenly her hands are on top of mine… *what's going on?*

"This is ***our mission*** Catra. Did you honestly think I could do this on my own… we're a team. We'll be together at the end of the world, remember?"

There it is, another promise that we made to each other a very long time ago: ***'It'll be you and me, together at the end of the world'.***

As much as I want to stop myself, I can't hold back the smile that's started to creep across my face. But this time it's okay, it's just me and Adora… *how is she this beautiful?*

I'm about to return with a sarcastic comment but somethings starts to come through on the communications system… *why are our perfect moments always ruined by something like this?*

"Force Captain Adora. We are almost at the first barrier of the rebel fortress. Everyone has their orders and are awaiting your command".

I recognize that voice, it's none other than the tentacled squid Octavia. I can't believe she's allowed on this mission. She can't even see properly, not after I took her eye out that is. It's not my fault she's a stupid dumb face. Adora takes the communications system and reports back.

"Thanks Octavia. My command to attack is simple. Troops are only to attack once *I* take the first shot at the barriers. Understood?" Adora looks down at me with a devilish smirk, *stars she's hot.*

“Understood.” Octavia responds and the communications system went dead.

“So, you ready?”

“Ready as I’ll ever be!”

--

Explosions from bombs are going off everywhere. I can feel the vibrations of tanks movements rumbling underneath my feet. People are screaming and running in all directions. I’m still coming down from my high adrenaline rush after hitting a metal barrier that surrounds the boundaries. It has helped to relive some stress but something doesn’t feel right. Adora and I are currently on a hillside watching the chaotic scene below us unfold.

Why is everyone running? We’re heroes freeing them from the Rebellion’s grasps… right?

I look to my side to check on Adora. Colour has faded from her face, she’s ghost white. Her pupils are fully dilated and her mouth is slightly open. I can tell her breathing is increasing slowly as her chest starts to move more quickly. All clear signs that she’s entering shock.

“Adora?” a hint of concern comes through in my voice, but Adora doesn’t respond. She’s still watching the scene unfold.

“Hey… ADORA!”

This time I take her by the shoulders so she’s physically looking at me. The expression on her face reads a few things: shock, confusion and fear. Adora grabs me by the shoulders and grips tight.

"Catra we have to put a to stop this!"

Okay now I'm very confused…

"WHAT? WHY?"

"Because this is a civilian town. These aren't insurgents, they're innocent people."

Adora lets go of my shoulders and turns me so we're once again facing the battlefield. Only this isn't a battlefield. Adora's right, Thaymor is nothing more than a civilian town with unarmed individuals running for their lives. I knew something seemed suspicious when I heard what Shadow Weaver said to Adora… *'Don't think too much about what you see'*. I turn to face Adora once again. Her expression is hard to read but I can tell that she's just realized something…

"The Horde… they've been lying to us, manipulating us. Hordak, Shadow Weaver, all of them."

Her eyes return to look at me, betrayal is visible in her eyes. I on the other hand am a bit pissed that she's only just realizing this.

"Duh. Did you just figure that out?"

What else am I meant to say? It's the truth! They've been doing it for years. Not just to me but to all of us. Has she really only just figured that out?

"Manipulation is Shadow Weaver's whole thing! She's been messing with our heads since we were kids!"

There, I said it! The realization hits Adora hard.

"How could you be okay with that?"

Does she honestly think I'm okay with being manipulated? Of course I'm not! The only reason I stuck it out is because the Horde is the only home I've ever truly known… well sort of. I can't

just defect, that would be a death sentence. I also can't leave her behind, she's my world, my everything. How can she be so clueless?

"Because. It doesn't matter what they do. The two of us look out for each other and soon we'll be the ones calling the shots."

Somewhere inside that mind of hers she must know I'm sort of right but I can clearly tell that she's fighting with her feelings.

"I can't go back Catra, not after everything I've seen." Adora pleads with me and takes my hand in hers, holding it tightly. "Come with me. You don't have to go back there. We can fix this."

I want nothing more than to run away with her and it be just the two of us against the world, but where would we go? Sure our Horde survival skills will come in handy but there is no telling what is out there. This may be my only chance to get through to her, get her to think logically rather than running headfirst into everything.

"Adora, for once think logically about this. Don't jump on your high horse and go off gallivanting. I want nothing more than for us to get out of the Horde together but this war isn't going to stop just because you've realized what they're doing is wrong. If anything Shadow Weaver will hunt you down, erase your memory and then the whole process of Force Captain to battle to realization will start again."

I can see the frustration in Adora's eyes, but before she can say anything I continue to speak…

"Think about it Adora. Where would we go? How long can we survive out there with the limited resources we have? We have never been outside the Fight Zone until today. We've been trapped inside there for most of our lives. We don't know what's out here."

Adora slumps to the ground, the realization of the truth hits her hard. I so badly want to pull her into my grasp and hold her close

to me. I want to tell her everything will be okay, even though I know deep down what happens next isn't going to be easy for either of us. Running away means we'd be free and I'd be safe to tell her how I feel about her. Who knows, maybe she feels the same way about me but leaving now would be a death sentence.

I've had to fight with my feelings more than once to protect her, I guess I'm going to have to keep fighting them a little while longer. I kneel down beside Adora and re-take her hands into my own.

"What are we going to do?" Adora asks. Her eyes stare deep into mine. What I see was not the deep blue beautiful oceans that I usually see, this time I see myself in her. Scared, worried and confused.

I looked around trying to think of our options. Then it hits me.

"We're going to work our way up and defeat the Horde from the inside."

"How are we going to do that?"

"I have a plan and it's going to be risky but it may be our only chance. But more than anything, I need you to stay with me, okay?"

Adora's breathing calms down and she takes a few deep breathes before responding…

"Okay".

Adora relaxes and I help her stand. The battle is still on going, but then I notice something fast and sparkly in the distance. *Perfect timing.*

"So, what's the plan?"

Adora has turned to face me, colour slowly returning to her face. She has a firm grip on my hand, reassuring me that we're in the together no matter what.

“We get ready to defeat the Horde. Follow me!”

I drag her along with me, carefully working our way through the trees and past the remaining Horde soldiers, trying our best to disappear undetected. We only stop when I find suitable cover and we are within striking distance of who we need to capture.

Chapter End Notes

Hope you liked Chapter 2. What do you think Catra's plan involves? Find out next week when Chapter 3 is uploaded. See you next Friday. :)

Sparkles & Arrows

Chapter Summary

Adora and Catra come up with a plan.

Things get a bit out of hand with Glimmer and Bow.

Catra relieves some shocking information about her past.

** Chapter/Creator Warning: Blood and Injury**

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"FOR FUCK SAKE! Why does the Horde have to be so DIFFICULT! They've got what they want why don't they FUCKING LEAVE!"

That must be the sparkly princesses' voices. What's her problem? They're worse than the Horde: unable to control their powers, barging in when they're not wanted. Except this time it's an exception, we actually need to get their attention.

"Glimmer try and calm down. Last thing we want right now is to be detected."

Of course the princess would have a protector, *pathetic*.

Adora and I have managed to get within striking distance of the two rebels. We've tracked them to just outside the boundaries of Thaymor. There's plenty of cover here: trees, boulders and bushes, we're pretty much undetectable. Adora is still a little shaken from the experience but she seems to have calmed down slightly. She seems to be as ready as me to capture the princess.

"So what's the plan?" Adora whispers. We're hiding between a thick overgrowth of bushes, following our targets.

“You’re going to keep him distracted, whilst I take down the princess. Once we get the princess to stand down, we’ll get them to meet our demands.”

“Alright, okay… wait a minute, why do you get to the one going after the princess and not me?”

I sigh deeply.

“You’re such an idiot. I’m the one with the brains remember. I have the plan mapped out in my head, you only know part of it. Besides, you’re the one with the muscles. I need you to take down Sparkles’ bodyguard so when we have them where we want them they’ll have to listen to us.”

“Did you really just name a princesses Sparkles?”

“Yes. Yes I did.”

Adora snickers under her breath. It’s nice to hear after everything we’ve just seen.

“You’ve noticed she can teleport right?”

“Well duh. We just need to tire her out.”

“Alright, just be careful.” A hint of worry came across in Adora’s voice.

“Always am.”

I dart upwards into the trees above whilst Adora continues her pursuit on the ground. We quietly continue our approach, getting ready to attack.

--

"Take a good look around Bow. Do you see any Horde soldiers around here… *no!* They're all too busy destroying an innocent town. I swear that if I see a Horde solider I'll…

"You'll do what, *princess*. Face it, you're all sparkle and no bite."

My voice echoes through the trees. They even flinched at that faintest sound of my voice. *This is going to be fun.*

"Show yourself HORDE SCUM!"

Both rebels stand back to back. Impressive fighting stance. The princess starts to form a glittery ball with her fist with her bodyguard having arrows prepared: *I think I'll name them Sparkles and Arrow Boy.*

I chuckle at Sparkle's '*command*'. She's so tiny, how can she ever command a Rebellion army?

"Haha, now where would the fun be in that?"

Her frustration is clearly visible, it's enjoyable to watch. Arrow Boy on the other hand has started to tremble, he's going to be really easy for Adora to take down. I start jumping through the trees at different height levels to confuse them. They both clumsily try to follow my movements. They're not very good at tracking or aiming, they've missed me with every shot they've taken.

How can they lead an army when they can't even aim? Who knew this would be so enjoyable.

"Here's what's going to happen. You're going to stand down willingly or we're going to take you down, make you regret not listening to us in the first place and then you're going to meet our demands."

"FUCK YOU! Why don't you stop being cowards! Come out and fight us!"

"Glimmer that might not be a good idea. We don't know how many of them are out there. Not to mention that I only have a few arrows left and you're almost out of magic."

Sparkles gives Arrow Boy what might be the most intense death stare I have ever seen, it's hilarious.

"Arrow Boy is right *Sparkles*, I would listen to him if I was you."

I look down to see that Adora is ready in position on the opposite side to me. Now would be the best time to strike. I just need separate the two rebels, but how?

I look around for an option… *that'll work.* I kick a branch into the bush underneath me. Perfect, Sparkles starts to move forwards and Arrow Boy is now facing with his back to Adora.

"We're not afraid of you!" Sparkles voice is trembling.

I look down at Adora to make sure she's ready. She looks back up to me and devilishly smiles before nodding her head signalling to me that she's ready.

"Suit yourself."

Adora sprints out of the bushes and pins Arrow Boy to the ground. Sparkles turns around with glowing fists ready to attack Adora. There was no way I'm going to let anyone hurt her.

Pouncing out of the trees I slam Sparkles full force into the dirt below, glitter even fly's off her when she hit the ground, *typical*. My initial attack is short lived as I receive a firm punch to the ribs from Sparkles' elbow before she turns and kicks me in the stomach forcing me off her.

That little shit is strong.

Adora is struggling to keep Arrow Boy pinned down but at least she's managed to discard him of his weapon. Both rebels are putting up a good fight.

Next thing I know, Sparkles fires a glitter ball at my face, momentarily blinding me, it tastes horrible. I think I've got glitter in my mouth.

I briefly see Sparkles disappear and then suddenly reappear next to Adora. She's strangling her in an attempt to get her to release Arrow Boy, but Adora's not going to give up without a fight. I have to help her.

"GET AWAY FROM HER!"

I sprint towards them, fangs and claws bared. I'm ready to slice that bitch to shreds but Arrow Boy manages to grip onto my leg, pulling me to the ground. I'm only able to scratch Sparkles leg but it's got her to release Adora from her grasp.

Adora falls to the ground gasping for air, her hand held around her neck. *I know that feeling all too well.* I turn and manage to scratch Arrow Boy under his chin. He should be grateful that Adora is my main concern right now. If she wasn't I would have ripped his eye out. Once he releases me I run over to Adora.

"Adora are you okay?"

"Yeah… yeah I'm fine."

I'm close to her now. She has a few scuff marks on her chin and arms, probably from trying to secure Arrow Boy. I'd kill them both if we didn't require their assistance. I help Adora regain her bearings and immediately stand in front of her to protect her. My claws and fangs are ready for another attack, but it never came.

Arrow Boy has run over to Sparkles' aid. Turns out my claws have gone in deeper than I thought. Blood is streaming down her leg and she's struggling to stand. She deserves it after trying to hurt Adora. He helps her stand, she tries to teleport them both away but it's no use, she's clearly out of magic and exhausted.

Arrow Boy is the one to actually talks some sense... "What do you want from us?"

I'd be lying if I said I'm not slightly surprised. I thought it would have taken more than that to get them to listen to us. Of course Sparkles has to protest.

"BOW! We can't help them! They're…"

"GLIMMER! You're injured, I'm defenceless. They could easily run back to Thaymor and get the rest of the Horde soldiers to take us prisoner. Brightmoon needs us. Your mother made me promise to protect you and she doesn't even know we're out here. Our only chance may be to hear them out and give them what they want in return for us leaving unharmed."

"*Unharmed?* Bow, in case you haven't noticed that *bitch* just sliced through my leg a few moments ago. I have no doubt it will become infected and need stitches. I think the word you're looking for is *ALIVE!"*

Stars she's annoying, even more annoying than Lonnie.

"Well I wouldn't have had to do that to you if you had listened to me in the first place. You deserved it after you tried to hurt the one *I*…"

I chock on my last words. I nearly let the fact that I have feelings for Adora slip out to two complete strangers. *I'm such an Idiot!*

"Look Sparkles…"

"It's Glimmer."

She gives me the death stare. *Does she honestly think that's going to work on me?*

"Whatever. Will you and Arrow Boy…"

"Bow."

"Ugh… will you just hear us out! We don't have long and we certainly don't want to talk to you more than what we have to,

but this may be out only chance to make things right."

After a few seconds of awkward silence pass, Adora is the one to speak.

"Please." Her voice is calm and she speaks softly. If they're going to listen to anyone it'll be Adora.

Both rebels start to have a *'telepathic'* conversation. I'm sure they're just trying to waste our time. It's Sparkles who decides to speak, not Arrow Bow.

"Alright. We'll listen but only if you agree to let us leave alive."

I snicker at the remark. I'm sure that comment was targeted at me.

"Such as *big* request coming from someone as *small* as you."

"Catra!"

"What? She strangled you. She punched me in the ribs, kicked me in the chest and then threw glitter in my face. If she tries to attack one of us again I'll make sure it's the last time she attacks anyone."

"You're really not helping."

I let out a long sigh, retract my claws and cross my arms across my chest.

"Sorry about Catra. She's just a little bit pissed about you trying to kill me."

"Well the feelings mutual," Sparkles responds.

I don't even have the energy to talk to her so I just faintly growl with my teeth slightly showing. Think she got the message as she's backed off leaning into Arrow Bow a bit more. He's next to speak.

“So, how can we help?”

--

Adora explains everything that has happened. She mentions that we had been taught since we were kids to believe that the Horde were fighting to restore peace to Etheria. She emphasized how we had been manipulated in to believing that everything the Horde told us was true. Most importantly she mentioned how only now were we realizing what the Horde was really doing and we wanted to make things right by putting an end to this war once and for all.

I could have sworn Arrow Boy has tears forming in his eyes but I can tell Glimmer wasn’t buying it.

“If you want out of the Horde so bad, why don’t you just defect?”

“Because if we were to defect our mentor, *Shadow Weaver*, will hunt us down, wipe our memories and the whole process will start again.”

There’s a hint of sadness in Adora’s voice. I can tell the realization of this, of everything, is hard for her. Now wasn’t the time to mention that Shadow Weaver would only come looking for Adora. I’m worthless to that bitch, she reminds me of that every day -‘*You’re nothing without Adora!’*

“So, why should we help you? How do we know this isn’t some Horde trick?”

Sparkles is testing my patience. The longer we’re out her the greater chance someone will notice we’re… *Adora* is missing and come looking for her and our plan will be exposed. Not to mention that they’ll notice that I have snuck onto this mission. My frustration with her is growing stronger, if we we're ever going to

get across to them it would have to be soon. I've held back long enough.

"Look, we don't really have time for this. The longer we're out here the more chance we have of being caught. Just…*ugh*… why are you refusing to believe us!"

Sparkles' face starts to turn red. I think I've punched a nerve.

"BECAUSE WE'VE LOST SO MUCH BECAUSE OF YOU! Not only have people lost their homes, their lives, but so many of us have lost the people they love, *including me*. We've lost people we care about as well as some many families and…"

"SO HAVE I!"

The trees shake at the sound of my voice and some birds leave their nest, squawking as they fly past. *Shit that was a bit too loud but at least it shut her up.* I didn't want to play that card but she wasn't giving me much of a choice; she's not the only one who has suffered because of the war.

I haven't told anyone about my life before the Horde or how I really ended up in that dump. I haven't even told Adora the whole story. She thinks I was just abandoned at the Horde's doorstep in a box, but there's so much more to it than that.

Adora stares at me, clearly shocked. I have a feeling that she wants to know what happened and why I have never told her the whole story, but that a conversation for future Adora and Catra.

"Catra?"

Adora's places a hand on the back of my shoulders. I release a breathe I didn't realize I had been holding in. I take a few deep breathes before looking back up to face Sparkles and Arrow Boy. Now it's my turn to give them the death stare.

"You two don't deserve to know about my past. You're not the only ones who have lost a part of yourself because of the war. Do

you honestly think we have a choice in what we do? Do you think any of us wanted to be a part of this? *Well?"*

Both rebels refuse to say a word. Adora continues to look at me. Her hand rubs small circles across my back in an attempt to calm me down. It sort of works.

"This war isn't going to end unless we do something about it. You're right, you have no reason to trust us but I'll… we'll do everything within our power to put a stop to this war. *I can't lose what matters to me most."*

I can't lose her.

The air feels tense. I think everyone is a bit shocked at what I just said, including myself. For the first time since she opened her mouth, Sparkles speaks reasonably.

"Fine. You want to end the war and so do we. What do you suggest?"

Adora, Arrow Boy and I have to take a minute to process the fact that Sparkles is actually agreeing to help. I guess it's now or never.

"We need some sort of secure communications system set up. We can't stop attacks from taking place as Lord Hordak gives orders to attack. We don't exactly know what happens to those who disobey his orders, but we don't want to find out. Let's just say they haven't been seen in *very* long time. If we can set up as secure communications system we can send you relevant information on battle plans, meaning you can try and evacuate the area and prepare your *'Rebellion army'* for battle. In the meantime, Adora and I will work our way up the ranks and strike the Horde at its core. I know it's not much but it's a start and it may be our only chance to end this war."

Sparkles looks at Arrow Bow, who then turns to us to address us directly.

“You’ll need to get in contact with Entrapta, she's the princess of Dryl. She’s a scientist who experiments with first-ones tech. I’m sure she’ll be able to help you out. Once it’s set up, try to communicate us on this tracker pad, we can discuss what to do from there.”

He hands us a separate communications device which we’ll eventually use to contact them once everything is set up and secure. Adora seems relieved that we have finally managed to get through to them and to be honest so am I.

“Thank you. We’ll do everything we can we promise.” Adora says. We part ways feeling relieved.

--

It’s just Adora and I now. We’re taking a skiff back to the Fright Zone. Adora is steering and I’m sat on the floor opposite her. Some of the soldiers have been ordered to make camp and guard the area to prevent any rebels from trying to take back Thaymor. They have their orders. Force Captains have been ordered to return to the Fright Zone to issue reports on the events and celebrate successfully conquering Thaymor. However, Adora and I won’t be celebrating, not after we’ve seen and come to realize. I suppose we’ll get used to it… *eventually.*

It’s a long journey back, I’m surprised Adora hasn’t yet asked me…

“Catra?”

“Yeah?”

“Can I ask you something?”

“Depends on what you want to ask.”

There’s a moments pause. I can tell what’s coming.

“Do remember how you ended up in the Horde?”

Guess I jinxed it. This really isn’t something I want to talk about right now.

“Yeah I remember. I don't remember everything but I remember enough”.

“Do you mind if I ask what happened? I mean you don’t have to tell me… I’m not going to pressure you to tell me…”

“Adora. I get that you’re interested and you want to know what happened, but today brought a lot of memories back for me. I don’t want to talk about it right now but I promise I’ll tell you everything soon, okay.”

The memory of that night scarred me for life and talking about it after what we’ve just witnessed is too much. I don't want Adora to push me, I’m thankful that she doesn’t.

“Okay.” That was Adora’s only response.

I pull my legs up to my chest and wrap my arms and tail around them, trying to make myself as small as possible. It helps me to feel safe. We weren’t far from the Fright Zone when Adora spoke again.

“I’ll always protect you too.”

Wait, what?

I turn to look up at Adora to find her looking back at me with those beautiful eye and her gorgeous smile.

“I heard what you said to me last night before I fell into a deep sleep. I wanted to make sure that you know that I’ll *always* protect you too.”

I’m a little embarrassed that she heard what I said, but I can't hold back the smile that starts to form. The skiff pulls into the docking bay. Adora helps me stand and I move so I’m now facing her properly.

“Yeah well, don’t get used to hearing it. This is *not* because I like you.”

“Sure, keep telling yourself that.”

“I’m serious!”

Adora started to giggle-snort, holding her sides.

“Shut up!”

I push her off the skiff and she lands hard the floor. We both can’t stop laughing. It feels good to have a laugh. If only she knew I love her. Maybe someday I’ll be able to tell her.

Chapter End Notes

> Hope you enjoyed Chapter 3. We'll find out a bit more about Catra's past next week. See you next Friday :).

Alone

Chapter Summary

Adora and Catra return to the Fright Zone after meeting Glimmer and Bow.

Shadow Weaver has something to say.

Catra is reminded about her past.

Adora and Catra spend their first night Alone?

Chapter/Creator Warnings: Reflection of the Past, Blood and Injury, Mentions of Physical Abuse

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Applause and cheering can be heard throughout the Fright Zone. Word that we have successfully conquered Thaymor has traveled fast. As much as Adora and I didn't feel like celebrating we both know we have to *'blend in'* with the crowds to avoid raising suspicions. We avoid the larger crowds and slowly make our way through the smaller gatherings. Adora accepts any congratulations that she gets. She smiles it off and eventually makes her way back to me at the other side. The sooner we're back to the barracks the better.

I can tell she's starting to feel uncomfortable but you can't blame her. I wonder how many people actually know what's really happening outside these walls?

"Hey, you okay?" I ask. I'm unsure what to do to make her feel better.

"Ye, I'm okay. Just tired. It's been a long day."

Adora fakes a yawn. She's such a terrible liar. I cross my arms and stare deep into her eyes. I can tell something's up and this time I'm not going to let it drop. I need her to understand that she can tell me anything.

"What?" Adora asks. Her eye start to dart from side to side like she's looking for an escape route.

"Adora, I can tell something's bothering you. You know it's okay to feel... *I don't know*... *upset* about all this, especially after what we've just witnessed."

I unfold my arms and place my hands on either side of her shoulders before continuing...

"You know you can talk to me, *right?*"

Adora relaxes and places a hand over mine that rests on her shoulder. She sighs, I can tell she wants to say something but I don't think she knows where to start.

"Is it about what we saw, what we did or what we're about to do?"

I only ask to give her a helping hand. So much has happened today, it could be something and everything at the same time.

"No, it's not that… well some of it is but that's not what's bothering me at the moment. I can deal with all that later. Catra…"

A voice that belongs to neither of us sends a shiver down my spine…"*Adora."*

My fur immediately stands on end. I spin around startled and stand next to Adora ready to attack.

It's Shadow Weaver. *Where did she come from?* She gives me a fowl glare, leaving me with no choice but to retract my claws

despite my senses telling me to remain on high alert. I don't trust her one bit.

She then looks to Adora, who is standing at attention. *Why does she always have to be the perfect solider?*

"Shadow Weaver."

I refuse to say a word. If I keep my mouth shut maybe this conversation won't last long.

"I just wanted to… *congratulate* you on conquering Thaymor. I knew you wouldn't let me down. As you are aware this is a great accomplishment for the entire Horde. With each achievement we're closer to '*restoring*' peace Etheria in Lord Hordak's name. You should be proud."

I refuse to look at Shadow Weaver, her voice alone makes me sick. Instead I favor looking at the floor. I don't want that witch to be able to stare into my soul. She's already tried to access my mind once or twice before. I'm proud to say she failed miserably. Adora doesn't say anything, she just smiles. Shadow Weaver continues to speak.

"You'll soon have new recruits joining your team. I expect you to train them up to be some of the Horde's best soldiers. Do I make myself clear?"

Great, new recruits. Surely our teams big enough as it is.

"Yes Shadow Weaver. We won't let you down."

'We won't let you down'. Since when did I become a part of this?

I look up at Adora to see her smiling back at me. I give a faint smile back in return. Shadow Weaver on the other hand *does not* look impressed. She's glaring at me, trying to find a weak point to strike me down… *good luck with that, she's already used them all.*

"Very well." Shadow Weaver says, before returning to look at Adora. "You better get some rest. Your new quarters are ready. A key code isn't necessary, we have *upgraded* the system to be print recognition to ensure you don't get… *interrupted*."

I think the term she's looking for is *'Magicat proof'*. Adora seems to pick up on what Shadow Weaver means by *'interrupted'*. Her smile becomes no more than a faded line.

"Alright, we'll I go and make my team aware of where I'll be from now on should they need me. "

Adora looks at me before walking ahead towards to barracks. I'm left alone with the witch. I'm about to follow her when Shadow Weaver blocks my path. *Great, here it comes.* I clench my fists at my sides and look up.

"Where were you today *Catra*?"

She spits my name like it was venom, not that that's anything new.

"What does it matter to you?"

Shadowed tentacles start to form around me, red electricity sparks round the witches' mask. I know these tell-tale signs all to well. I brace myself for what's coming. I'll be over soon enough.

"I'm not as foolish as you think Catra. If it were down to me you would have been sent to Beast Island when Adora found you in that box. If it was possible, you would be in the Black Garnet Chamber right now receiving your punishment. Consider yourself lucky that crowds are gathered all over the Fight Zone, that's the only reason you're standing here right now. You are and will always be nothing more than a worthless, useless, despicable magicat cub. If it wasn't for Adora you'd be dead. She's the only reason you're still alive. *DO NOT* stand in her way!"

Shadow Weaver hasn't stated anything other than the usual, I'm used to it, but her words still stab like a knife to the heart. It hurts

but I’m not going to let it show, that would just give her a perfect excuse to strike. Instead I shake it off like I always do. I know the bitch will do anything to bring me down.

"Yes Shadow Weaver."

I glare into the white orbs of her mask for a few seconds before trying to barge past her. I should have seen it coming. She wasn’t going to let me get away without one physical hit.

SLAP

My mask clanks against the ground. I’m surprised I’ve been able to keep my balance and not fall over. The side of my face is on fire but that’s not all. I feel a small cut on my right cheek under my fingertips; drawing my hand away I notice blood.

I growl at the bitch that stands before me. She smirks and chuckles before floating away. Only once she has gone do I let down my guard and retrieve my mask, carefully placing it back on my head, being extra cautious not to aggravate the cuts: I’ll clean them up later.

I was almost at the barrack doors when they suddenly open. Of course it would be Adora. She looks at me, stunned at the sight she sees.

“Catra what happened?”

Her hand lightly brushes my cheek. I want to tell her what happened but that bitch may only be around the corner waiting for another opportunity to strike. I slowly take Adora’s hand in mine lowering it away from the cuts. I can’t let her near me at the moment, it’s not safe.

“It’s nothing. I’m fine.”

“You’re clearly not. Catra please tell me what happened…”

“I SAID I'M FINE!”

Silence. I didn't mean to snap but what else could I do. I can't have her or anyone else thinking I'm weak. Besides it's only a few scratches, a burning cheek, possibly a swollen eye and an aching heart.

"Okay well, you know where I am if you need me."

She smiles weakly before walking past me. I can hear her footsteps fading. I can't leave it like this…

"Adora?" But it's too late, she's already gone. I'm alone... *again.*

--

Even though I'm lying in Adora's old bunk, surrounded by her scent and our memories, I can't find sleep. I feel terrible for snapping at her but what choice did I have? What else was I supposed to do? I didn't snap intentionally. The guilt is eating me up inside. I also can't sleep because… *well…* I miss her. It's been a long time since we've been separated. Even when either of us tried to be alone we'd somehow find each other. It was as if the universe was trying to pull us together.

It's horrible feeling like you're alone. Adora's the only thing that makes me feel complete, appreciated, and above all… loved.

I have since cleaned the cuts on my face. Thankfully, they're not too deep. They should easily scar over in a few days. Magicat healing works wonders, we heal a lot quicker than other species. It's one of the few things I like about being a Magicat.

I can't take it anymore, I need talk to Adora. *But how?* Shadow Weaver, being the bitch she is, has made Adora's quarters *'Magicat proof'*. Come on brain think. The vent pipes… prefect. I climb through them all the time when I'm racing Adora around the Fright Zone or trying to get out of training. It's the one place

Shadow Weaver hasn't actually caught me yet. It shouldn't be too hard to navigate my way through them.

I climb onto the top bunk open the vent cover and crawl inside. I then use my tail to lift the cover off the bunk roof and screw it back on.

--

There are quite a few right and left turns to this journey. I'm surprised I haven't got lost. The only reason I know I'm on the right track is because I have managed to spot Adora in the corridors. I assume she's just left the showers and is on her way back to her quarters. I would come out and walk beside her but I'm not sure if that witch is around. *Better to be safe than sorry.* As soon as Adora enters her room I crawl over to vent door that will allow me to drop right in front of her bed.

Using my claws, I carefully unscrew the vent door and land on all fours on the floor as quietly as possible. Adora is lying on her side facing away from me but she is clearly not asleep. She just hasn't noticed me yet.

" Hey Adora."

Adora freaks out and reaches for something at the other side of her bed… *an electric baton.*

"What the… Catra?"

She lowers the baton as soon as she realizes it's me.

"Surprise."

"What are you doing here? How did you even get in here?"

“Adora, in case you haven’t noticed I’m a Magicat. We’re known for beginning intelligent, talent and sneaky.”

A smirk crept across my face. Adora just looks at me with a blank face. I blow out a puff of air. *Come on is it not obvious how I got in here?*

“I came in through the air vents.”

Adora smiles and lets out a soft giggle. She moves up the bed and invites me to sit next to her.

“I’m glad you’re here. I’ve being trying to change the *‘print scanner’* all night so you could have access to my quarters too. I struggle to sleep when you’re not around. I tried to fall asleep on my own but… I couldn’t.”

I can’t help but smile. It’s nice to know she need me just as much as I need her.

“You’re not the only one. I’ve been trying to sleep for a while now and couldn’t for… *various reason*. I had to come and find you.”

Adora laces her hand with mine. It’s safe to do that here. We don’t have to be secretive. No-one can get in here except for Adora and me… *well when I come in through the vents that is.*

We sit like that for a while, but I can sense that something is still bothering Adora. I can feel it. Adora leans further into me. I move my arm to rest around her, pulling her into a tight hug. I use my other hand to keep our fingers laced together.

“Talk to me.”

Adora nuzzles further into me, her cheek brushing against my fur on my shoulder, trying to be a close to me as possible. It’s important that she feel grounded and safe.

“A few things have been bothering me since we got back: what we saw, what we did and what we’re about to do. But a lot of

those things I can deal with as I know I'll have you by my side."

Adora sighs deeply. I can sense what's coming. Before she can say anything I finish her answer…

"You want to know why I haven't told you the full story about how I ended up in the Fright Zone."

Adora simply nods.

"I worry about you Catra, I care about you. Keeping something like that to yourself for so long… I know it hurts me everyday not knowing where I came from or if I had a family, but I can't imagine what it must feel like for you. Especially if you knew what your life was like before the Horde."

Silence fills the room. As painful as the memory is, I think it's about time I tell her the truth. I reposition use so we're facing each other, our hands no longer linked together.

"I suppose it's about time I tell you everything, about how I end up here. But Adora you have to promise me that you'll let me get it all out before you say anything. I'll tell you everything I remember up to you finding me okay?"

Adora nods and responds, "Okay, I promise."

I take a deep breathe, this is going to be tough.

"I don't remember much, but I remember enough. I remember I had a life outside these walls, it was a good one, or at least what I remember is. Magicats have good memories. I think I was about two, maybe three years old when the Horde attacked where I lived. I remember hearing screams, bombs exploding and seeing sights/images of the world that no-one should ever have to see."

My hands start to shake, this is where the memory hurts the most. I try my best to fight back tears. Adora takes my hands in hers, rubbing circles over the top of them. She gives me a reassuring smile, I continue…

“I remember my mother carrying me out the house, protecting me, carrying me in her arm. She had a long cut along her other arm and blood running down her leg but she refused to give up. My dad stayed behind to give us an opportunity to escape. They wanted to get me as far away from the destruction as possible. The rain caused the ground beneath us to mix with the dirt and blood, everywhere I looked I saw red. I’m not sure how long my mother had been running but I could tell she was getting tired. I remember her telling me that she was sorry. Next I knew I was in a box and she gave me *this.”*

I untangle my hands from Adora's so that I can remove my mask from my head. I hold it in my hands, tight.

“This is the last thing I have from my life before the Fright Zone, along with the memories of that night. I remember hearing screams and machines not long after she left and feeling the box I was in being carried into what I can only assume was a tanker. The box I was in was dumped in the corridors were Shadow Weaver found me. She wanted to get rid of me as you very well know. I was terrified. I had no idea what had happened or fully understood why I ended up here. I had never felt so... alone. Then I met you. You took me in your arms and begged Shadow Weaver to let you keep me. Adora, if it wasn’t for you finding me when you did I probably would be…”

Before I get the chance to finish what I was saying Adora wraps her arms around my shoulders and pulls me into a tight embrace. Nothing more needs to be said. I drop my mask to my side and hug her back. I’m unable to stop the tears from forming. The memory is painful but I feel a sense of relief that I have finally told her.

We stay like this for a while, holding each other until my tears subside. When Adora lets go her eyes appear to be a bit red yet she’s smiling.

“Thank you, for telling me.”

I’m not sure how to respond so I just smile back. Adora leans forward and wipes the remaining tears off my cheeks. Even when she exhausted she’s beautiful.

“How about we get some rest. We’ve both had a long day.”

I simply nod my head in response before I speak, “Okay”.

Adora moves my mask to the side of the bed. I suppose I can sleep with it off tonight, after all it’s only us two here. She starts to get comfy under her blanket whilst I get ready to curl up at her feet.

“What are you doing all the way over there?”

I look up at her, confused.

“This is where I usually sleep.”

“Catra it’s just us here. You can sleep up here with me if you want. It really helped last night and… I like being able to sleep next to you.”

Warm heat rushes to my cheeks. *How can she be this adorable?*

“Okay, but this is *not* because I like you.”

“Careful, the more you say it the more people will start to think you *actually* like me.”

Both Adora and I start to giggle. If only she knew part of what she just said was true. She lifts the blanket inviting me to cuddle up close to her. I wrap my arms around her waist and rest my head on her shoulder. She uses one of her hands to stroke my mane, her other one wraps around me and pulls me closer to her. I can’t help but purr, she helps me to feel safe.

“Hey Adora.”

“Yes Catra.”

“Thanks… for everything.”

Adora squeezes her arms around my body a little tighter in response.

“You’ll never be alone again Catra… I Promise.”

We both fall asleep within minutes. My purrs fill the room whilst Adora holds me close, promising that she will always be there for me no matter what.

Chapter End Notes

Hoped you like Chapter 4. Please let me know what you thought in the comments.

Little update for you all, I have altered how often this fic updates to be more regular. This fic now updates every Monday and Friday so you no longer have to wait a week for a chapter update. See you on Monday :)

The Next Step

Chapter Summary

Catra awakes to a beautiful sight.

We meet the new recruits.

Catra and Adora discuss their plan for Conquering Dryl.

Chapter/Creator Warnings: Brief mentions of Physical Abuse

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

I awake from what must be the best sleep I've had in years: no nightmares, no worries and no one around to pull my tail during me sleep. Best of all I've woke up to the most beautiful sight there is… Adora. She's so beautiful when she sleeps, not that she's not beautiful all the time but it's times like this when I can admire her in all her beauty. We're still in the same position that we feel asleep in last night, our arms wrapped around each other and my head resting under her chin against her chest. I can't help but purr. I've never felt this relaxed in my life. I don't want this to end, but sadly all good things in my life seem to end eventually.

Adora starts to stir from her slumber. I slowly move out of her grasp so that she can awake fully. I prop myself up on elbow so I can get a clear look at her as she yawns and stretches. Her eyes start to flicker open.

"Morning." I say as a smile starts to creep across my face.

Adora turns her head. Her eyes are now fluffy open looking directly into mine.

"Morning. How did you sleep?"

“Alright I guess. It was nice not being kicked by your sleep fighting for once.”

Adora smiles and lets of a sleepy chuckle. This is probably the first time in a long time that Adora has manage to sleep through the night without being woken up by her nightmares. The night before Thaymor she was startled awake twice by her night terrors.

“What about you?” I ask, brushing a strand of her fallen hair poof out of her eyes.

“That was probably the best sleep I have ever had. I can’t remember the last time I slept through the whole night without sleep fighting. I’m surprised you didn’t try and wake me up once or twice to make sure I was still alive.”

We both start giggling. I really wish we could stay like this for a little bit longer, but we both know I have to get back to the barracks before anyone awakes and discovers I’m gone. I start to move out from under the blanket we were sharing and reach over Adora to retrieve my mask. Before I'm able to retrieve my mask Adora wraps her arms around my body and pulls me down on top of her into a bone crushing hug, and by bone crushing I literally mean bone crushing. I think I just felt my rib crack.

“Adora what are you doing?” I ask through a fit of laughter. It’s a good job she can’t see my face properly as I can feel my cheeks burning up.

“You reached across me. You should have seen this coming. You’re so fluffy and warm… I’m not letting you go!”

Both Adora and I start laughing hysterically. She tightens her grip around me body as I try to escape the *‘crush of Adora’*.

“Come on Adora. You know as much as I don’t want to leave I have to get back before anyone notices I’m gone.”

Adora loosens her grip so I’m able to prop myself up onto my elbow, one on either side of her body. Her hand are lightly placed

on my sides, she's not letting me go just yet. I smile down at her.

"I know. I miss you, that's all."

Adora looks directly into my eyes, her smile is magical. *Does she have any idea what her smile does to me?* A few seconds of silent pass, I'm so close to her and she still has hold of me. Stars she's pure beauty, if only I could tell her how I feel about her. Maybe we could finally be something more than '*just friends'.* As much as I love her, care about her and want to spend every minute of the day with her I don't feel strong enough to tell her… *not yet anyway*.

"You'll see me throughout the day dummy. Besides who says this little arrangement of ours has to stop?"

Adora quickly sits up at my remark, almost banging our heads in the process.

"Really?"

Stars is she really that dumb?

"Well yeah, I mean that's if you want to? Also long as no one finds out or gets overly suspicious we should be fine."

Adora smiles, "I'd like that."

I smile back at her and start to get up off the bunk. Adora follows my lead and walks over to the bedside cabinets to retrieve that *awful* red jacket and get her boots on.

"Same time tonight?" Adora asks as I start to unscrew the air vent cover above the top of her bunk roof.

"Same time tonight. Now get going, you have *'Force Captain Crap'* to get to before we meet these new recruits."

Adora must have forgotten because next thing you know she's stumbling all over the place trying to get her boots on. She falls

onto her rear with a *'oof'*. I can't help but laugh. It's so like Adora to do something like that. She even starts laughing with me. She regains her bearings and exits her quarters as I enter the air vents, but not before she turns around and smiles at me. Life in the Fright Zone may not be the best, but it would be much worse without Adora in my life.

--

It's been two weeks since we met the new recruits. We have four new additions to our existing team:

- Stinger – A young Scorpioni individual who looks between the age of 13-14. I have only seen a few of his species around the Fright Zone. If I recall correctly they willingly gave the Black Garnet Rune Stone to the Horde in order to keep peace between them. He looks very much like Force Captain Scorpia who I have meet a few times since Adora's promotion. Only differences is that he is small, has dark brown hair and a scar going across his right eye. His strengths include speed, stamina and venom that can temporarily paralyze those he strings. Despite the tough outer-shell he has Scorpia's personality.

- Shadow – I'm not sure if this is their real name but either way it's a pretty cool. They are the same species a Rogelio but they have different features. They have a mix of blonde and white hair, purple scales rather than Rogelio's green scales and they seem to favor wearing black boots rather than the red ones provided by the Horde. I can't blame them, each to their own. I remember ripping up my Horde boots when I first got them, I hated wearing them. They look not much older than Stinger. When we first met them, they

seemed to stay out of the conversations with the rest of the group. But since working with them, they have opened up a bit more and no longer seem afraid to be themselves. Adora has done really well getting them to be more confident with who they are.

- Delta – She's around the ages of 16-17. She's very good with the technological side of things: adapting weapons and resources to be more effective during the team's training sessions. I'd be lying if I didn't say I was impressed. I have a feeling she'll prove useful when trying to communicate with the Rebellion about the Horde's future plans. I'll have to think of a way to get her to assist us without raising suspicious. Adora and I are still unsure about the whole situation, we don't want to put anyone in danger.

- Six – Now I'm a certain that this isn't her real name. Her records state that this was a number assigned to her when she arrived at the Fright Zone and has been referred to that ever since. Six is a challenging individual, but I can't blame her, I know how she feels. Her records show no evidence of her life before the Horde. All they state is that she is 14 years of age, had been brought here as an orphan at the age of six with eight other orphans (hence the name six – orphan number six) that had been found in the Crimson Waste. She had been put through grueling training exercise that'll make her an ideal solider in the future. She's a very competitive team member, one of the top students when training. She reminds me very much of my younger self: determine, courageous and stealthy.

The new recruits get on well with Lonnie, Kyle and Rogelio. Six has even taught Lonnie a thing or two, quite often knocking her off the charts in training and doing some damage. Now that made my day. *Karma's a bitch isn't it Lonnie?*

Adora and I have agreed to approach training the recruits a little differently to how we were trained. When we were cadets Shadow Weaver tried to get us to turn on each other, fueling us with jealousy, anger and rage. We are not doing that! Instead we have been encouraging the cadets to learn from each other: a strong team is an effective team.

We have had to be harsh with the cadets when they are being observed. But every time after the observations were complete, we always tell them things like *'good job'* or *'you did great today'*, something Shadow Weaver would never do.

--

After a long grueling day I make my way back to Adora's quarter's. I'm still currently going through the air vents, we haven't been able to change the system yet. Going through the vents also means I can avoid Scorpia. She appears out of nowhere. The other day when Adora and I were on a lunch break talking about, *you know... stuff,* she appeared out of nowhere asking if she could join us. Adora was obviously more than happy for her to join us. She's always lingering near me. I wouldn't mind if it wasn't obvious that she has a *major* crush on me. She's always trying to flirt with me or show off her strength. Don't get me wrong she's a nice person but I'd wish she'd get the gist that I only have eyes for Adora. My heart practically belongs to Adora.

So far we're doing well with me sneaking into Adora's quarters through the vents. No one suspects anything, not even our expanding team. It's nice knowing after a long hard working day we can just relax and be in each other's presence.

Today we hardly did any training with the new cadets. We've been planning for our next mission tomorrow… conquering Dryl. This is a big step for us and the plan for taking down the Horde. Hordak

wants us to take a small team as he has intel that there is hardly any signs of life there except for a princess who specializes in technology and a few robotics.

“So is this everything?” Adora asks.

We’re sat facing each other, legs crossed, our final plan for conquering Dryl laid out in front of us. We have decided that we'll be taking some of our older team member, *as well as Scorpia,* with us but our newer recruits will be staying behind with Lonnie to keep up with their training. Adora and I will be the ones leading the mission with the elected strike force will be guarding the area once we enter Dryl. They should be prepared to alert us at the first sign of trouble. I’m a bit reluctant to take Scorpia along with us but I’m hoping that this mission will help her understand that I’m not interested in her, I’m only interested in Adora, especially considering that only Adora and I plan to enter the castle.

“I think so. Now all we can do is wait for tomorrow to come, do what we have to do and contact the Rebellion without anyone finding out our plan. We can work out the rest from there.”

I’ll be honest, I’m nervous. I’ve been a bit on edge since our last mission. I’m exhausted, emotionally and physically. Shadow Weaver has taken any chance she can to get to me at the moment. Sometimes it’s been just words, sometimes physical hits, but more often than not I’ve been dragged into that dark room against my will. She never does it when Adora’s around. She manages to catch me when Adora’s at Force Captain Orientation or sent on battle plan meetings. I fight against her everytime but it no use. Adora’s noticed like she always does and helps tend to my cuts and bruises each time. She’s even tried to stop it all from happening by staying close to me at all times when possible and even confronting the bitch herself, but it hasn’t made a difference. At least she hasn’t found out about our sleeping arrangements or our plan to end this war once and for all. If she found out about any of that there is no telling what she’d do, it would probably be a nightmare come true.

“You feeling okay?” Adora asks, taking me away from spiraling thoughts. I’m glad she’s with me. She keeps me calm even when I am far from that.

“Yeah, I’m alright. Just tired. Could really do with getting some sleep. What about you?”

Adora smiles weakly and holds one arm with her hand before responding.

“I’m alright. I’d be lying if I said I wasn’t worried about tomorrow. I don’t know what to expect.”

She nervous, scared even. I can’t blame her, not after what we saw the last time we were out on the battlefield. At least this time we’re prepared. I take her hands in mine and press my forehead against hers. I look deep into her eyes, waiting for hers to find mine. When they do I speak.

“We’re going to be okay. We’re going to go to Dryl tomorrow, carry out our next part of our plan and work out what we need to do from there. I won’t let anything bad happen to you. You look out for me and I look out for you.”

I squeeze her hands reassuring her that I mean every word, maybe even a little bit more. Adora smiles back and I feel her relax.

“Now how about getting some sleep. We've had a long day, maybe even few long weeks and we have a big day tomorrow. I think someone needs her *beauty* sleep?”

Adora giggles and simply nods her head in response. Even when she’s tired she beautiful, it’s no secret.

Adora starts to climb under the blanket and I’m not far behind. I’ve been sleeping next to her since our first night together in her new quarters. We’ve both slept better when I’m not at her feet. Why that is I don’t exactly know, but I don’t care. I like being close to her.

Adora lays her head on my chest and wraps her arms around me. I tuck the blanket tightly around us both before wrapping one of my arms around her shoulders and using my other hand to lace our fingers together. We seem to be doing that a lot lately. Once settled I start to purr and we both find sleep within a matter of minutes. We'll have to wait to see what tomorrow brings.

Chapter End Notes

Hope you enjoyed Chapter 5. Sorry this Chapter is a little bit slower compared to the others but I promise it's necessary for what's to come in the story. Please let me know what you thought in the comments. I love hearing what you think about the fic. In Chapter 6 we finally visit Dryl. I wonder what will happen? See you on Friday :)

P.S - Chapter 6 may be a late night update (dependent on where you live) as I'm at work all day but I'll get it uploaded ASAP :)

Dryl

Chapter Summary

Catra and Adora arrive at Dryl.

Entrapta's security system is highly advanced.

Lord Hordak makes his debut.

** Chapter/Creator Warnings: Blood & Injury**

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Look at this places. It's practically a dead zone."

Adora's right. There are no signs of life anywhere, well that's apart from a few critters running around here and there and our team *obviously*. Other than that this place is the literal definition of a dead zone.

"Are… are you sure we're on the right track?" Kyle asks. To be honest I'm questioning our decision as to why we elected him to join the force team we decided to take with us. He's been a nervous wreck all the way here.

"Of course we're on the right track. My wildcat knows exactly where she's going."

I've lost count of how many times I've told Scorpia to stop calling me that. To be honest, between the bone crushing hugs and that nickname, I gladly stick with the name *'wildcat'*. Adora likes the nickname, she says it suits me, matches my personality and attitude.

"Hey?" Adora whispers besides me… "You sure we're on the right track?"

“Yes Adora, for that third time I’m certain. In a moment or two we should be able to see…”

We come to a sudden halt as we turn the corner. There is it standing before us, the Crypto Castle.

“Looks like we’re here. Told you’d I knew where we were heading.”

I turn to Adora with a devilish smirk. She should know by now that I’m *always* right and she should trust my instincts.

Behind us Rogelio gruff and roars, “Graw, gruff, raw, graw?”

“What did he just say?” I ask. Now I remembered why we brought Kyle. He’s the only one who can fully understand Rogelio, well other than Lonnie that is who can translate some of his words for us. But believe me, between Lonnie and Kyle I think it was a very obvious reason why I preferred Kyle to be with us.

“He asked what’s the plan?”

Kyle looks up to Rogelio and Rogelio looks down to Kyle. They seem to spend a lot of time together. I recon there is something more going on between those two.

“Catra and I are going to enter the Crypto castle and search the area for any signs of life. Our orders are to locate the princess and make her a member of the Horde. Lord Hordak believes she’ll be useful for developing our weapons system.”

Adora then turns to face the team behind us.

“Your orders are to guard the surrounding area of the castle doors and its boundaries. The first signs of trouble you should alert us immediately. We don't know what to expect so you have to be on high alert at all time.”

Her force captain voice is impressive, who knew she could be so assertive, *I like it.* Once everyone is clear with their orders we

enter the castle grounds.

--

This place is seriously creeping me out and we’re not even inside the castle yet. I’m glad my mane coves the back of my neck, I can feel my hackles rising. We're about in the center of the castle grounds when my ears twitch, picking up the faintest of sounds.

“Did you hear that?”

The team stops dead in their tracks.

“Hear what?” Adora asks. Silence… but then I hear it again but it’s louder this.

I turn to face the direction of the sound. Two red eyes glare back at us. I growl, claws outstretched prepared for an attack. Adora extends her staff and stands at the side of me. I can't get a clear look at it but I don't dare step forward, not just yet...

“INTRUDER ALERT! INTRUDER ALERT!”

Sirens and red lights start going of everywhere…

“KYLE WHAT DID YOU DO?!

“What! I-I didn’t do anything.”

“No time for that… CATRA LOOK OUT!”

Adora alerts me as the creature charges towards us. Before I can get a good look at it Adora pushes me out of the way and blocks the incoming attack. The creature jumps onto her but she manages to ‘kick-flip’ it over to Scorpia who uses her tail to swing the creature into a nearby wall. Metal starts to break off it. Whatever it was meant to represent, it was as clearly a robot that

is no longer functioning. I find my feet and climb onto a high stack of boxes to my side. Up here I can clearly see what's going on. There appears to be a square box on the ground like an... *an arena boundary?*

Wait a minute, arena type boundary… alarm systems… robotics?

"EVERYONE GET OFF THE GROUND! GET OUT OF THE BOX! YOU'RE IN A BATTLE ARENA!"

As a shout to warn the others more robots appear from all directions. They're all various shapes and sizes, some even seem to represent animals but they're much bigger than the creatures they're meant to represent. Some battle each other, others target our team. Kyle and Rogelio have managed to make it out of the arena and Scorpia isn't too far behind. Adora however is struggling. They all seem to be going after her but she's strong and takes each one down like a true warrior.

Just when we think it's over, something emerges from the ground behind her. The shake of the earth causes her to stumble as fierce shadow looms over her. It's a giant robotic scorpion like creature.

"Adora, behind you!"

She turns and uses her staff to block the blow from the robots tail as it tries to crush her with its sting. Unfortunately, the impact instantly causes her staff to snap. The stinger only just misses her head. As the creature rears to take another strike, I pounce forward onto the robots eye, causing it to stumble backwards.

"Get into the castle, I'll catch up!" I shout back to her, narrowly missing the creatures pincers that tries to grab me.

"No, I'm not leaving you!"

Adora starts to run to me but is stopped in her tracks when the scorpion like creature's stinger hits the ground. It's trapped, its stinger is stuck in the hard earth. The rest of the team, *even Kyle*, run to the creature to help me disable it.

“You guys go ahead, we’ll take care of this.” Scorpia’s order.

I’m not leaving without giving this creature a piece of my mind. Using my claws I smash into the creatures robotic eye removing as many wires as possible. The robot shrills as if it were in pain and manages to grip me by my arm with one of it pincers, before hurling me towards the castle doors. It hit the wall with a thud… *guess it saves me from running over here*.

Adora darts over to me and helps me to my feet. We enter the castle and slam the doors shut behind us. We'll be safe in here... *for now.*

--

“Adora how many times do I have to tell you I’m fine? It’s just a little cut. It'll scar over.”

The creature has left a deep cut in my upper right arm. Adora has created a makeshift bandage with some material she found lying around. At least it’s stopped the bleeding for now.

“I don’t like it when you get hurt because of me.”

“Seriously Adora it's not that big of a deal. We look out for each other remember? If you’re that worried about me I’ll let you clean it up and strap it up properly when we get back to the Fright Zone. Now can you let it drop so we can get back to trying to locate the princess?”

It’s like a labyrinth in here. We have literally no idea where we are or where we’re going. If someone can send us a…

Adora pushes me into a gap between two walls, pushing us close together. *Now this is interesting.*

“Adora what are you…”

“Shh!”

Adora forces her hand over my mouth so I can’t speak. *Not where I thought this was going but alright.* Then I understand why. A robot in the form of a butler rolls past us carrying a tray of soda and… *are those mini cupcakes?*

“ -- ------ ------ --”

“What? Oh sorry.” Adora removes her hand. Finally I can breathe.

“I said we should follow it. It may lead us to the princess.”

Adora doesn’t look overly impressed but agrees with me after some persuasion. We follow the robot at a safe distance. We head down a few corridors we have already been through and some new secret passages we hadn’t yet discovered.

--

We eventually reach a tall metal door. I haven’t seen this one before so we must be in the right place. The robot enters the room. I quickly pull Adora into the room with me and hide us both behind a stack of crates. There seems to be a lot of crates around here, not to mention all the creepy robot parts that are hanging from the ceiling.

“Ah perfect. This is just what I need to refuel my energy supplies to continue my research. It has become so much easier having my robots deliver my food sources over my original butler.”

“Is that the princesses?” Adora whispers.

“I think it might be. Now we just have to figure out how to get her attention.”

The robot exits the room, leaving us trapped in here. The princess lowers her mask and starts talking into some sort of recorder that’s held by her hair as she works. *Is her hair magic or 'adapted' through science?*

“Entry log 6785, robotic attempt 098. Subject appears...”

“She seems harmless. If we need her on our side we should maybe try reasoning with her.”

Wait did Adora actually suggest something smart?

I turn to look at her, eye wide staring at her.

“What?” she asks.

“Who are you and what did you do with the real Adora?”

Adora starts to giggle under her breathe. “Come on Catra, it’s worth a shot.”

As much as I would rather approach with the 'controlling the situation' plan Adora has a very good point. She seems harmless and if we need her on our side we might as well make a good first impression. Adora and I start to slowly approach the princesses. She hasn’t seen us or so we thought.

“Give me a minute and I’ll be right with you.”

Adora and I look at each other with a blank expression. *How did she know we were here?*

“I saw you on my surveillance cameras up there.” A free stand of hair point to a video screen in the top right hand corner. Sure enough we can see that the strike team have taken down the robotic scorpion and are standing guard. “I also saw you sneak in through the door.”

Okay can she read minds or something?! How does she know what I'm thinking?

The princess turns towards us and sits on her hair that has made itself into a makeshift chair.

"Hello. So what can I do for you?"

Adora is the one who chooses to speak.

"Entrapta isn't it? You're a scientist we've been told about."

"Well scientist is such a generalized term. It could mean anything. I'm more of a first-one technology experimental scientist but you can call me Entrapta… who is she?"

One strand of her hair is now pointing towards me. *Why do I feel intimidated?*

"This is Catra. She's my second in command. I'm Adora, the Force Captain of the strike team out there. We were sent here on behalf of the Horde…"

"Oh I know you're from the Horde. The symbol on your badge told me that. I'm fascinated by the technology you use for your robotics but it is a bit out of date. If I could have a sample of your technology I'm sure I could boost their efficiency by at least 30% to start with."

Okay well at least we have now established that she's not a threat and she seems interest in Horde technology. This could work out easier than we initially thought. I decide to speak next.

"Lord Hordak wants to recruit you to help develop our weaponry. But that's not the only reason we're here. No one else knows about this so you can't tell anyone."

I slightly growl at the end of my statement and show her what Adora refers to as my... *sigh* *'Angry Catra Face'*. I think the princess gets the message as she looks a bit shocked but allows

me to continue... "We need you to create a secure communications line on this tracker pad. The other pad that it is connect too should already be a part of it. We need a secure line so…"

Before I can finish my sentence she takes the tracked pad out of my hand and sets off to work. *Well that was easy enough*. A few minutes pass. Adora and I keep looking at each other unsure of what to say.

"Here you go."

Entrapta throws the tracker pad back to me. I catch it mid-air before it can fall to the ground and smash. Good job I have quick reflexes.

"It's now connected so that only yourselves and the other pad can have access to the data you send through it. That means it's a secure line. Now when can we leave? I want to get into your robotic systems as soon as possible. Also you should really get that checked out."

This time she actually uses her hand to address the cut on my arm. My hand darts to my arm to cover the bandaged wound, a little bit of blood has seeped through but not to much.

"Let's just get out of here. The sooner we're back at the Fright Zone the better."

As we exit the building with Entrapta in tow, Scorpia informs us that Lord Hordak would like to speak to us both… *in person.*

--

Adora and I both walk into Lord Hordak's *'sanctum'* as we call it. There are only two times I've known people to be summoned

here:

1) you're watching someone receive their punishment.

or

2) you're the one receiving the punishment.

When we reach the top of the stairs we both bow out of respect to Lord Hordak himself. Shadow Weaver is standing to his left.

Adora is the one to address him. "You requested to see us Lord Hordak?"

Silence. If I wasn't tense before I most certainly am now.

"Rise Force Captain Adora."

Adora rises but I stay knelt on the ground.

Don't slip up. For once be the prefect soldier.

Hordak continues to speak...

"I'm impressed with how far you have come as a Force Captain. I was unsure about promoting you but Shadow Weaver insisted that it would benefit the Horde immensely. I can confirm that I was not disappointed. If anything, I'm impressed. Your squadron has some of the strongest members on record and it was proven today by how your elected team members attacked Dryl's robotics, especially you Catra."

Wait did he just say my name? How does he know about the robotic attacks?

I then hear footsteps approaching me. I risk gazing up to find him looking down at me. I don't dare hesitate and I rise to meet his gaze. *Is this a good sign or a bad sign?*

"You Catra have proven yourself to be a valuable member of the Horde. I'm impressed with how far you have come, especially

considering the *'rumors'* that I have heard. You have proven your worth for the Horde when you attacked the robotic creature back in Dryl and protected not only your team but your force captain. Entrapta showed us the recording of the attack on arrival to show me how we could improve our own robotics and weaponry."

Shadow Weaver is clearly not impressed, but she can't say anything against him.

"I've come to the decision to promote you both for your efforts. Adora you are now ranked as Commander. Catra, you will take Adora's place as Force Captain."

He hands me a force captain badge. As he does Shadow Weaver immediately protests…

"My Lord *you* cannot do this! Catra has caused nothing but trouble since her arrival. One successful attack on a robot proves nothing…"

"SILENCE!" His voice bellows through the room. He changes position and looms over Shadow Weaver. I've never seen her look so scared in her life.

"If I wanted *your* opinion I would have asked for it. Catra's records have shown she's made incredible progress since her training was put in Adora's hands. She seemed to be *'slacking'* because of *your* training methods. I suggest you amend your ways Shadow Weaver. I want all our troops to be as strong as their squadron before we pursue our attack on Salineas. Only the strongest will succeed. Do I make myself clear?

"Yes my Lord."

Hordak shoves Shadow Weaver by the shoulder before returning to his throne.

"Now, Adora you will still have access to your old quarters. Catra we will have yours set up tomorrow."

Before he can continue Adora speaks…

“Lord Hordak… if I may I would like to make a suggestion.”

“Proceed.”

“I have given Catra access to my quarters so we could discuss and plan the most effective way to train our team. If Catra wants, I would like to suggest that I share my quarters with her. This will allow us to plan our training strategies and battle formations more effectively.”

There is a moments silence and then he addresses me directly.

“Is this what you want, Catra?”

I waste no time in giving him my response, “Yes Lord Hordak. I believe this will enable us to be more efficient.”

Another moments passes, then he speaks.

“I don’t usually allow this. You both know very well that fraternization amongst soldiers is strictly forbidden. However, you have both proven yourselves worthy and I doubt such as thing would occur between my strongest and most loyal soldiers. I will accept your request and grant Catra permission to share your quarters. I expect great thing from you both and your team. Remember with great success, comes great rewards. You are dismissed.”

We both saluted before exiting the chamber and head back to what is now our quarters.

--

“Can you believe it! You’re final a Force Captain. Catra I’m so proud of you.” Adora practically screams as she pulls me into a tight hug, lifting me off the ground.

We’ve just got back to her quarters, now *our* quarters, after visiting the medical bay to get my arm stitched up and properly bandaged. It should heal over in a few days.

“Says you. Adora you’re a commander now. At this rate you might as well be the Hordes Second-in-Command.”

She places me back down on the floor but keeps hold of me for a few moments more. It’s weird not having to enter this room through the air vents. It’s nice knowing I can now come and go as I please without the fear of getting caught.

We eventually separate and get ready for bed. We have alerted our team of where I now am should they need me, *not that they will but you never know*. Turns out I wasn’t as sneaky as I thought. They all noticed that I sneak out during the night but didn’t want to say anything.

I lie down on my pillow next to Adora. She seizes the first opportunity she has to pull me into a hug. I don’t think I’ve ever purred this loud in my life.

“Let me guess, I’m warm and fluffy?”

Adora hums in response and pulls me even closer to her, not that I’m sure that’s even possible. She eventually loosens her grip.

“Thanks for saving me from that Scorpion earlier today. I didn’t get the opportunity to thank you earlier.”

“Which scorpion are we on about: the big scary one or the Force Captain down the corridors?”

Adora laughs and punches me in the shoulder for good measure.

“Hey watch the arm. I almost *died* trying to save you from that thing.”

Now we’re both laughing. It’s one of those belly laughs when you can’t stop and when you do it starts again. I end up lying on my back in an attempt to ease my laughter. We eventually settle down and I’m able to catch my breathe. Just as I’m about to dose off to sleep Adora speaks.

“By the way did I tell you how proud I am of my best friend?”

I suppose I can tease her a bit before I fall asleep.

“Do I know who this person is?”

“You should do. She smart, witty, has a bit of an attitude but most importantly has a big heart, even though she won’t admit it.”

Adora lightly chuckles and I can see a smile creeping up the side of her face. I turn on to my side so I’m now facing her. Stars she beautiful, if only she knew how much she means to me. She takes my hand in hers, pulls it close to her chest and puts her forehead against mine. Maybe she does know this is my way of showing love.

“I’m really proud of you Catra. You should be too. I know how hard you’ve worked for this.”

A smiles creeps across my face and I start to purr again. “I am proud. ‘Force Captain Catra’ has a nice ring to it don’t you think… I’m proud of you too. Only you would be promoted to commander not long after becoming a Force Captain.”

“I couldn’t have done it without you.” Adora responds. I feel my cheeks starting to blush. I curl up next to Adora, burying my face against her chest. I hope she hasn’t noticed my cheeks reddening.

That night we both fall asleep held tight in each other’s arms.

Chapter End Notes

Hope you enjoyed reading Chapter 6. Thank you for all your kind words last week. Please let me know what you thought of this chapter. I love hearing what you guys think of the fic and where you think things are heading.

The adventure continues on Monday when Chapter 7 - 'Sting of Emotions' - is published. Things are starting to get very real. :)

Sting of Emotions

Chapter Summary

Catra gives an update on what has happened since her promotion.

Scorpia and Catra have a chat.

Catra has something she wants to say to Adora.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Many months have passed since we conquered Dryl and Adora and I got promoted. Quite a few things have happened in that time. We successfully made contact with the Rebellion and have been making them aware of Hordak's plans to eventually attack Salineas. We also reported a few other places on the list to attack before then. We managed to take down Plumeria but they didn't put up much of a fight, it was an easy take. The Kingdom of Snows was a little more difficult and despite not yet taking the castle we've *successfully* taken Rebellion territory. Entrapta and Hordak have been working in close partnership to improve our weapons systems. I very often see her climbing through the vents jabbering on about some technology nonsense. We put their new robots to the test when we proceeded with our attack on Elberon and certain areas of the Crimson Waste. They worked brilliantly. They did try and experiment with the Black Garnet but backed down due to uncontrollable electrical power. They're working on solving it. Scorpia eventually accepted that I'm not interested in her and abandoned her pursuit to *'impress'* me. However, since she realized that my heart belongs to Adora she's been on a mission to get me to admit my feelings to her. Adora and I have been working on improving our teams battle tactics. Hordak has been that impressed that he has already selected our whole squadron to be one of those that take over Salineas. Despite all

the positives, unfortunately the situation with Shadow Weaver hasn't gotten any better since my promotion. If anything it's gotten worse, but it doesn't matter, I can take it. It's not like anything is ever going to change anyway. As long as I have Adora with me I'll be fine.

Today is the day we attack Salineas. The Horde haven't made any major pursuits for the past month in order to prepare for today's attack. We got confirmation from princess Sparkles last night that the Rebellion have evacuated as many citizens as possible but many are choosing to stay and fight for their homeland. She also informed us that the Rebellion will be prepared to attack upon our arrival. Before ending the call she told us to be careful. She almost sounded like she cared.

I can't be bothered with today. I'm exhausted and my body aches. Shadow Weaver's `*training efforts´* have been intensified to *'cure me from my weaknesses'*. That's what she's told Lord Hordak. If only he could see the scars that are left behind. Maybe then he'd realize that even she is manipulating him. I've ended up having to remove my grey ear tuffs, or at least what was left of them. This week that bitch ripped one of them off as a form of punishment, that was painful. I'm surprised she didn't rip my ear off in the process. Adora has tried again and again to free me from the witches grasp. So much so Shadow Weaver has started to punish Adora, *her star student*, but her scars never go as deep as mine. We both help each other tend to our wounds and keep reminding ourselves that this will all be over soon… what more can we do?

--

"Catra, it's time to wake up." Adora whispers as she gently nudges me to wake up.

Sleeping next to Adora has been so much better than sleeping at her feet. Spending more time with her has definitely had a strong effect on my feelings for her. I've tried to tell her the truth a few times now, but everytime I've tried she's been called to attend some bullshit meeting about the Horde's future battle plans. Sadly everytime she returns I lose the courage to tell her. I've even asked Scorpia for advice. She's actually not as annoying as I initially thought. We've become a lot closer since I took over Adora's previous position. She's actually quite a good friend.

"Five more minutes." I mumble as roll onto my stomach placing my face flat into my pillow. I hear Adora chuckle softly. She's up to something.

"Okay but don't blame me when... IS THAT A MOUSE?!"

"WHAT! WHERE?"

I jump up onto all fours ready to pounce, my tail fluffed up, ears on alert, claws at the ready. *Where are you, you little shit? I'm going to get you this time!*

Adora is in hysterics. She's wraps her arms around my waist to keep herself balanced. *Wait, there is no mouse is there*? I relax and sit back on my knees so I'm facing her. I'm too tired for this shit but I love seeing her laugh.

"Are you ever *not* going to fall for that?"

"I don't know. Are *you* ever going to let it go. That was one time."

Adora's laughter slowly starts to subside, she wipes a few tears from her eyes. My tail swishes around playfully. *Two can play at that game.* She sees the devilish smirk that has started to creep across my face.

"What?"

Before she can brace for an attack I pounce onto her pinning her to the bed. I then straddle her hips and start tickling her.

“Catra, *ha, no, ah, stop, hah,* Catra that tickles!”

“You should have seen this coming Adora. This is payback for the mouse bullshit you keep trying to pull.”

I continue to tickle her. She even tries to tickle me back, she knows I’m ticklish near my hips. I lose focus for one minute and she flips me off her, now she straddling me. *I like this view.* Adora starts to tickle me.

“*Ah,* Adora. *Ha…* Okay, Okay I surrender have mercy.”

Adora releases me and rolls off me on to her side. We’re still laughing but not as much.

“You awake now?” She asks as she brushes a strand of hair from my mane out of my eyes.

“What do you think?”

Adora smiles and takes my hand in hers. She gives it a gentle squeak, I can’t tell something is on her mind.

“You feeling okay?” I ask slightly concerned.

“Yeah... no... I don't know. I'm just nervous I guess. Terrified if I’m being honest.”

For a moment our room falls silent. I move closer to her and rest my head against her chest and wrap my arms around her. I can her her heart beating a thousand beats per minute. Adora proceeds to wrap her arms around me and rests head on top of mine.

“Me too.”

We stay like that for a while, holding each other, comforting each other. We have nowhere important to be yet. *Would now be a good time to tell her how I feel about her?*

“As much as I love being this close to you, I have a final battle preparations meeting I have to be at in ten minutes. I would gladly skip it but it’s kind of important. Are you going to be okay?”

I know what the meeting is about and it’s important that she attends. We’re getting our new battle uniforms today. Our uniforms have been designed to strike fear into our enemy’s hearts and allow us to attack efficiently. My uniform has one long black sleeve along my right arm, a separate piece as shoulder supports, and cut off legging that attach to my shorts and go around my feet so I can run and jump effectively. I’m more excited to see Adora’s reaction this new *‘boob window’*, I imagine she’ll be flustered at the sight. I have yet to see Adora’s uniform. I have been told she has a sword or blade that has been designed by Entrapta and our squadrons’ team member Delta.

“Ye I’ll be fine. I’ve arranged to meet with Scorpia once I’ve got my new uniform on anyway.”

That is only part of the truth. What she really wants to know is if I have told Adora about my feeling for her yet. As part of her mission, she’s helped me realize that my feelings for Adora don’t make me weak, they make me strong. We’ve become quite good friends. She’s even started calling us the 'Superpal Trio' since Entrapta started to join us during our breaks. They clicked a lot better than when I first met Scorpia, it’s probably because they have similar personalities.

“You and Scorpia seem to be hanging out together a lot more. It’s nice to see you two getting on with each other. I know you weren’t keen on her to begin with but I’m glad you’ve worked things out. Should I be jealous?”

“Nah you’re alright. She just nice to talk to when you’re not around. Besides, you give far better hugs.” I respond in a flirtatious voice as I move to pull Adora into a tight hug. My tail gently wrapping around her calf as her arms wrap around me back.

Adora chuckles, “Well that’s good to know. I’ll see you in a bit alright. I can’t wait to see what you look like in your new outfit.”

“Right back at you. Now get going before your late.”

Adora turns to wave at me before she exits our quarters and heads down the corridor.

--

I leave our quarters about five minutes after Adora. I have arranged to meet Scorpia at our Force Captain Orientation meeting. I usually skip them but today is important. I enter to room and see Scorpia already waiting for me.

“Hey Wildcat… ***long whistle***,* looking good in the new outfit.”

“Thanks Scorpia. Never thought a bit of a costume change would make me feel so… **Powerful!**”

I don’t know why but my outfit makes me feel stronger, important and fearless. Maybe it’s the colours, they can be quite intimidating. It may even be the way it allows my most powerful features to be recognized.

Scorpia doesn’t have anything new on her, she’s still in her old uniform.

“How come you don’t have a new uniform?”

“Oh I don’t need one. My outer shell is pretty much the toughest type of uniform there is. Not to mention this stringer and these bad boys and give quite a firm punch.” She exaggerates her statement by rattling her stinger and closing her claws together a few times. “By the way how did things go with Adora last night. Did you finally tell her?”

Before I can respond the sergeant enters to room. “Alright Captains, listen up, we have work to do.”

“I’ll tell you later.” I whisper to her. We take our seats awaiting for our sergeant to go through our orders.

--

“What do you mean you didn’t tell her? You were so confident when we last spoke about it. What happened? ”

Scorpia looks confused and devastated. Our meeting literally ended one minute ago and the first thing she literally asks me about is Adora. Not that I mind talking about Adora, to be real with you Adora is the only thing on my mind like 24/7.

“I don’t know. I was ready to tell her and then I just couldn’t. I froze, my mind went blank.”

I feel so stupid. Why is it so hard to tell her how I feel about her? Surely it shouldn’t be this hard. My ears lower flat against the back of my head, my tail instinctively wraps around my leg and my arms move to hug myself.

“Scorpia… is there something wrong with me?”

I don’t know where that came from, it just appeared and it needed to ask it. I’m so conflicted with my emotions. One minute I feel strong and confident enough to tell her, the next minute I feel like the world is crushing in on me and I don’t deserve her.

Scorpia lifts me into a bone crushing hug that was not prepared for.

“Oh Wildcat. There is nothing wrong with you. Telling someone that you have feelings for them like you have feelings for Adora is

never easy. It’s scary, sometimes terrifying. But it’s worth it, especially when they feel the same way.”

"But I don't know if Adora feels the same way about me. I'm scared I'll ruin what we have. What if I tell her and I screw it up and she never wants to see me or speak to me again?"

Scorpia places me back on the ground before responding...

"Adora isn't that type of person Catra but I can't tell you how she feels about you because even I don't know. It's just a risk you have to take. It's a risk of being in love. The only way to ever find out is to open your heart and yeah it's scary but it may be worth it in the end. You'll never know unless you give it a try. You just have to be brave enough to tell Adora how you truly feel about her.”

“Thanks Scorpia. I needed to hear that.”

“Anytime Wildcat.”

--

We continue our journey to the vehicle bay. All of our robotics, vehicles and weaponry is there ready waiting for us. Adora and I arranged to meet each other here as there was no point in heading back to our quarters when we’d be getting ready to set off after our final meeting.

“Hey Wildcat.”

“Yeah Scorpia?”

“Look, I don’t want to pressure you or anything but I… well… I’d encourage you to tell Adora how you feel about her before we get to Salineas.”

A bit of an odd thing to say, especially coming from Scorpia. Her expression and posture is trying to tell me something, but I'm not sure what. I don't need to ask what she means, I can tell she's going to speak again.

"I, uh… wow this is hard. Right okay. Conquering Salineas is a huge step for us but it isn't going to be easy. There is no guarantee we'll succeed. Last time we had a big battle like this not everyone came back. It's how I lost my grandpa. He was all I had left, he meant a lot to me. I've also heard many stories from troops coming back regretting a lot of things that they had and hadn't said or done. I'm not saying that any of that will happen for you or Adora, I really hope it doesn't and everything works out how it should for you. I just… I don't want you to regret not telling her that you love her."

My heart sank. I hadn't considered looking at it that way. Sure I'm aware that some soldiers may not come home but I never really thought of it being a possibility. I need to find Adora, I need to find Adora and tell her now!

"Thanks Scorpia. I've got to go. If you see Adora tell her I'm looking for her."

Before Scorpia can respond I run off to start my own search for her.

--

I eventually find her. She's standing with our squadron both old and new. They're all suited up, ready for battle.

"Adora, there's something I need to… wow you look, incredible."

Her uniform is similar to what she normally wears but better. Her standard Horde jacket colours have been revamped. Rather than

the classic red and white it is now black with the lapels being a maroonish-red colour, the Horde symbol printed on the back. She's also wearing forearm plates that are silver with a green like diamond shape going across the middle. Then I notice sword that Delta and Entrapta have created for her. It has a silver hilt with the Horde symbol at its center. Delta informs me that one press of the symbol will make the blade shorter and longer at will so it can be carried as a small dagger if needed. Entrapta altered Adora's uniform once her sword was made so she could either hold it as a sword across her back or at the side of her leg when in its dagger form.

"Thanks. You don't look to bad yourself. Do you like the new sword?" Adora asks as she throws it to me. She blushes slightly, the *'boob window'* is definitely responsible for that.

"Like it… I love it. Delta and Entrapta have really outdone themselves." I say as I hand the sword back to her.

Aren't you meant to be telling her something?

"Adora, do you think we could talk somewhere in private for a moment, please?"

"Yeah sure."

Adora sends our squadron off to their certified ships. Once she's sure they're gone she directs me away from the crowds. It's now or never.

"Are you okay? Is something wrong? What did Shadow Weaver do?"

"No Adora, everything's fine. I just really need to tell you something."

I start to tremble. Adora takes my hands and gives them a squeeze to gently reassure me. She smiles and looks at me with those beautiful blue eyes.

“Adora, I…”

“EVERYONE PREPARE FOR BATTLE. WE LEAVE IN ONE MINUTE!”

Stupid fucking sirens!

Cadets start to run past us getting into tanks and onto skiff, preparing to load them onto the ships. The moments gone.

“Promise me you’ll tell me later okay.” Adora says, she refuses to let go of my hands just yet. Her grip is tight as ever.

“I promise.”

My heart is racing, my fur is standing on end. I’m terrified. I can tell Adora feels the exact same way. She pulls me into what must be the tightest hug she's ever given. I hold her close, refusing to let go, my claw pricking slightly into her jacket. We reluctantly have to part. Before she leaves Adora takes my face in her hands and places our foreheads together. I place my hands over hers. She trembling, her eyes show fear. She scared, we're both scared.

“Stay safe.”

Despite her sergeant calling her to get onto the ship I know she won’t leave until I answer her.

“I will, I promise. Promise me you’ll stay safe too.”

“I promise.”

I didn’t expect what came next. Before removing her hands form holding her face, she gently tilts my head downwards and places a gentle kiss to my forehead. She lingers there for a moment or two before pulling away. Our hands remain holding each others until we physically have to let go. I watch her get onto her boat before I turn around to head to mine. Scorpia is already there waiting for me. I turn to face Adora’s boat before we set sail. She’s far away in the distance, too far away for her to hear what I wanted to tell her even if I shouted.

Even though the ship is full, I feel alone. The rest of the crew are already preparing for battle. As we set sail, I whisper under my breath the words that I wanted to say to Adora - “Stay Safe… I love you.”

Chapter End Notes

Hope you enjoyed reading this chapter. Please feel free to leave you thoughts in the comments. I love hearing what you think will happen as this fic gets update. In Chapter 8 we arrive at Salineas, what do you think will happen? See you on Friday :)

P.S - Chapter 8 may be a late night update (dependent on where you live) as I'm at work all day but I'll get it uploaded ASAP :)

Salineas

Chapter Summary

The battle of Salineas take place.

Scorpia has been keeping a secret from Catra.

Catra hates water!

Chapter/Creator Warnings: Description of Battlefield Scenes (Graphic-ish), Blood & Injury, Fire, Scars

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Why are we doing this? Do we have to do this? Sure conquering Salineas would be a huge gain for the Horde but is it really worth it? How am I meant to go through with this? I need to protect…

"Hey Catra, there you are. I've been looking everywhere for you. Are you okay?"

Scorpia? I was hoping she wouldn't find me. We're not far from Salineas now. About five minutes from being in Rebellions sight and making our presence known. Since we left port I've been hiding behind a few of the stacked barrels on the boat, trying to pull myself together. Why am I so scared about this? I've been training for missions like this my whole life. I know Salineas is much more advance than Thaymor and the other areas we have battled but surely I shouldn't be feeling like this. Scorpia takes a seat next to me when I don't respond. I bring my knees to my chest and wrap my tail around them trying to be as small as possible.

"I can tell somethings bothering you Wildcat. You know you can talk to me, well that's if you feel like you can". Scorpia looks at me with an encouraging smile.

Over the past few months I have grown closer to Scorpia and I have mentioned to Adora probably letting her in on our plan. After all she feels the exact same way about the Horde and this war as we do. The only reason she's here is because she feels it's her duty to be a part of the Horde to keep her family honor. Sometimes I wonder if her grandpa gave the Horde the Black Garnet willingly or if it is all just a cover up story to hide the truth from her about what really happened. I decide not to say anything, to be fair I'm not even sure what I can say or how to tell her.

"You know I think it's time I let you in on a little secret. Well, I guess it's not really a secret if you also know about it." Scorpia chuckles nervously. She raises her claw to rub the back of her neck. Now she's got my attention. I look up at her with a neutral expression waiting for her to continue.

Scorpia takes a deep breathe… "I know about the plan to end the war by taking down the Horde from the inside."

She what?! How does she know? How did she find out?

"Adora told me. But before you get mad hear me out."

Mad, me mad. I'm not mad, maybe a little frustrated. Ugh I'm so confused right now. Why would Adora tell Scorpia and not tell me about it?

"Alright, I'm listening."

"Adora told me because she felt it was the best thing to do after you mentioned filling me in on the plan. She also said that I had told you that I feel the same way about the war, which I 100% do. I sometimes feel that there is more my story that the Horde is keeping hidden from me. Some things I've been told about my life before them and after them don't add up. I want to know the truth and that's why I want in on this secret mission. We didn't tell you as we didn't want you to freak you out. But I want you to

know that am I aware of the plan and I will do everything I can to help you end this war."

As relieved as I am to know that I can fully trust Scorpia I can tell she holding something back from me. What did Adora ask of her?

"Scorpia, what are you not telling me?"

She takes a deep breath and sighs… "Adora made me promise that if anything ever happens to her… not that it will and I hope it doesn't… that I'll protect no matter what."

Of course she would, typical Adora. She always puts others before herself. Why can't she look out for herself for once. She doesn't have to play the hero. I don't know if I'd be able to go on without her… I'd never leave her behind.

"I can't lose her Scorpia. She is all I have, she means everything to me. I will do anything I can to protect her. I'm not going to lose her like I lost my family… she is my family. She's all I have left."

Scorpia pulls me into a tight hug and for once I don't fight it, I hug her back. She may not be Adora but right now I need to be grounded from my thoughts. Besides, she's good at giving hugs. I can only hope that everything will turn out as it should.

--

WATER! I hate water. I only tolerate it when I have to but this whole place is surrounded by it. To make matters worse, their fucking princess can control water. `*Thanks for the heads up Sparkles'*. I'm sure she's managed to catch me twice with what can only be described as a *'cyclone of the sea'*. They're putting up a really good fight, a little too good. I've managed to obtain a few scratches and bruises from their attacks, nothing to serious but I'll more than likely feel it in the morning.

Some of the sights in front of me are all too familiar. People running and screaming, the fires, the tanks, the Horde flags… *the blood*. I'm shaking, my vision blaring, my pulse rate picking up in speed.

*Come on snap out of it! That was then, this is now. Remember you are not the enemy****. The Horde is the enemy****. Calm yourself down and find Adora!*

Adora? I need to find Adora!

I snap back to reality and start to sprint through the flames. I need to find her. I need to protect her. I hope she's okay.

The heat from the flames is hot against my fur. I'm surprised I haven't caught fire yet. I try my best to ignore the sights and sounds around me but then I hear something, something that I can't ignore… "PLEASE HELP ME! ANYONE PLEASE!"

I don't recognize the voice but it clearly belongs to a child. I skid along the floor from how fast I was running, eventually coming to a stop. I move my ears in all directions trying to pinpoint the location of the sound. I hear them again and then I spot them, a young kid trapped beneath the rubble of a destroy house. Fire is spreading quickly, I have to help them before it's too late.

"Don't panic. I'm going to get you out of there."

I need to be careful about how I do this. If I move the wrong piece of wood the rest of the rubble will collapse onto us both. I try lifting the rubble with all my strength but I'm not strong enough to do this on my own. Scorpia, she's not too far away.

"SCORPIA!"

Scorpia hears my call and runs over to help me lift the remaining debris. We can see them clearly now. They're the same species as Octavia only small and innocent, they're terrified.

“We’re not going to hurt you. We’re not like to others. You might want to get out of here before they arrive.” I reassure and order them at the same time but in a calm tone, but somethings wrong.

“I can’t move. My leg, it’s trapped.”

Shit. What we going to do? Sparkles! She can’t be too far from here. I saw her not too long ago. The flames are moving fast. I’ll have to make this quick.

“Scorpia, can you hold this for a few more minutes? I’m going to go and get help.”

I can see she’s struggling but determine not to let go. “Sure thing Wildcat. Just don’t take too long.” She responds through the grit of her teeth.

I release the side of the wood that I have hold of, allowing Scorpia to take the whole weight. Thank stars she’s strong. I run in the direction that I last saw Sparkles. The scenes in front of me continues to unfold. The Horde continues to make further ground.

I see a puff of glitter just a few feet in front of me.

“SPARKLES!”

Fuck, I forgot we’re supposed to be enemies out here. She disappears and then reappears next to me before teleporting us both to a location out of the Horde’s sight. Oh shit that was awful, I feel like I’m about to throw up.

“What the fuck are you doing? You could have just blown our whole mission.”

“I need your help. There is a kid trapped under some rubble near the houses on fire. They’re stuck. We have to help them.”

Before I can say another word Sparkles grabs my arm and teleports us back to the wreckage. Wish she'd give me some sort of warning.

“Over here!” Scorpia calls. I run over to her taking back some of the weight.

Sparkles is suspicious. Oh right, she might not know Scorpia’s on our side.

“It’s okay, Scorpia’s with me. She’s on our side. I’ll explain later but right now we don’t have much time.”

Sparkles simply nods at the fact and brushes her nerves aside. The fire is fast approaching.

“Can you lift it any higher? I need to try and un-trap their leg before teleporting them away.”

With one last push Scorpia and I give it all our might to lift the rubble higher. Sparkles successfully teleports the kid away but as she does some of rubble starts to collapse.

“AHHH!” I scream. The rubble hasn’t trapped us but most of it has fallen onto the side of my arm and leg, almost trapping my tail in the process. The sharp slates of wood have cut through my uniform and fur. Some parts have even burned my skin. *Well that's going to leave a permanent scar.*

“CATRA!” Scorpia shouts as she runs over to my aid. Sometimes I wish I had her exoskeleton, she can buffs of any scratches.

“I’m fine! I need to find Adora. Have you seen her?”

“I think her orders are to take down the sea gate. You better hurry?”

Ignoring the pain in my arm and leg I sprint onward in hopes of getting to Adora before it’s too late.

--

I feel like I've been running forever. My feet are aching, my body hurts, my hands feel raw but I refuse to stop. I have to get to Adora. I eventually find her at the sea gate just like Scorpia said. She's with the strike team that is trying to hold off the rebels that are trying to prevent the sea gate from collapsing. So far she doing good. There are tankers on the other side that are aiming at the sea gate walls trying to bring it down. It's an even match if you ask me.

"Let's see how powerful you are again the waves." Oh for crying out load! Why does the water princess have to be here?! I've had enough water antics for today. She takes aim at Adora.

"Adora look out!" I shout. She turns to look at me.

"Catra what are you…" I pounce at her, narrowly missing the tidal impact of the sea witch's wave cyclone. We fall to the ground with a thud. I think I may have pounced a little bit too hard. The world around us starts to fade as if it is only us two here and now in this very moment.

I raise myself off Adora using my arms to keep myself upright. Adora repositions herself so she's propped up on her elbows. She uses one of her hands to rub the back of her head. Yep I definitely pounced a bit too hard.

"Hey Adora."

"Catra what are you doing here?"

"Did you honestly think I'd let you have all the fun? Come on we've got a battle to win."

I move to stand, reaching my hand out for Adora to take. She lightly chuckles as she takes my hand so I can help her up. There is a moment between us, we look into each other's eyes. I feel myself start to relax. I feel safe with her.

However, it doesn't last long. Adora quickly pushes me to the ground with her once again but uses her body to shield mine. *What's she doing?* It's then that I hear and see some rocks fall onto the ground. In my daze I completely forgot that we're in the middle of a battle and the Horde is still firing at the sea gate, trying to bring it down.

"You okay?" Adora asks. It's only then that I notice that Adora's new jacket and pants have quite a few rips and tears in them, some have ripped through to her skin. Her cuts are definitely going to scar. One of her forearm armor guards is completely shattered and the other is showing a few cracks. She has a few cuts on her face but nothing too serious. It's clear that our uniforms are not built for protection. *I should have been here sooner.* She's starts to check my body for bruises and cuts, then she notices the most recent wounds on my arm and leg. She looks horrified. I'm quick to reassure her.

"I'm fine, I promise. We can worry about that later. Now what do you say about teaching these rebels a lesson they'll never forget."

Adora devilishly smirks at me and retrieves her sword from the ground. I extend my claws ready to defend us both from any incoming attack. We stand with our backs to each other so we can take on the rebels from any direction.

Adora is a natural with the sword. It's almost as if she was born with the knowledge and power of how to use one. Of course that's impossible though. Her staff training in the Horde must have come in handy. I slice through targets and rocks that are aimed at us. My claws are my most powerful weapon. At one point we get a stick on fire thrown at us whilst some shouts *"For Adventure."* Seriously, what kind of battle cry is that? *Oh shit, one of our boats is on fire.*

It's not long before we have the rebels running for their lives. The team starts to chase them to ensure they don't come back. I stay put to catch my breath. My arm is killing me, it feels like it's on fire. I think I might have pulled something…

BOOM! – *What was that?*

I turn to the direction the sound came from. *Shit!* The Horde tanks must have taken their final blow to the sea gate. It's starting to crumble.

"CATRA!"

Adora scream my name. I turn to run towards her but my leg gives way. Of all the times why now? I panic, frantically trying to get up and out of the way of the falling rocks. Then I see Adora running towards me.

"Adora?"

But before I can ask what she's doing she grabs hold of me and hurtles me out of the way. I tumble on the ground, unable to grip the surface properly with my claws. I land flat on my stomach. Scorpia helps me up. For a moment I feel dizzy but then I see my nightmares coming true. Adora is running for her life as the rocks and rubble from the explosion continue to fall.

This can't be happening. I try to escape Scorpia's grasp but it's not use. She's too strong and I don't have the strength or energy to fight her. The falling rocks are coming down at high speed, Adora's struggling to keep up. *Please, No!...*

"ADORA!!!"

Chapter End Notes

> Oh no... a cliffhanger. I hate cliffhangers yet I decided to include them in my fic. Hope you enjoyed reading Chapter 8. Thank you for all your kind comments on the last chapter, I loved reading what you thought was going to happen. What do you think will happen from here? Find out on Monday when Chapter 9 is uploaded. See you then :)

ADORA!

Chapter Summary

Battle of Salineas Aftermath

Someone special makes an appearance.

Someone opens up to Catra about their past.

Chapter/Creator Warnings: Blood & Injury, Reflections of the Past

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"ADORA!!!"

This is all my fault! This wasn't meant to happen. I'm living a nightmare. I can't see her anymore. The rocks have stopped falling and the Rebellion has backed off but she's nowhere to be seen.

"SCORPIA LET GO OF ME!"

I frantically try to get out of Scorpia's grip threatening to scratch her. She eventually releases me, *wise decision*. Members of our squadron and fellow soldiers run past me heading towards the carnage that's unfolded before us. Despite the burning pain in my legs and arms I power forwards. I need to find Adora!

Scorpia isn't far behind me. Soldiers move whatever they can to try and create a clear path to where we last saw Adora. She's nowhere to be seen. I thought the damage from the fires was bad but this definitely tops it. The ground is broken, the tide can't decide if its staying or going… this is all too familiar.

"Adora!" I call with all my might. My voice croaks from the smoke of the flames and the dust cloud created by the fallen rocks.

"Adora!" I desperately try calling her again but there's still no answer.

I walk on further into the destruction when I spot something shiny in the distance. Curiously, I walk towards it careful not to disturb the rubble around me. One wrong footing could trigger as rock slide. Whatever it is it's hidden under a piece of bark… *Adora's Sword.*

No, no it can't be here! It's meant to be with her! If the swords here then where is she?

"OVER HERE!" Someone shouts. I pick up the sword and run in the direction of the voice, others follow suit. Despite the pain in my legs and arms begging me to rest I need to get to her. I won't leave her side ever again.

"Adora?"

I stop dead in my tracks, shock takes over my body. The sword clanks on the ground. I tentatively take a few steps before falling to my knees.

This can't be happening. This… this is all my fault! I promised her that I'd protect her. She's injured, bruised, unconscious… because of me!

Other soldiers run to my side, cheeking her vitals and life signs. She's alive but her breathing is shallow and has a deep laceration on right her side of her stomach. We need to get her back to the Horde's medics ASAP! It's her only chance. One of the soldiers unloads a skiff off the boat at the sea gate. It's going to be quicker to get her back to the Horde by going through the Whispering Wood than it will be going by sea. One of the soldiers boards her onto the skiff.

“I’ll take her.” I command. I promise we’d look out for each other and that’s exactly what I intended to do. I’m about to board the skiff Scorpia tries to stop me.

“Catra, are you sure…”

“Don't try and stop me Scorpia! Adora is injured because of me! I’m going with her!”

I board the skiff and set off without looking back. I know Scorpia will look after our squadron whilst I’m gone. Right now Adora is my priority.

“Hang on Adora. I’ve got you. You’re going okay. Hold on for me, please.”

--

We’re about halfway away from Salineas when I notice something seriously wrong. Adora was patched up to the best of our abilities before she was boarded onto the skiff but some of the bandages are starting to seep blood. My arm has also started to burn, a clear sign that if not treated soon a serious infection will take hold, but I don’t care about myself right now, my main concern is Adora. *I’ll be fine, I always am.*

I pull the skiff to a stop so I can assess the situation further. It's not looking good. This is all my fault. I should have tried harder to persuaded the sergeant to let me on the same boat as her. I could have stopped all of this from happening. I didn’t even get the chance to tell her…

“Catra?”

Adora speaks my name but it comes out as a faint whisper.

"It's alright Adora. I'm here. You're going to be okay."

She's starting to come round, but not completely. She keeps drifting in and out of consciousness. There's no way I'm going to get her back to the Fright Zone in time without sorting some of these wounds out now.

I can't lose her like this, I won't lose her like this. She's all I have.

I look around trying to find materials that can be used as bandages to temporarily stop the bleeding. Then I spot a small hut with smoke coming from the chimney. Hopefully, that means someone is home. I know this goes against everything we've been taught in the Horde but she needs help, we both need help.

"Adora listen to me. I'm going to pick you up now so I can take you somewhere we can get help. Please, hang on a little bit longer for me."

Adora's too weak to respond verbally but she does attempt to nod her head instead. At least she can still process what I'm saying. I move my arms to cradle her back and legs before lifting her off the skiff, her head resting against my chest. My arms and legs feel like they're about to fall off but I power through. I have to for Adora.

The appears to be no door on the hut, only a draped blanket over the opening. I use my tail move the blanket aside and enter the hut.

"Hello, anyone home?"

"Catra dearie, I didn't except to see you again so soon."

Okay who is this woman and how does she know my name?

"How do you know my name? We've never met before."

"Oh don't be silly. You came round only last week. We're very old friends. You used to help Madam Razz make pie for my Mara

when you we're very young, even if you were falling over your own tail half the time. You even brought Adora along with you last time you visited. You two are always getting into trouble like you did back when you were in the Horde. You've never grown out of your mischievous ways. That's one of the things Adora loves about you the most."

'Were' in the Horde, I'm still a part of the Horde technically? What the fuck is she on about? I've never seen her before in my life, at least I don't think we have. Who on earth is Mara? I don't have time for this shit!

"Look… *Madam Razz is it…* I don't have time for whatever this is. Please, my friend, Adora, she's injured and I really need your help."

A hint of panic came across in my voice. I can't lose her, I won't lose her. We're meant to win this war together. We're meant to be together at the end of the world. I look down at Adora, still holding her in my arms. Her eyes are still sealed shut but her breathing is steady.

"Place her over here dearie. Let Madam Razz see what she can do."

At first I'm hesitant to even let this stranger help but what other choice do I have. I gently place Adora on the bed careful not to cause any more damage to her body than want she has already sustained. Her jacket and pants are practically ruined, her arm plates have been smashed to smithereens. Her left shoulder is completely exposed, her skin is bright red. The rocks must have ripped her jacket and grazed her skin. All I can keep thinking is this is my fault.

I keep a tight hold of Adora's hand as Madam Razz gets to work, cleaning Adora's wounds with some sort of salve and temporally patching her up. I'm not going to leave her side. About fifteen minutes later Adora is all patched up and were ready to continue our journey. Madam Razz insist on patching up my wounds too

but I assume her I’m fine. Really I’m not but right now I need to get Adora back to the Fright Zone.

“Thanks… for helping us. You’re probably the first person I’ve ever met who saw more than just a Horde Soldier.”

I move to retake Adora in my arms. She’s still unconscious but at least she's okay for now. I stand with Adora in my arms to find Madam Razz smiling back at me.

“You’re not the enemy Catra, you never were. Your path just happened to have a not so happy beginning, but you made it work. Your parents would be proud of you.”

That hit's straight to the heart. It means a lot to me to hear that, even if it is from a complete *stranger*.

“Look after our Adora… RAZZAL DAZZAL!”

Wait, What the…

PUFF

--

What just happened?

I open my eyes to find myself suddenly back at the Fight Zone, Adora still held tight in my arms.

I hit my Force Captain Badge with my tail so I can communicate with the medical bay and get Adora the immediate medical attention she needs.

“This is Force Captain Catra. We have a medical emergency. Commander Adora is severely injured. I’m bringing her to the medical bay immediately.”

I end call and head straight to the medical bay.

Upon arrival, I place Adora in a medical bay and doctors immediately get to work. They check her vitals, reassess her injuries, stitch up the ones that are most serve and put her on fluids. Some medics try to escort me from the scene so they can attend to my burns but I put up a fight. I refuse to leave Adora’s side, if they want to treat me they can treat me in the medical bay next to hers.

The medics assess and patch up my most serve injuries, which happens to be almost all of them. They start asking me various questions about the battle. I briefly answer giving them short statements and when they start to annoy me with the continuous questions as to how some of Adora's wound looked well treated before her arrival I simply growl. All I can focus on is the love of my life lying in the medical bay beside me. She looks so helpless, I’m just glad she’s safe. Doctors have said that she will be fine but they’re not sure when she’ll awake. Either way they're certain that she's going to feel sore when she wakes up.

I get up to take a seat next to her when Shadow Weaver barges in.

“WHAT DID YOU DO TO ADORA YOU INSOLENT CREATURE!”

I’m grateful that a medical officer is nearby. There’s no telling what damage Shadow Weaver would inflict upon me if they weren’t here to witness it.

“I DIDN’T DO ANYTHING! There was a rock side after *your* soldiers took a final blow to the sea gate. It’s *their* stupidity of not assessing the situation to make sure the area was clear and *your* poor battle tactics that were put into operation that have caused this!”

That is only part of the reason as to why Adora is currently in this position. I am truly the one to blame for her condition. If I had gone with them when her team chased after the Rebellion none of this would have happened.

There is a stare down between us. I stand in the way of Shadow Weaver getting to Adora. I'm not letting her anywhere near her, she's a threat to us all. To my surprise Shadow Weaver actually backs down and slowly starts to float away.

"This isn't over Catra. You better hope Adora makes a speedy recovery." Shadow Weaver slams to door behind her. I release a breath I hadn't realized I'd been holding in. I move to take my place on a seat next to Adora's bed.

--

Our Squadron arrives back at the Fright Zone a few hours later. Adora is still asleep but her condition is stable. I haven't left her side. Scorpia, Lonnie, Kyle and Rogelio all come to see how she's doing.

"Is she going to be okay?" Kyle asks, Rogelio stand behind him with hands on his shoulders. I sigh leaves me before I answer, my eyes never leave Adora.

"Honestly, I don't know. The doctors says she'll be fine but they have no idea when she'll wake up. It's a waiting game. But until then I'm not leaving her side."

"Well keep an eye on the other's for you. They're pretty worried about you both. Are we okay to tell them what's going on?" Lonnie asks. I simply nod my head in response. They all start to walk towards the exit but Scorpia stays behind, resting on of her claws on my shoulder.

"This is my fault Scorpia. It's my fault she's in this state. It should be me lying there unconscious, not her. I…"

I can't stop the tears from rolling down my cheek. I fold my arms on the bed and rest head on top of them, trying to hide the tears that flow. Scorpia pulls me into a tight hug from behind.

"She's going to be okay Wildcat. Adora is strong, she'll pull through this."

I can only hope she's right.

--

A few more hours have passed and it will soon be lights out. Really I should be heading back to our quarters and contacting the Rebellion to find out what happened after we left the battle scene but I'm not leaving Adora. The Rebellion can wait. Adora needs me. For all I know she may wake up in the night. I need to be by her side when she does.

The door starts to creek open. *Shit I bet this is Shadow Weaver.* Of course that bitch would stoop so low as to come and attack me when everyone is out of sight. I brace myself for an attack but it never came. I turn to find our youngest squadron member, Six, standing behind me.

"I thought you might be hungry so I brought you these. I also wanted to see how you and Adora are doing."

She hands me four two ration bars, all are the grey kind. How she's manged to get four of these I don't know but I'm grateful.

"Thanks kid."

I open one of the ration bars, I'll save the other for tomorrow. With everything going on I forgot to eat and only now am I realizing how hungry I am. The other are for Adora. She loves the grey kind and she's going to need all the energy she can get when she wakes up.

"Lonnie told us about the extent of Adora's injuries. To say we're all shocked is quite a big understatement. How's your arm and leg doing anyway? Scorpia told us you got burned pretty badly."

"Not too bad. Feels better now there some burn gel on it. But I'm a Magicat, they should heal over fairly quickly once the blistering goes down."

"Suppose it one of the benefits of being you. Adora's always talking about you during training sessions. She was telling us how remarkably quick you healed after you saved her from one of Entrapta's robots back at drill. Hopefully Adora can recover just as quick."

There's a hint of sadness on her voice. It clear today has had an impact on how the team feels. I Can't blame them though, I remember how my first *'unofficial'* mission went and look where that's led us. This was their first mission, they had no idea what to expect a part from what we had prepared them for. None of us expected that this would happen to their team leader. I suppose I better ask them how the team is doing, Adora always says its better to talk about things rather than keep them bottled up.

"How you feeling? Today was probably quite dramatic for you all. I remember my first mission and let's just say that it brought back a lot of memories… *sigh* mostly bad ones."

Six moves slightly closer to the end of Adora's bed so we're now directly facing each other. I can faintly see her hands starting to tremble, her facial expression reads confusion and fear.

"I don't, I feel empty I guess. I felt prepared for whatever was going to be thrown at us. I didn't expect the scenes to be a

remind of how I ended up here, how everything collapsed, how I lost the only friend I had ever know."

I have never seen this side of Six. She's not someone who's very open up about their past. I don't push her into telling me anything. I wait patiently offering her a curious look. Six takes a deep sigh…

"The first time I remember confronting the Horde was when I was about four years old. It was just me and older brother. He was about fourteen at the time this happened. Our parents had been captured by the Horde when I was about one, he never told me what happened or how we escaped and they didn't, the memory was too painful for him I guess. The Horde eventually caught up with us a few years later. He told me to run as far as I could and to never look back. As much as I didn't understand what was happening I did what he told me to. I never saw him again. I manged to make my way further into the heart of the Crimson Waste. The only way to survive was to take what you can get. It was when I was attempting to steal a loaf of bread that I met Max. He was about two years older than me and you could tell he'd had it rough out there. We became quite good friends, he showed me the ropes and the best places to get food and supplies from. Everything seemed to be heading in a better direction, but we were only surviving."

Six takes a moment to collect her thoughts. She folds her arms trying to be defensive, but I can see straight through her. This memory brings pain and has scared her for life...

"The Horde eventually come to the area of the Crimson Waste where we made camp. There were quite a few of us in the same area, all roughly the same age, located there for similar reasons. The fires started again, guns were fired and fights enraged. I wasn't going to back down this time. I'd lost my home, my family and a part of myself thanks to the Horde. I should have seen it coming. I managed to drive away two of the soldiers but I hadn't seen the one creeping up behind me. It was only when I turned to see the dagger in their hand I realized what was happening.

Max pushed me out of the way of the attack but he didn't escape the consequence of his actions. He died so I could live. In my state of shock I was knocked out and next thing I knew was I was here in this dump. My life forever changed by the Horde. ”

The room feels eery, darkness starts to close in around us. Six has always been a quite character, challenging at times but nothing Adora and I couldn’t handle. Her story now explains why that might be.

“You and Adora are the only people I have ever told that too. I feel like I should tell some of my squadron members but their pasts are as traumatic as mine. None of us asked to be a part of this war but it seems like it’s the only way we can survive.”

Adora knew about Six’s past? Since when?

Six processed to look at the floor and I turn to face Adora. I never knew how much of an impact she had these kids’ lives. They need her in their lives just as much as I need her.

“Thank you for opening up to me about your past. It’s nice to know you trust us. You’re not a bad kid Six. Your life just hit a few bumps at the beginning before hitting this big hurdle that changed it all. You’re just like us. You didn’t ask for any of this to happen but it ended up this way. Things will get better eventually.”

That earns a smile from Six. Her body visibly starts to relax. “I better get going before the rest of the team wonder where I’ve gone. Don’t want to be caught by *you-know-who.* You’ll let us know when Adora wakes up right?*”*

I smile and simply nod in response. Just before Six exits the room I speak to her one last time…

“Don’t worry about Adora. She’s strong. I know she’ll pull through this.”

When Six finally leaves I start to get ready for bed. I curl up against Adora’s side careful not to aggravate her injuries. I place

my arms around her body, rest my tail across her legs and pull her as close as possible to me. My head rests against her chest and I allow her strong, steady heartbeat lure me to sleep.

Chapter End Notes

Hope you enjoyed reading Chapter 9. Thank you for all your kind comments on the last chapter. I loved reading them and I'm glad you're enjoying this fic.

What do you think will happen in the next chapter? - I can't wait to share the next part of this fic with you all and I have good reasons as to why I'm excited to share it with you all too. The next chapter will be released on Friday. See you then :)

Don't You Get It

Chapter Summary

Catra and Sparkles realize that they're two sides of the same coin.

Hordak makes a decision that angers Shadow Weaver.

Catra has a confession to make.

Chapter/Creator Warnings: Scars, Reflections of the Past, Mentions of Panic Attacks

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

I awake to the sound of the medical room doors opening. It's Scorpia. She's probably come to see how Adora's doing. I'm not actually supposed to be here. I was meant to leave when it was lights-out but like hell was I leaving Adora. It's my fault that she's stuck here. The least I can do is be here for her when she wakes up.

I didn't sleep too well last night. I woke up everytime I heard someone walking through the corridors, scared that the witch might come by to punish me for what happened. Adora would sometimes shift in her unconscious state. I could tell she was distressed and most likely in pain as a result of her injures. When I heard her or felt her move I'd start to purr, attempting to try and settle her. It seemed to work as she'd soon settle down. It's a good sign but it doesn't give me any indication of when she'll wake up. Still this is all my fault, she wouldn't be in this situation if it wasn't for me.

"Hey Wildcat. You feeling okay?"

Scorpia walks over and takes a seat across from me. I'm still lying at Adora's side, my head resting on her chest, tailed draped across her legs and my arms wrapped tightly around her body. Only my eyes move to meet Scorpia's gaze. She looks down at me with that stupidly friendly smile of hers. I'm too exhausted to lie to her.

"I don't know Scorpia. I'm not sure how I feel right now. Didn't get much sleep as well, *you know*…" I look up at Adora to express my point. My arms tightly warping around her before continuing…

"This is all my fault Scorpia. I should have been there sooner to protect her. She wouldn't be in this state if it wasn't for me. Why do bad things always happen to the people I care about… *Scorpia, what is she doesn't…*"

My eyes start to water. Stupid emotions! Scorpia reaches forward, holding one of my hands in her claws, attempting to ground me.

"Hey, hey Wildcat listen to me. That is *NOT* going to happen, okay! This is *NOT* your fault! This could have happened to anyone. Adora did what she did to save you. She's going to wake up and you're going to continue this mission with her by your side. Right now it's just a waiting game. I know that's difficult and I don't like it either, but she's going to be okay."

I take few deep breaths to steady myself. I can only hope she's right. A weak smile is all I'm able to return to Scorpia before proceeding to gently maneuver myself of the bed so that I can eat the ration bar I saved from last night. Adora will be able to have to other two when she wakes up. I look around the room to make sure that we are the only two, well technically three, here.

"Any news from the Rebellion?"

"Not that I am aware of but I'd try and contact them sooner rather than later if I was you. I know you don't want to leave Adora but it might be worth getting out of your ruined uniform, having a quick shower to wash off any remaining dirt before

sending the Rebellion a quick message to let them know what's going on."

Stars I hate it when she's right. As much as I hate water, it would be nice to have a quick rinse off and get all the remaining dirt out of my fur and change into something that doesn't smell like sea water and burned wood.

"Will you look after Adora whilst I'm gone? I won't be too long but if she happens to wake you come and get me immediately."

"Sure thing Wildcat."

With that, I move to make my exit but I don't leave the room before taking one last look at Adora. It's nice to know that Scorpia has my back.

--

I never thought in my life that I would say that I found having a shower refreshing, but I guess things change. It was a quick one but a calming one; fresh clothes put on after sorting out my fluffed up fur. Adora thinks it's cute when that happens, she usually offers to brush it down. Really that's just an excuse to stroke me but I can't complain, it's comforting. It doesn't feel right having to do it myself after many years of Adora helping me.

I choose to wear what was my old uniform, just until my burns heal. The medics said I need to keep my wounds clear from any form of restrictions until they have completely healed. I have other sets of both uniforms, old and new; Adora does too. I think I'll save my newer uniform for *'special'* occasions, especially considering the intimidating effect it has.

Adora's standard red jacket is draped across one of our room chairs. I decide to place it across my shoulders so I don't forget to

take it to her when I head back to the medical bay. Her scent still lingers on its collar, it's comforting and calming.

I pick up the tracker pad to find that the rebels have already tried to contact us. Scorpia may have had a point about contacting them sooner rather than later. I guess I better see what they want. It's Sparkles that answers the call.

"FINALLY! We've been trying to contact you all night. Ohhh you look like you've been battered."

"What a greeting Sparkles! You don't look any better than me."

She doesn't. She's in some sort of glittery pyjama type thing and her hair is wilder than my mane. She looks like she taken quite the beating. There are several bruises and cuts visible on her face and arms.

"Sorry that was insensitive of me. How are you and Adora doing? We heard that you both got injured when the sea gate collapsed… where's Adora?"

Oh course they've heard, who hasn't heard. I turn to face away from Sparkles, unable to look at her as guilt takes over.

"It's my fault Adora's not here. She's in the medical bay being treated for her injuries. She's unconscious. She saved me and now because of me she's stuck lying in a bed with none of us knowing for sure when she'll wake up. She could have died because of me… *I didn't even get the chance to tell her I love her."*

Shit, I wasn't meant to say that last part out loud. Too late now it's out in the open.

I turn back to face the camera to see that Sparkles has tears in her eyes. Stars she even softer than me. I thought it would take a bit more than that to get her water works flowing.

"Catra, I'm so sorry. I wish I could somehow help but I… I don't know what I can do."

“There’s nothing you can do Sparkles. There’s nothing anyone can do. We just have to wait and hope for the best.”

There’s a moments silence between us both. It’s not tense or uncomfortable, just silent. After a few silent moments Sparkles speaks again...

“When I lost my dad the world around me collapsed. I was too young to understand what was going on. I didn’t know why my mum started to isolated herself or why she withdrew herself away from everything. Growing up all I knew was that my purpose was to protect the people I love and to fight against the Horde. I never stopped to consider how this war was effecting the lives of those on the other side. Funny when you think about it we’re practically two sides of the same coin, trapped in a war that isn’t meant to be our battle.”

She lost her dad? I didn’t know that. I remember her mentioning losing someone due to the war when we first met but I didn’t know who she was referring to. Maybe we’re more alike than I thought.

“I never asked to be a part of this war. I never asked to be taken from my family and be turned into… *this*. Adora is the only family I have left, the only good thing in my life. She found me, gave me a name, promised me we’d be together at the end of the world. I’m not sure what the future holds for us, but I know that no matter what I will protect her with my life.”

I’ve failed to protect her once, I will not fail again.

--

When I arrive back at Adora’s beside I notice that her dressings have been changed. The doctors said that she is healing well but I

still can’t shift the guilt that this is all my fault. None of this would have happened if this wasn't for me.

Last night’s restlessness is taking it toll and I start to feel myself dosing off. I wrap Adora's jacket into a makeshift pillow. If I am going to doze off I might as well get comfortable. My eyes were almost shut when I hear something. If it wasn’t for my sensitive hearing I might have missed it.

“Catra?”

Adora’s fingers start to twitch, her hand slowling moving across to bed as if she’s searching for something… “Catra?”

Within second I am out of my seat and standing next to her side. I take her wandering hand in mine. My other hand moves to rests on her forehead, my thumb brushes a stand of hair out of her eyes.

“I’m here Adora. I’m right beside you. I’m not going anywhere.”

Her hand forms a firm grip around mine. It’s a good sign. Her eyes start attempting to open… she’s waking up! I lean my forehead against her, silently promising her that I am by her side. I whisper words of encouragement...

“Come on Adora. You’ve got this. I’m right here. You just have to wake up.”

It’s a tense few moments but her eyes eventually open. I move back as to not startle her. Our strong hold on each other’s hands still remains. Her eyes wander slightly attempting to focus. When they do those beautiful baby-blue eyes look directly into mine.

“Catra… y-you’re really here?”

I can’t stop the smile that appears across my face. I’m so relived. She’s awake, she’s alive and the first person she asks for is me.

“Yes Adora. I’m here. I never left your side”

Well that's not technically true but I only left to have a shower and speak to sparkles. I was back in less than thirty minutes. Other than that I've never left her side.

Adora's grip on my hand becomes stronger. She could easily break my hand right now and I wouldn't care, she awake and she's alive. *Thank stars she's alive!*

Despite the very heart warming moment that is happening between us, I'm suddenly dragged away from her so medics can assess her injuries. Adora's hand weakly reaches for mine before a medic gets her attention, asking her a series of random questions. She's appears to flustered and confused, but eventually relaxes when she realizes what's going on.

My growl is deep. I threaten to scratch the medics should they hurt Adora or cause her any distress. If anyone one of them hurts her they'll be sorry. One of the calmer medics manages to calm me down. Adora appears startled by the situation, three medics assessing her all at once. I want nothing more than to be able to hold her hand and reassure her that everything's okay. The medics eventually finish their assessment and I immediately re-join Adora at the bedside.

I wouldn't have been able to stop myself even if I wanted to. I learn over Adora and embrace her into what might possibly be the strongest hug I have even given. Adora proceeds to do the same, even though I can hear her wincing through the pain.

Shit I forget about her injuries. I relax a little bit to give Adora some space but it seems the *'space'* is too big for her as she immediately responds by pulling me closer to her once more and holding me tighter so I can't move away. I hold her tightly once more. Take it we both need this hug more than we thought.

After a few moments we part, hands still intertwined with one another. My tail happily sways behind me. I have to fight back tears. *There's no way I'm going to start crying in front of complete strangers.* Adora reaches up the best she can, lightly stoking my

cheekbone with her thumb. I lean into her touch, a quite purr building in my chest.

"So what did I miss?"

--

Two hours after waking up, Adora is discharged but not before being visited by the wicked witch of the Fright Zone, *Shadow Weaver*. She doesn't pay any attention to me, which I appreciative anyway but I never take my eyes off her. You can never tell what she is capable of, she always has a hidden trick up her robe. Shadow Weaver informs us the Lord Hordak has authorized us both with two weeks rest but would like us to meet with us before the end of today to discuss some *'important matters'*. It's clear that Shadow Weaver is not impressed that he has granted us both time off. To be honest I'm more surprised he has allowed us anytime off at all, especially for that long. He never gives his troops time off. *Is he feeling well?*

Adora insists that she's visits our squadron not long after being discharged, stating that she needs to make sure *they're* okay. *'Come on Adora I told you before they're fine. Can't you think about yourself for once'*, but I'm not in the mood to argue. We pass the barracks on the way back to our quarters and the showers so it was easier to let them know she's awake when passing by. Adora is greeted with open arms and multiple questions about what actually happened. I stay in the background with Scorpia. She offered to keep up training with our Squadron whilst we wait for Adora to recover. As happy as I am that Adora is awake and is on the road to recovery, I can't help but feel guilty. None of this should have happened, *it wouldn't have happened if it wasn't for my failure.*

'You don't deserve her. She almost died because of you.'

We're now back in our quarters. Adora's has finished showering and has started to get dressed. She's opted to wear her old uniform and has even mentioned burning all her other uniform styles, saying that this one offers her more protection and comfort. We both know the true reason as to why she favors her old uniform is because of her jacket. It's her lucky jacket. I gave it for her when she was 16 and she has wore it ever since.

I'm balancing with my back against the wall, my arms folded across my chest. Her body looks hurt and bruised but her wounds seem to be healing nicely. The medics said that the dressings will need changing daily, which I can sort out for her. They estimate that her minor injuries will be healed in a week with the more serve injuries taking two weeks to a month to completely heal. There's no doubt that they'll scar over.

'It's your fault she has got those scars. It should have been you lying in that medical bay not Adora. You failed to protect her!'

"Catra?"

"Yeah?"

"Are you okay, you seem a little distant."

"Yeah, I'm fine. Are you ready to get going?"

Adora still looks at me with that concerned look she does but she doesn't question it further. We exit our quarters and make our way to Hordak's Sanctum.

--

We arrive at Hordak's sanctum to find that both he and Shadow Weaver are waiting. Entrapta is working on something somewhere in the background, talking to someone or something called Emily.

I can't be sure from this distance but it looks like a robot of some sort. *She name's robots now?*

"Lord Hordak, you requested to see us." Adora say. As a commander she should always address our '*leader*' before anyone ranked captain.

"Do you remember what I said to you when we last spoke?"

Hordak address this question to us both so I decided to answer.

"You informed us that with great success, comes great rewards."

"Indeed. You have both proven that you are one of the Hordes greatest soldiers. Your squadron is the strongest amongst them all. Your battle tactics and training techniques are exemplary. Salineas proved a challenge, and despite our victory it was not an easy take. We have lost many and it will take time to recover. You both showed incredible levels of courage and determination. That's why I'm promoting both of you to be by my side when we restore order to Etheria once and for all."

Sparkles never mentioned that they'd lost the battle at Salineas and Scorpia never mentioned the number of troops lost during the battle. *One of them was almost Adora.*

Hordak rises from his thrown and strides forward. He stops once we're eye level and mere inches apart. *I won't lie this feels slightly intimidating.*

"Adora, you are no longer a standard Horde Commander. You have been promoted to be my Second-in-Command. I want you by my side during future battles. Catra, you will keep your position as Force Captain but I want you as Adora's Second-in-Command. This ultimately makes you my first ever Third-in-Command but you main focus should be as one of the Horde's top Force Captains.

Adora's been promoted to Second-in-Command, me Third-in-Command. This… this is all a bit too much to take in right now.

Shadow Weaver immediately erupts to protest against Hordak's decision.

"My lord you cannot do this! This is not a wise move to make! For Adora yes that is one of your greatest decisions yet but to promote that *fowl beast* that stands before you is a grave mistake. Adora could have died because of that creatures mistake. If you don't exile her she'll destroy your legacy."

"SILENCE! You, *Shadow Weaver*, have proven nothing but an inconvenience to me in the last few months. In case you haven't already realized, Adora's promotion means that your rank has now been stripped for you. You are to remain confined to your quarters until I find use of you."

The look on Shadow Weavers face says it all..."You cannot do this! I am most powerful being in the entirety of the Horde! I'm the only sorceress in the entirety of Etheria who knows how to extract raw power from a ruin stone! YOU NEED ME!"

"ENOUGH!"

The room falls still and silent. Hordak's voice bellows throughout his lair, causing a series of thundering echoes. It even got Entrapta's attention.

"I suggest that you leave now Shadow Weaver unless you want me to deal with your stupidity personally."

Karma's bitch isn't it. Shadow Weaver makes the wise decision to leave before angering Hordak further. If you ask me she trying to save any bit of dignity she has left. As she passes she stares me down…

"This isn't the last you've seen of me, *Catra*!"

What does she mean by that? Who the fuck does she think she is!

Before Shadow Weaver can float any further, Adora blocks her path and stares her down. Shit she can give a mean *'drop-dead'*

glare.

"You better be careful Shadow Weaver. We out-rank you now. If you *ever* speak to Catra like that again or do *anything* to hurt her *I'll* be the one to *make sure that you regret it*!"

The is no emotion visible in Shadow Weavers eyes as Adora stands her ground. She leaves a few moments after. We turn to face Hordak once more before saluting. Entrapta gets back to work and we make our exit.

As we exit Hordak's sanctum panic starts to set in. The walls start to close in on me, yesterday events replaying in my mind. I want to scream but my voice is lost. I want to run but I can't, I can't breathe…

'*Adora?'….'You're not the Enemy Catra'…* `*WHAT DID YOU DO TO ADORA YOU INSULENT CREATURE'…'she's going to be okay Wildcat'… 'it should be me lying there not Adora'…'ADORA!'*

"Catra?"

Adora hands are placed firmly on my shoulders, holding me steady whilst she tries to calm me down. I can see my reflection in her eyes… *fear.*

"Catra you're okay. I'm here, we're okay."

Adora tries to calm me but nothing seems to work...

"Catra what's wrong? Catra please speak to me?"

No this is all wrong, it's too much. I have to get away. I have to get away before I do anymore damage.

I break from Adora's hold and start to run. Adora immediately starts chasing after me. I move to run on all fours so that I can move faster. I can hear Adora calling me but I can't stop running, I need to be alone, somewhere I feel safe. I need to get away,

away from Adora so she'll be safe, safe from my failures, safe from my feelings for her, *safe from me.*

--

"Catra? Catra are you up there?"

I've made my way up to mine and Adora's secret spot, the watch platform. I need to be alone with my thoughts for a bit but as always Adora manages to find me.

"Catra what's going on? You've not been yourself all day. You know you can talk to me. I want to know how I can help. Please tell me what's wrong? Whatever it is we can fix it together."

"Nothing's wrong Adora I'm fine."

"You're clearly not. I know you better than anyone. I can tell somethings bothering you. You're scaring me by shutting yourself out."

"Maybe it's better that way."

"WHAT DO YOU MEAN?!"

Unshed tears burn my eyes as I turn to face Adora. My hands have formed fist, my claws digging into my palms. Adora looks back at me with a hurt expression.

"YOU ALMOST DIED BECAUSE OF ME ADORA! I promised I'd protect you and I couldn't even do that. I had to watch you almost die. I thought you had died when I couldn't find you. I allowed a complete stranger to assess your injuries and re-patch you up as you were fading when I was trying to get you back here. You wouldn't have those injuries if I had the strength to get

up out of the way. BECAUSE OF ME YOU'RE HURT. BECAUSE OF ME YOU KEEP GETTING HURT!"

"Catra, none of this is your fault. Look at me I'm okay."

"NO ADORA! I'm not just on about what happened at Salineas!"

Adora tries to reach for my hands but I pull away. I need to let this all out. Adora seems to recognize this and backs off slightly, giving me space.

"You've risked your life for me more than once. You've been torture so many times by that fucking witch who calls herself our *'mentor'*. You risked your life to save me when you found me in that box just by standing up to her. You were young yet you did that. Right now your risking your life just to end this war. Of course I'm proud you got promoted again but that's now going to make you a major target. I owe you my life."

"Catra you don't owe me anything. The day I found you was the best day of my life. I met my best friend, we started to build a future together, made promises to each other... I met someone who I deeply care about and want to spend the rest of my life with. I get that you're scared, I'm scared too but I promise you now like I did back then that no matter what happens we're in this together."

Frustration causes me to pace. Adora doesn't dare move but her eyes follow my movements. I eventually stop, my hands resting on my hips, my tail aggressively swishing behind me… "You still don't get it do you?"

"Get what?"

"I can't lose you Adora. I won't lose you. Adora I…"

I choke on my words. Why is it so hard to tell her that I love her. Just say *'Adora, I love you'. Come on Catra just say it!*

"Adora…"

Sometimes actions speak louder than words. This is one of those times. I can't take it anymore!

I stride towards her, pulling Adora close to me by the lapels of her jacket and draw her into a passionate kiss. At first our bodies are tense but we quickly relax into it the kiss. Adora's hands wrap around my waist and pull me closer to her. My tail relaxes and wraps around her body, my arms moving to rest over her shoulders

We eventually pull a part, both of us unaware how desperately we needed air. Adora rests her forehead against mine. Our eyes meet each other's.

"I love you Adora. I always have."

"You love me?"

"You're such an idiot". I lightly giggle, a smile appearing across my face. This is the Adora I know and love. It's then I realize that she's smiling back at me with that beautifully dumb Adora smile. Her eyes reflect the same emotions as mine... *love.*

"I love you too."

She… she love me? Adora loves me the same way that I love her?

A thundering purr emits from my chest. It so loud that the whole Fright Zone might be able to hear me. Before I can fully process what's happening, Adora gently guides me into another kiss. It's long, passionate and a little bit clumsy but this is only our second kiss.

My heart fills with joy knowing that I have finally had the courage to tell Adora that I love her. *I can't believe she feels the exact same way about me.*

We spend the remainder of the night on the watch tower platform, holding each other close, whispering silent promises

between kisses and sharing our confessions on when we first released we had feelings for each other.

With Adora by my side our future looks bright.

Chapter End Notes

> Finally! Who else was waiting for Catra to tell Adora that she loves her? I'm the one writing this fic and even I was like 'when will Catra tell Adora about her feelings for her' throughout the writing process.
>
> Hope you enjoyed reading Chapter 10. I enjoyed writing this chapter. Thank you for your kind comments last week. I loved reading them all and I'm really glad you like reading this fic so far. Adora and Catra start to explore their newfound relationship in the next chapter. Can't wait to share it and the rest of the story now these two love birds have finally come to terms with their feelings for each other. See you on Monday ☺️

I Love You

Chapter Summary

A friendly sparring match occurs.

Catra has been feeling butterflies in her stomach.

Catra and Adora take the next big step in the relationship.

Chapter Content: Explicit Sexual Content

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Adora won't rest even if I was to save her life. The second she was able to properly move again she was back to training, even though it was very obvious that she still had some discomfort from her injuries and it had only been a day or two since she was discharged from the medical bay. I've lost count of how many times I've dragged her out of the training simulation rooms and back to our quarters. She spent most of our two weeks off training. *So much for resting.*

Things have been going well these past few months. I'm no longer scared of my feelings for Adora, I can be as close to her and as affectionate as I want with her, but we're only like that when in our quarters or when we're at our secret spot on the watch tower. Fraternization is *highly* forbidden in the Horde. Rumors quickly spread about soldiers who are caught being intimate with each other being sent to Beast Island or the Crimson Waste and in some cases much worse. We sneak the occasional peck on the cheek or lips when no one is looking but we don't risk it any more than that, even that is taking a risk as it is. Let's be real though, no one would dare challenge Hordak's two most *'loyal'* soldiers. They'd think better to turn a blind eye. Still we refuse to risk it.

I haven't seen Shadow Weaver since our promotion but I'm still on edge about what she said to me that day… *'This isn't the last you've seen of me.'* A cold shiver makes its way down my spine. But I can't worry about that right now. Currently I'm having to deal with a new, *unusual urge.*

Everytime I'm with Adora I feel... *different*, different than when I used to be around her. It's a good different but it makes me feel… *well I'm not sure how to describe it.* It usually happens when we're sparring or laughing, but it becomes more *'demanding'* when we're kissing and cuddling. *'It's a side effect of being in love'* I keep telling myself, but now I'm not so sure. I want to be more physical, more intimate with Adora but I don't know how and I don't want to fuck it up. I don't want to pressure her into anything and I don't even know if she's ready or wants to be more intimate with me. I love Adora more than anything and I want to be able to show her that… *I just don't know how.*

--

"Come on Adora, you've been training all day. You deserve a break."

This is the fourth time this week I have caught Adora in one of the training simulations. She's already admitted to me that she's exhausted with all the standard training practices and meetings she has to attend yet she still refuses to give herself a break. She's been trying to sneak out when I'm not looking but she forgets I have incredibly heightened senses. No matter how quite she tries to be I can always hear her. If I can't see or hear her, I can easily track her scent a mile away.

"I know. I just want to be prepared you know. We could be attacked at any moment and now being the Horde's Second-in-Command the pressure is on." Adora lowers her staff from the

target and takes in a deep sigh. "I won't lie to you Catra. Being promoted is a huge bonus for us but I've never felt more stressed in my life."

She's not lying. Her night terrors have been getting more frequent since the attack on Salineas a few months ago. Sometimes they're flash backs of what happened, and other times… well Adora's never been able to tell me what the rest of them were about. Everytime she tries to re-tell me what it was about, all she's able to do is hold me close and let her tears fall until they run dry.

I can't help but feel responsible for all of this: her stresses, her exhaustion, her nightmares... they're all happening because of me. I feel useless knowing that I can do nothing but comfort her through reassuring promises, holding her close and purring until she eventually relaxes in my hold. Sure I have nightmares too but they have never been as drastic as Adora's.

This is all my fault.

I unfold my arms and walk towards Adora. My tail instinctively wraps around her waist and my arms rest over her shoulders. I use one of my hands to lift her chin up so she's now looking directly at me rather than the floor.

"I know you're stressed Adora and I know you better than anyone. You're a *'punch you're feelings out'* kind of person, but you seriously need to rest. I can't see the Horde making an extreme attack for the next few months, especially with Hordak having his eyes set on Brightmoon."

Adora knows I'm right - *Well of course I'm right, I'm always right, there no questioning about it.*

Despite all this, I'm still unable get to Adora to smile. It's an unusual sight to see, a smile-less Adora. She seems lost, trapped in a battle with her own emotion. I'm not sure how I can help, *unless…*

“You know what, I’ve just remembered that we haven’t set the record straight from our last sparring match.”

Adora faintly giggles, signs of a small smile appear across her face.

“What are you suggesting? We both know I can very easily kick your ass. There’s no question about that.”

“In your dreams Adora. We both know you had an unfair advantage against me that day as I twisted my tail bone the day before… I want a rematch. What do you say… *princess*?”

“Oh you’re on!”

With that Adora’s smile returns and we get ready in our stance positions.

“Oh and no claws this time. I know you like to cheat!”

"*Me? A Cheat?* Adora you should now I'd never consider doing such a thing... *not with you anyway*.”

Adora makes the first move, immediately aiming for my waist. She so predictable. I swiftly dodge her attack and use my tail to trip her up. She lands flat on her stomach.

“Wow, you really are out of practice.”

“Shut up!”

I can’t help but laugh. It’s cute when she’s embarrassed. I help Adora regain her bearings so it’s a fair advantage. I make my first move, swiftly aiming at her right side which she easily blocks.

Our friendly match plays out like they always do, a bit of teasing, a few near misses, but this one also has laughter. We don’t usually get to have fun when sparring as we’re always being observed. I always come second to avoid Shadow Weaver’s wrath for

‘*embarrassing*’ Adora. I came first once. I felt victorious, but not for long, not after facing the consequences; *never again.*

Adora's getting tired, I can tell by how her strikes are becoming messy. A strand of hair has fallen loose out of her ponytail. If we weren’t sparring I’d reach up and brush it to the side, but if I did that now she could easily take me down.

Lunging forwards, I grab Adora’s waist and position her into what might be the smoothest dip in all of Etherian history.

“Hey Adora.” I say in a very lustful tone. She look beautiful in this position. My tail starts to smoothly sway side to side, as sign that I’m content and relaxed. In my moment of distraction, Adora sweeps my leg, causing us both to fall to the ground. Within seconds she flips us over, straddling my lap, pinning my wrist at either side of my head. *Stars that’s hot.*

“Hey Catra.” Adora returns in the same lustful tone I used earlier. She starts to laugh, still keeping me pinned firmly to the ground. She looks so beautiful, so radiant. *Surely its illegal to be this attractive.*

Adora’s laughter eventually settles and her eyes fall to mine. They look as if they’re searching for something. *What do I do now?* She's so close to me, her body firmly pressed again mine. Her lips just out of my reach. A fluttering sensation builds in my stomach. It’s too strong to ignore.

“Catra…”

Nothing comes after, it almost as if Adora’s words are lost on her lips. Adora’s grip on my wrists slackens and I’m able to move one of my hands to rest against her left cheek. They’re starting to brighten and I can tell mine are doing the same.

“You... *urm...* feeling a bit more relaxed now?” I ask, unsure of what to say. I feel lost for words. *She so, so beautiful.*

Adora seems to jump out of her trance and moves to get off my, helping me stand. *Why did I even say anything, I was enjoying the view.*

"*Yeah…* yeah. A lot better. *Urm...* thank you. I… I think I needed that."

There's a few more moments of awkward silence between us. Neither of us quite sure what to say or do.

"Well, I-I'm going to go and have a much needed shower and I'll see you back at our quarters."

"Yeah sure okay. I-I'll go and grab some ration bars whilst you're at it. I'll see you there."

Adora moves closer to me and places a gentle kiss to my forehead.

"I think it's fair to say that I won that match. Told you I would kick your ass!" Adora shouts in the distance as she exits to room.

"*Whatever you say princess!"* I respond, giggling under my breath.

With that I leave the training room. *'What was that all about?'*, I ask myself. That fluttering sensation in my stomach and chest has sort of eased but it still lingers. Maybe the way I'm feeling is not a side-effect of being in love after all.

--

I return to our quarters after managing to retrieve four grey ration bars. Adora deserves the best so I made sure I got the best. Sure there's probably better, more tasteful food outside the Fright Zone but these will have to do, this is all we ever get offered.

Our sparring match really calmed my nerves. I think we both needed it despite not even realizing. Still, I'm left wondering why I feel the way I'm do when I'm around Adora. Maybe I can get some answers if I try to get the same reaction from her as before.

I have an idea.

We've added a few extra platforms to our quarters once we were certain the room was ours as I like to lounge in different areas of our room during my 'cat-naps' as Adora like to call them. I'll go up on the one near the door and hide there. When Adora comes in I'll pounce and try and get her to engage in a tickle fight, we'll take it from there.

Just as I'm getting in position Adora walks into the room. She's only wearing her grey pants and white Horde shirt. I brought her jacket back to our quarters when she went for a shower. Her jacket and my head mask are both placed on one of the rooms' standard desks. She removes her boots and sock and places them with her jacket at the side. She's let her hair down for once.

"So what do you want to do…Catra?"

Adora glances around the room searching for me. She even lifts herself up to the bed roof to see if I'm there. That would have been too obvious. As she lowers herself back to the floor I start to giggle. She turns and I pounce.

"Catra what are you - ah!"

I knock her down onto the bed and we both land on the mattress with a thud. I immediately start tickling her, careful not to aggravate her healed injuries.

"Catra… *ah…* stop… *ha…*"

I relax my hold on her to make this a fair game and in doing so she flips me over. I don't mind, I love this view of her. She immediately start to tickles me back.

"*Ah*... *no…* Adora... *hah…*"

I immediately see a weak spot, something that will allow me to get back on top. I move my tail so it under her shirt which she hasn't tucked into her pants like she usually does. The response is instance. As she goes to grab her stomach I flip us back over and lightly pin her hands and the side of her head.

Our laughter starts to fade. Our eyes lock with each other and a smile appears across our faces. My hands start to loosen their grip but only enough so Adora can remove her hands if she wants to.

Adora leans upwards so she resting on her elbows. One of her hands strokes the side of my cheek and then heads towards my ear. I learn into her touch, purring up a storm as she scratched. That's when I notice the way Adora is looking at me. It's different from all the other times.

She moves ever so slightly closer to me until our lips meet. At first its slow and gentle, but when she kisses me again there is more force behind it. Its passionate and demanding all at the same time. The unusual urge is back but this time I don't ignore it, I let it guide me telling me what to do.

I gently push Adora back onto the bed. One of her hands strokes its way through my mane, the other on my back pulling me as close as possible to her. Instinct drives me to gently nip her bottom lip and I'm rewarded with a delicious moan from her lips.

I wonder how I can coax more sounds like that out of her.

Our kisses quickly become more heated. Adora's hand lowers to the base of my tail and she starts to scratch there. It's usually sensitive but this time I feels different, it feels right.

"Adora." I faintly whisper as I move to kiss under her chin.

"Catra." Her response is just as faint as mine and just as lustful.

I move from kissing her chin to lightly kiss her nose. I then place myself on both elbows so I'm looking down at her. I want to make sure she wants this as much as I do before we go any further. I won't do anything she doesn't want to or isn't ready for. Her face is flushed and her pupils are blown. She's smiling at me and I can't help but smile back at her.

"You're beautiful."

She giggles and proceeds to starch behind one of my ears. Instead of leaning into her touch, I use of my hand to move hers to my lips where I gently kiss her palm. Her breathing slightly hitches but in a good way.

"Adora… do you… do you want this?"

Adora moves to sit up with me still straddling her hips. Her smile never leaves her face. Her hands come rest the sides of my waist.

"I want this Catra. I want to be intimate with you. I just…I don't know how."

Her smile fades at her confession and her cheeks start to flush. It's almost as if she is embarrassed to admit it... It's cute.

"Adora, that's okay. To tell the truth I also have no idea what I'm doing. I've just been letting my instinct guide me for last however long we were doing that for."

"I just don't feel like I should be nervous about this… about us. I love you Catra. I'm just worried about accidentally doing something wrong or doing something you won't like. I want our first time to be special. I've never done anything like this or felt like this before."

I move Adora's hands from my waist so I'm holding them. I give them a gentle squeeze. I'm glad to know I'm not the only one who's feeling like this. First times are special but they come with a lot of nerves. I'd be lying if I said I haven't had some of the same thoughts as Adora.

"It's okay to be nervous Adora. I'm nervous too. I love you and if you're not ready we can wait, that's okay. Even if we choose to do this and then decide we want to stop, we can stop. If I accidentally do something you don't like or you do something I don't like, *which believe me I highly doubt*, and you want me to stop that's also okay. Just tell me and I'll do anything you want. Nothing is ever going to change the way I feel about you Adora. I promise you that our first time will be special. Do you know how I know… because I love you Adora, I trust you."

Adora smiles back at me and draws me into a passionate kiss. I'm certain this won't be our final one tonight.

"I love you Catra, and I'm ready. I want this. I want you."

I kiss her back gently, starting at a steady pace. It's not long before our kisses become more demanding, hungry even. I lick across Adora's bottom lip asking for permission to enter. She grants it and I get a sensational jolt down my spine when our tongues dance together.

After some time, I slowly feel Adora's hand work around the hem of my shirt asking silently if she can remove it. I lean back onto my knees and place my hands over hers, giving them a reassuring squeeze I can sense she needs. What I didn't expect for her was to move my hands to her shirt.

"Can we do this together. I'm a little nervous." She nervously giggles. I smile back at her and place a gentle kiss on her lips.

"Together."

We both slowly remove each others shirts but then we hit our first hurdle. Turns out its difficult to remove each other's shirts at the same time.

"I don't think I thought that through to well" I hear Adora say through a fit of laughter.

Even though I can't see her face I can still picture her smile. I move my hands from her shirt to remove mine and then go back to removing hers. When I see Adora's beautiful eyes again I gently kiss her. I lean back, surprised to find that Adora has no bra on, which is *very* unusual for her. *Guess she's taken a leaf out of my book*.

I can tell that Adora feel a bit flustered, we have seen each other naked in the showers before but this... *this is different.*

"Adora you're… *wow*!"

I'm quite literally lost for words. Everything about her is beautiful: the stretch marks against her perfectly rounded breasts, the faded scars that she has obtained through years of training, even the dimples on her hips… she's stunning. Everything about her is beautiful.

"It's funny isn't it?" Adora says through a small grin that appears across her face.

"What is?" I ask, never taking my eyes of her.

"From all the times I've tried to sneak a peek over the shower stalls to look at you, this is the first time I get to appreciate how stunning you are… Catra you most beautiful that I have ever seen."

What did I ever do to deserve someone like her? She somehow manages to make me fall in love with her even more everyday. I move to kiss her on the lips but this time it's Adora who pulls me down with her. She gently raises her hips and moves one of my hands to the top of pants and underwear, silently asking me to remove them. To make sure she feel comfortable as I work her pants and underwear down her legs, I continue to passionately kiss her. She pushes me up slightly, before asking if she can do the same to me. I smile against her lips between kisses, letting her know it's okay to do so. We kick the rest of clothes to the side before returning to the bed.

Adora slowly parts her legs, allowing me to completely sink against her body. She's pulls me closer to her encouraging me to move against her. My instinct guides me to gently rock my body against her body.

"Is this okay?" I ask between kisses.

"*Yes.* This feels nice. You can be a bit harder than that if you want. I-I don't mind."

As our kisses become more heated I start to pick up the pace of my movements. Adora's grip on my body becomes stronger. The room fills with sounds that I never knew either of us could make.

"Adora… you…ah… you feel amazing."

"Catra… ah… I love you"

I move from kissing her lips to kissing her neck, easily locating her pulse point. My instinct demands that I mark her, bite her, let everyone know she's mine. *Where did this primal instinct of being possessive come from?*

"Oh Catra."

Adora's clearly enjoying this, I can tell from the sounds I'm coaxing from her. I'm enjoying this too. I've never felt like this before and I an sense that there's more to come. My hand slowly starts to make its way down to the space between Adora's legs, but not before feeling the smooth swell of her breasts and the dip of her waist first. My claws lightly rake over her body, causing Adora to tremble under my touch.

I move to position myself over one of Adora's bent legs. I groan when I discover how wet she is, how wet I've made her just from my touch. My fingers move further south were I find a small, swollen and very damp bump at the top of her entrance. I gently press and move two fingers over it in delicate circles. Adora's breathing hitches slightly and I stop immediately worried that I have done something wrong.

“Sorry. Did I hurt you?”

Adora is quick to reassure me, her hands coming to hold the sides of my cheeks.

“What? No. You didn't hurt me in anyway I promise. I just felt weird for a second there. Not a bad weird, a good weird. It was like a jolt of electric pleasure, but... *down there.* You can do it again… i-if you want. I actually liked it.”

Thanks Stars, I was worried I’d hurt her. I gentle follow Adora’s lips back to her pillow and continue doing what I was doing before, slowly starting to grind atop of her leg. Adora’s hip eagerly buck up against my hand to meet my gentle strokes, that when I realize just how wet she really is.

“*Oh Catra… ah... oh wow that feels… oh*.”

The sounds that I manage to coax from Adora are intoxicating. I can't get enough of her. I can’t believe that I have the power to make her feel this way. My movements, both from my palm and my body, start to become faster. Something amazing has started to build up inside my core but it’s not enough. *I need to feel her, I need to feel her touch.*

“*Adora… ah… I need you. Adora, please… touch me.”*

“A-are you sure?”

I eagerly nod. Adora doesn’t hesitate and she quickly moves her hand to find my core, moving her finger exactly to where I need them most.

"Yes!”

I can’t help but cry through pure ecstasy. I’ve never felt this way before, *it’s amazing*. At first I was nervous but now I’ve never felt more alive. I can feel something happening, something exciting is building up as though it’s about to explode. Adora must be able to feel it too.

"Catra… I love you… ah… I love you so much… Catra I'm…"

"*Adora… ah… I love you… oh fuck…"*

I open my eyes to find Adora passionately staring back into mine. I lunge forwards capturing her lips with mine, deepening the kiss in an instance. We both moan into the kiss. Fresh heat pours onto my fingers as Adora's hips twitch frantically. My hips do the same across her thigh, it's like a fire has been ignited. Our movements become frantic as we both reach our climaxes. As they start to edge away, I lovely lay across Adora's chest as we both try to catch our breathes.

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"That was incredible!" I say as my breathing starts to steady.

Adora lightly giggles from underneath me. *"Yeah, it really was."*

Adora starts to shiver underneath me. Goosebumps visible across her forearms. She doesn't feel cold but if she feels anything like me then she's probably just overwhelmed. Using my tail I reach to pull the blanket up from the bottom of the bed over us both before wrapping my arms around her. Adora proceeds to the same and I immediately start to purr. I don't think I have ever been this happy.

Adora gently places a kiss on my forehead. "I love you."

I gently rise myself off her chest so I'm looking down at her, "I love you too *dummy*."

We both giggle as I gently kiss her on the lips before leaning back down to rest my head on her chest listening to her strong, steadying heartbeat. If we both weren't so exhausted right now I think we'd both be up for round two.

My body starts to relax even deeper and Adora's movements across the fur on my back is enough to try and lure me to sleep. My eyes start to feel heavy. I'm about to dose off Adora starts to giggle.

"What you giggling at?" I ask as a smirk appears across my face. I can't believe how much I love her laughter.

"Nothing… **giggles*…* it's nothing?"

"Come on you're going to have to tell me know. Spit it out… tell me."

I gently demand as I poke her in the side. Adora's giggling subsides and she starts to stroke through my mane with one of her hands.

"It's funny how I always dreamt of this: you, me, having a life together. I never thought we'd get the chance to have this. When you told me you loved me my world felt complete. I never allowed myself to fully dream or want things. I knew that all I ever wanted was you. I don't think I've ever been this happy."

My eyes start to water. I bury my face in Adora's chest hoping that she's hasn't noticed. For as long as I can remember I have loved Adora. I loved her long before I even knew what love was. I never once thought she'd love me back. Our future together always seemed like a fantasy to me. I never thought it would become our reality.

Adora places a gentle kiss to the top of my head. In response, I nuzzle myself further against her neck, placing a gentle kiss to her pulse point.

"I love you Adora."

"I love you too Catra."

Chapter End Notes

Hope you enjoyed reading this chapter. I have never written smut before so this was a real challenge but I think it turned out alright. I wanted to capture pure love and emotion that these two have for each other and I think I managed to achieve that.

Next week we head back to the main plot of this fic and things start to get complicated as a few spanners are thrown in the works. How will Catra and Adora face the new challenges that lie ahead? Find out Friday when Chapter 12 is released. See you then. ☺️

Spies Among Us

Chapter Summary

Adora and Catra are up for round two.

Scorpia has a problem.

Adora attempts dirty talk. 😌

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

A sudden chill makes its way down my spine as I start to awake. I wrap my arms tighter around the body that I am lying on top of. It feels cold, almost as if they aren't wearing any clothing… *wait a minute.*

My eyes dart open and to my surprise I'm lying across the top of Adora who is completely naked.

How on earth did I end up here?

The memories of last night's events slowly start coming back to me. The sounds I coaxed from Adora's lips, the feeling of her body against mine, the way her eyes looked into mine filled with nothing but love as we both came underdone underneath each other's touch. If it wasn't for the clear marks that we have left on each other's bodies I would have thought I was dreaming...

I had sex with Adora… YES!

My loud purr causes Adora to awake for her sleepy dazed.

Whoops... I can't help purring, it's an automatic response to being happy. I don't recall ever feeling this happy.

I wrap my arms around her body even tighter and push my head further against her chest as she starts to slowly awake.

"Did you seriously just nuzzle yourself further against my boobs?" Adora asks sleepily as a smile starts to appear across her face.

"Yes, yes I did. You going to do anything about it?"

Adora lightly giggles in response and places a kiss against the top of my head. One of her hands move off my back to stroke my mane. I place a gentle kiss to her sternum.

"I didn't think I've ever heard you purr this loud."

"Believe me if you could purr you'd also be purring this loud after having what might have been the most amazing night of your life."

I move further up Adora's body and place a gentle kiss to her collarbone, then her neck, then her chin, then her nose and finally her gorgeous lips. Adora leans into the kiss as if it were her lifeline. She skillfully moves me to the side of her without breaking the kiss, our bodies practically glued together. I don't know how she does this to me but she always manages to take my breathe away, *figuratively and literally.*

"You have no idea how much I love you Adora."

"Well considering you made love to me last night I think I have a pretty good idea. It was the most magical night of my life. I love you Catra. I love more than words can describe."

Adora's hand comes to rest against my cheek and her lips quickly find mine again. Our kiss is passionate, lustful and hungry. Adora slowly pushes against my shoulders, repositioning me so my back is laid flat against our bed, her body on top of mine. Her lips move from mine to my neck, gently sucking at my pulse point.

"*Adora*."

My claws gently scratch across her shoulder blades, not enough to make her bleed but enough to leave faint scratch lines. My tail moves to wrap around her right thigh. Adora's lower body presses harder against mine as she returns to kiss my lips. Warmth start to work its way through my body, just like it did last night.

"I love you so much Catra. You took such great care of me last night. Can we, maybe, do what we did last night again?"

I can't help but giggle.

"Adora, you do know you can say the word *sex* right?"

Adora's cheeks starts to blush.

"Alright, okay. Catra can I please have sex with you again?"

My arms fold around the back of Adora's neck and a mischievous grin appears across my face.

"You're such an idiot. Of course we can, besides…" I pull Adora's body closer to me and lustful whisper in her ear… *"I'd like to try see what other ways I can make you scream my name*."

Adora's body shivers against mine and my smile becomes wider knowing that I was the cause of that. Our lips meet once again, ours tongue battling for dominance. My hands rake down Adora back as one of hers strokes through my mane whilst her other works its way towards my chest.

"Can I touch you?" Adora asks looking directly into my eyes. I bite my bottom lip between my teeth and nod, waiting for the pleasure to overtake my body. I get an electric jolt down my spine when Adora's thumb light brushes across my very erect nipple, but it's not enough.

"Adora. I'm going to need more than that." It comes out more of beg than the sexy tone I was aiming for.

"Patience *Kitten*. All good things come to those who wait."

“Adora I swear if you call me that a-*ah*, *oh fuck*.”

Adora silences me as she lowers herself down, sucking one of my erect nipples whist gently massaging the other.

“A-Adora.”

My claws dig into her scalp, my chest arching up to meet her eager mouth. I try to retract my claws as I don’t want to hurt her but the feeling of having Adora being in control of my body feel so right.

“You were saying?” Adora asks with a smug grin appearing across her face.

“Who said you could stop?”

Adora lightly giggles, her hand brushing through my fur located at my cleavage. She slightly moves further up my body and rest her forehead against mine.

“Oh I’m not done with you yet. I just wanted to see how flustered you look. It’s cute.”

"I am *not* cute."

"Oh you most definitely are."

Adora giggles and places gentle kisses to my very reddened cheeks. I'll let this one slide. Only Adora is allowed to call me cute. Adora continues to place multiple kisses all over my face. As much as I love kissing her, her attention is needed elsewhere.

“Adora, please… I need you.”

“What do you need?”

Adora’s eyes are filled with nothing but love. Those eyes were the first thing I feel in love with and then the rest quickly followed. I trust her more than anything.

"You, all of you."

Adora's lips quickly find mine again, our tongues dance together as if this was a rehearsed routine. Adora's hand starts to travel towards my neck rather than where I want it to go.

"Wrong way Adora."

Adora lightly chuckles but keeps her hand resting on my cheek. She's nervous about something, I can tell.

"Are you sure? Like I know this isn't our first time and I did sort of touch you last night, but this will be my first time touching you like that, like *really touching you.*"

I move one of my hands from Adora's back and place it over hers that is rest on my cheek. I push my cheek further into her hand and start purring as a way of reassuring her.

"Adora I love you. I've loved before I even knew what love was. There's no right or wrong way of doing this. We're both still learning each other's *'turn-ons'* and *'turn-offs'*. We don't know until we try. I would love you touch me like that but if you're not ready that's…"

"No, No… I *really* want to touch you Catra. I just wanted to make sure that you're okay with me touching you like that before we do anything. I don't want to hurt you that's all."

"I trust you Adora. You would never hurt me. I promise that if I feel uncomfortable in anyway, shape or form I'll ask you to stop, but you have to do the same okay. Promise?"

"Okay, I Promise… I love you Catra."

"I love you too."

Our lips meet and Adora's full form is back on top of me. Her hand slowly makes its way southwards, stroking gently through my fur on my chest, waist and hips, all the way up until Adora

reaches where my fur becomes slightly darker. I don’t know why I suddenly feel nervous. It’s only Adora and I trust her more than anything. Adora must have been able to tell by the way my breathing slightly hitches when her hand reached my lower abdomen.

“You okay?”

“Yeah I’m fine. A little nervous but I’m fine.”

“You sure you want to do this?” Adora asks with genuine concern. As much as I love her I am starting to get a little impatient.

"I'm certain."

"You'll tell me to stop if you want me to..."

“Adora if you don’t fuck me right now I’ll either be shoving you’re hand down there for you or doing this myself. I love you and I trust you. I need now Adora!”

Adora chuckles and her lips target mine. I love her checking in on me but when your this 'turned-on' I needed things to move a little faster.

This is it, it’s happening. Adora’s hand starts to lower even further. I relax my body waiting for the pleasure to take over…

BANG! BANG! BANG!

What the fuck was that?

“Guys! I’m sorry to wake you but we’ve got a serious problem!”

For fuck sake Scorpia! Having a crush on me is one thing but ruining our very intimate moment just as things were about to get going is on a whole new level.

“Sure thing Scorpia. Give us ten minutes to urm... wake up and get our uniforms on and we’ll meet you in your quarters.”

“Okay. Thanks guys. Oh don’t tell anyone I asked you to come and meet me. I’ll explain later.”

Next thing I hear is Scorpia’s footsteps racing down the corridor. She sounded desperate, panicked even. She’s lucky Adora responded, my response would have been more direct. Adora turns back to face me, her body still on top of mine. Without even saying a single word we both burst out laughing. Of course this would happen to us. Shit like this always does.

“Sorry. I did not expect that to happen.”

“Don’t worry about it. Beside, you can make it up to me later.”

I lean up to place a gentle kiss to Adora’s lips before rolling her off me and getting out of bed to put my uniform on. I’ve been wearing my newer battle uniform, the same as the one I wore to Salineas more recently since I found out what effect the *‘boob window’* has on Adora. It’s funny watching her blush when out on missions, trying to control herself from taking me there and then. Adora has gone back to wearing her standard uniform, simply because she refused to part ways with her *‘lucky jacket’*. One day I’m going to rip that thing to shreds. I know she loves it but its getting old and she could really do with a new one.

Despite being the last one out of bed, Adora is the first one dress. It scares me how quick she can move. Adora's arms come to wrap around my waist, her chin resting on my right shoulder.

“I’m interested? How exactly do you plan to get me to scream your name?”

I turn my head slightly so that I’m looking at her through the corner of my eye. My arms moves around her so I can stroke my claws though her beautifully long blonde hair.

“I have a few ideas in mind, but you’re going to have to wait to find out.”

“Can’t wait.” Adora squeezes her arms around me a little tighter and pecks my cheek.

“Now come on lets go see what Scorpia wants. The sooner we get this over with the sooner you get to find out what I have planned for us.”

We’re about to leave both of our stomachs rumbles. “Good job I stole us those extra ration bars last night isn’t it”.

Adora’s hand leaves mine to get the two ration bars that I left on our bedside cabinet last night. I'm finish positioning my mask on my head when I hear Adora gasp in awww behind me...

“You managed to get the grey kind?”

“Only the best for the person I love.”

“Catra I love you so much.”

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Adora was called to meet with Hordak by one of the other guards before we even managed to get to Scorpia’s quarters. I would have gone with her but she insisted that I ‘*go and start training with our squadron. We wouldn’t want to disappoint them when we promised we’d be doing extra training drills with them today’,* before winking at me and walking in the opposite direction. That was my que to go and find Scorpia but be very discrete about it.

Once I’m certain the coast is clear I knock on Scorpia’s door.

“Hey, Scorpia. You wanted to…”

Before I can even finish my sentence two red claws dart forwards, one over my mouth and the other around my waist. I’m quickly

pulled into Scorpia's quarters and the door slam shut behind me.

"Scorpia what the fuck was that for?"

"Sorry. I didn't mean to startle you. You just can't be too careful. I don't want to get you into trouble."

Her voice is very nervy. Her claws and tail practically shaking. Something is clearly bothering her. I've never seen her like this before, not even at Salineas. She starts to pace.

"Scorpia try and clam down. What's gotten under your exoskeleton?"

I tried to lighten the mode with a joke but Scorpia is too distressed to even smile at the remark. *Okay whatever is bothering her is serious.*

"We'll I didn't want to wake you guys but I didn't know who else to turn to, or what to say or what to do. Oh this is all such a mess."

Scorpia slumps onto her bed with her tail wrapping around her legs and her hands on either side of her head. At least we now have clarification that she has no idea what Adora and I were up to this morning. I'm not the greatest of people when it comes to comforting someone. The Horde can take full responsibility for that.

I crouch down so I'm eye level with Scorpia. "Scorpia, I can't help you unless you tell me what's wrong."

Scorpia lifts her head up and looks straight into my eyes. They look glassy with unshed tears. She takes a deep sigh… "Hordak has reason to suspect…"

"HORDAK IS ONTO US!"

Adora bursts into the room much faster than Scorpio dragged me in here. She clearly ran here. My eyes dart between Scorpia and

Adora. I’m confused and angry.

“What do you mean, Hordak is onto us?”

Before anyone can say anything, the air vent above Scorpia’s dorms swings open and two long purple arms, *no wait that's hair*, attached to a person’s body slithers into the room. At first I want to panic but then I realize its only Entrapta. I forgot she makes her way around the Fright Zone via the air vents and pipes.

“Oh good, you’re all here. We need to work out what to do about the Hordak situation.”

There is bickering and chattering, nothing is making sense. I eventually lose my nerve…

“SHUT IT!"

Complete silence falls across the room and Adora, Scorpia and Entrapta turn to face me...

"Will someone please explain to me what the fuck is going on.”

There’s a tense silence that fills the room. Scorpia chooses to speak.

“Hordak has reason to believe that there is a spy within the Horde who is transferring information between here and the Rebellion. Despite having no solid evidence of this, he has reason to believe that Entrapta and I are the culprits.”

“Okay so what does that mean for us? Does Hordak know about our conversations with the Rebellion?”

“Judging for the data I’ve collected and the observations I have made, it’s impossible for him to know or have any record of any conversation that you have had with the Rebellion. The line I created is secure and even if he did somehow get his hands on any of the communications that have taken place they are highly

encrypted. So much so you'd be going mad trying to figure out what was discussed."

"*Sigh* Right, okay, but are you sure Hordak has no record of our conversations?"

"Positive. I have hacked his systems and there is absolutely no evidence to suggest that he has any trace of what has been said between you and the Rebellion."

"So why has he come to pinpoint you two as the spies?" Adora asks as she moves to stand beside me. Scorpia is the one who responds.

"Simply because we're princesses. He knows since I was a child I have always questioned how I ended up here and who I truly am. Let's face it, I'm not your typical Horde soldier. He also believes this started when Entrapta decided to join us, which technically he isn't wrong about."

There's another moments silence. I can't believe what I'm hearing right now. All our hard work could have been for nothing. The hope of creating a new life by ending this war, gone. What's worse is this could put Adora in serious danger, especially if Hordak finds out that we're the true traitors.

"Where do we go from here?" I ask looking towards Adora. Usually I'm the one with the answers but this time I really don't know. Adora's expressions reflects my own, *blank.*

"I do have an idea that may work, but it's very risky." Entrapta says, grabbing my attention. "Hordak clearly thinks that Scorpia and I are the only two imposters and it makes sense with us being the only two princesses in the Horde. Although can I actually be classed as a princess? Technically you need a runestone to be considered one and I don't have one…

"Entrapta, what's your point?"

"Oh right sorry. As I was saying, Hordak only suspects us two to be the traitors. The communication system, as I'm aware of, is still secure but I imagine Hordak will be trying to get access to whatever he can now he suspects something. Scorpia and I could make a break for it, which in turn would *'confirm'* Hordak's theory that we are in fact the imposters. That will give you two more time to work out a plan to rectify this and get your mission back on track."

"It's a good idea, but you two can't leave tonight. That would make it too suspicious, which could put Adora in danger."

"I think you mean that could put *both of us* in danger." Adora corrects me as her hand comes to rest on my shoulder. Scorpia looks at us with heart eyes, whereas Entrapta doesn't seem to notice.

"How much longer is the communications system safe to use Entrapta?"

"According to my calculations… eight hours. That's calculating the time for if Hordak's body armour doesn't malfunction like it has been doing. I would make him a new one but I don't have the technological resources required to create something better."

"Right then, here's what we're going to do. Scorpia, Entrapta you need to keep a low profile. Act like you normally would but don't raise suspicious. Entrapta, I need you to alter Scorpia's Horde badge, I know they track where we are using them. If you can get it to malfunction or even better destroy the tracking device once outside the Fright Zone that would be great. Ideally we may need you to keep hold of your badge so we can still communicate after you leave but we'll burn that bridge when we have to. Adora and I will get in contact with the Rebellion later tonight; we'll come up with a temporary solution. Adora, we may need to consider getting permission off Hordak to go on a *'scouting mission'* once these two leave to make it look like we're trying to track them down. You two need to be ready to leave in a few days. Only pack the essentials. Entrapta that means minimal tech. We don't say

anything about our mission until it's time to bust you two out of here. I've got a sneaky feeling Hordak's imp will be watching you two closely. This may be the only chance we have left to make things work."

We all agree that this is what we have to do if we are to continue with our mission. Entrapta stops us as we're about to leave Scorpia's quarters.

"You guys might want to go through the air vents. It's going to be quite busy out there and we don't want to raise suspicions."

I thought my days of climbing through vents were over?

Entrapta starts to open the vent when something catches my eye.

"Wait!"

The room falls silent, no one dare moves. A few seconds pass and nothing happens. I decide to investigate. I can't pick up a scent trail or see anything, but I know I saw something. It was too quick and quite to be Hordak's Imp. Something doesn't feel right. My fur remains standing on end as I lower myself back down to find the others staring and holding their breathes.

"You're allowed to breathe, *idiots."*

Their bodies relax and they all let out a deep sigh. *How did I end up becoming friends with and dating one of these three dummies?*

"What did you see?" Adora asks as she comes to stand beside me, looking up at the vent.

"I'm not sure but there was definitely something there."

"Whatever it was its gone now. My tracker pad is showing no signs of life. It was probably just a mouse."

"Believe me Entrapta, if it was a mouse Catra would have gone after it and we wouldn't have seen her for hours" Adora giggles.

I'm too zoned out to fully listen to their conversation. Adora's right though, if it was a mouse I would have been able to smell it and I would have gone after the little shit. I'm not sure what it was, from what I saw it looked like a…

"Hey, you okay?" Adora asks looking concerned. I had forgotten she was standing next to me.

"Yeah, just something doesn't feel right, but I'm fine I promise."

Entrapta enters the vent first, followed by Adora. Scorpia calls me once I've entered the vent…

"Hey Wildcat?"

"Yeah Scorp?"

"Thanks. You may not realize it but you're a good friend."

"Don't go all soft on me now Scorpia… I'll admit, you not too bad at giving hugs."

I hear Scorpia lightly giggle as I make my way back to our quarters through the air vents.

--

"What did the Glimmer say?"

Adora ask as she enters our dorm after returning from her shower. Her body is still showing traces of water droplets and her hair is hanging loosely over her left shoulder. *Stars I love it when she has her hair down.*

"*Sparkles* isn't overly happy that she's going to have to explain to Queen Sparkles that they may have to accommodate a Horde solider and apparent traitor for the purposes of keeping them safe

but I have explained what would happen to them if they stayed here and got caught. Not to mention that I also told her how we couldn’t have made it this far without them. Apparently she hasn’t even told Queen Sparkles about our whole ‘ending the war’ plan. We’ve also arranged to meet in the Whispering Woods in six nights time to try and come up with a solution to our problem. Scorpia and Entrapta will have leave before then.”

Adora is now sitting across from me on the bed, our knees touching together. She removes my mask from my head and places a gentle kiss on my cheek.

“I really don’t understand why you insist on putting your head mask on after a shower.”

“I feel naked without it.”

Adora giggles at my response. Its only like her wearing that stupid jacket 24/7. Adora moves to kiss me again and again. My arms move around her back as I move closer towards her so I’m sitting in her lap. My tail sways behind me as Adora begins to scratch my left ear.

“What’s gotten into you?” I ask playfully as a devilish smirk appears across my face. Adora breaks the kiss as a giggle crossed with a satisfied hum leaves her lips.

“The way you took charge earlier today was really hot… *I can confirm it's on of my 'turn-ons'.* I had to hold myself back from dragging you back here so I could wreck you until you couldn’t speak. That's what I intent to do right now. *Catra I’m going to fuck you so hard you won’t even remember you own name*.”

“Attempting dirty talk are we?”

"Thought I'd give it a go. Did it have any sort of effect on you?"

A growl as a low purr starts to form in my chest. Yes it did have an effect on my but rather than responding to Adora's question, I lightly nip her neck and I’m rewarded with a delightful gasp.

"Catra."

I move to capture Adora's lips with mine. Unlike this morning, our kisses are rushed and demanding. She's really riled up from this morning. Think I'll have to use my *Force Captain voice* more often if it has this effect on her.

"Want to finish off what you started this morning? I was *very* disappointed when we got interrupted."

"I'd like that, but on one condition. You show me how you're going to get me to scream you're name."

"All in good time *princess*."

With that Adora pushes me off her lap and into the mattress with a sexy yet displeased look on her face. "Call me that again and I'll withhold sex back for a month."

"Yeah right. Like you could resist *this*."

Adora starts to laugh with me. She knows I'm right. She wouldn't be able to keep her hands off me if she tried. "Alright, *Kitten,* two can play at that game."

Adora knows I hate that pet name. If she wasn't being so sexy and I wasn't so wound up right now I would have taught her a lesson. Adora dives forwards pinning my hands above my head and our bodies come together, still fully clothed. Adora places a series of kisses all over my face before she moves so we're looking at each other eye to eye.

"Adora."

"The one who gets the other scream their name the loudest wins?"

"You're one!"

"Hope you're prepared to lose."

“Oh I never lose.”

Chapter End Notes

Hope you enjoyed reading Chapter 12. The plot is starting to expand 😱 - What do you think Catra saw? What do you think this new plan will entail? Will Catra and Adora get to speak to Glimmer and Bow without suspicions being raised? Find out on Monday when the next chapter is released. See you then.

P.S - Thank you so much for your kind words last week. I can't even begin to tell you all how much they mean to me reading them. Thank you so much for your love and support throughout this fic. You're all amazing. I love reading your comments, thoughts and theories on what you think will happen. Can't wait to share the rest with you. ☺️

New Plan

Chapter Summary

Catra discovers why Brightmoon is called Brightmoon.

Sparkles and Arrow Boy make things difficult.

A new plan is created.

Chapter/Creator Warning: Panic Attack

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"*Don't worry about us Wildcat, we'll fine. I've got Entrapta and Emily to keep me company. Take care of her Wildcat. We'll see you soon."*

Those we're Scorpia's last words to me. They both left last night under the cover of darkness. Adora and I escorted them to the Fright Zones' boundaries before they departed. I was on edge all night and have been ever since. Even since we came up with the plan to get them out of here I feel like our every move has been being watched. I'll sometimes feel a chill of air. I mean the Fright Zone is a cold place, why do you think Adora and I sometimes slept in the same bunk at night, but this feeling I keep getting… *it feels wrong.*

"Hordak has given permission for us to go on a scouting mission. He didn't seem to suspect anything. But I'd avoid going to anywhere near him for a while. Hordak's not in the best of moods at the moment. In fact he seems angry, upset even, not sure why."

How oblivious can she be? Stars I love this dork.

I can’t hold back my laughter. Adora still looks as confused as ever.

“You’re such an idiot. Could you not tell something was going on between Entrapta and Hordak?"

Adora continues to look at me with a blank expression. Clearly she hasn't worked it out. *How did I fall in love with this dork?*

"Hordak *likes* Entrapta. Did you seriously not see the way he looked at her when they worked on experiments together? Of course he’s going to be upset she’s gone.”

I can see the cogs ticking in Adora’s mind. She's slowly putting the pieces together. Her expression when she realizes I’m right is so much funnier than her not figuring it out in the first place.

“In my defense, I didn’t even you loved me until you told me you did.”

Adora trails off and her cheeks start to burn up. I slowly move off our bed, place my hands on either side of her cheeks and bring her head down to place a kiss to her forehead. *I can’t believe I have to stand on my tiptoes to kiss her like this. The height difference is embarrassing.*

“It’s okay *dummy*. That’s nothing to be embarrassed over. It’s actually one of the many things that made me fall in love with you in the first place.”

Adora starts to blush and connects her lips with mine.

“I love you, you know that?”

“Of course I know. You tell me everyday and at one point that was the only thing you managed to say, *other than crying out my name*.”

“At least I wasn’t the one who could hardly walk to a Force Captain meeting.”

"Don't remind me. Scorpia kept asking me if was I alright and Entrapta offered to do a body scan to see what was wrong. I had to tell them I'd only *'sprained my tail bone'* from combat training with our squadron. Now *that* was embarrassing. I'll get my *payback* sooner or later."

"You have to admit it was worth it though."

"Oh yeah it was definitely worth it, especially considering I won our little bet."

Adora starts to giggle again and rests her forehead against mine. She knows I'm not wrong. At one point I had to clamp my hand over her mouth to prevent her from waking up the entire Fright Zone. That was a night I'll never forget.

A few minutes pass were Adora and I continue to hold each other, content with each other's company. A low purr emits from my chest as we both start to relax.

"Did I ever tell you how much I love it when you purr."

"Hum, that's why I do it, because I know you love."

"It helps me relax. Makes me feel safe… sometimes reminds me of when you used to sing."

"You know I only ever sang for you right?"

A smile appears across Adora's face and her eyes open, looking directly into mine. "Your voice was one of the first things that made me fall in love with you."

I haven't sang in a very long time, not since I was punished by Shadow Weaver for my talents. I'd quietly sing to Adora whenever she was sick, had woken up from extreme nightmares or was extremely stressed from the day's events. Shadow Weaver caught me signing to Adora one day when she was unwell and threatened to silence me by ripping out my vocal cords with her own hands. That threat came a few weeks before Adora got

promoted to Force Captain. I convinced myself that Shadow Weaver was just *jealous* of my talents but I haven't sang properly since. I know how much Adora misses me singing to her but she's never admitted it.

"I'll make you a promise. Once all of this is over and we're free to live our lives how we want… I'll start singing again, but *only for you*."

Adora places a gentle kiss to me lips, "I'd like that. I'd like that very much."

--

"All clear."

It's now nightfall. Adora and I have made our break for it to meet with the Rebel's: Sparkles and Arrow Boy. We're at the edge of the Whispering Woods. There doesn't appear to be anything near here and it seems safe enough to enter.

I wonder if we'll have time to find that old lady I meet on the day we attacked Salineas? I could do with thanking her for patching Adora up. Without her help, Adora may not have made it. I could also do with working out how she knows me.

"Where did you say we were meeting Glimmer and Bow again?"

"Somewhere in the Whispering Woods. This place is always shifting so finding them might be tricky. Sparkles said to keep an eye out for a bright sparkly light, that means we're near Brightmoon."

We take off our Horde Badges and bury them in the dirty, that way we can't be tracked.

“I get why we’re doing this but how are we going to find them again?”

“Entrapta gave me this before we left.” I respond holding up a small grey emitter. “It’s a low frequency emitter. Only my sensitive hearing can hear it. I’ll be able to locate our badges on the way back and if Hordak asks why our tracker locations haven’t moved from this point we'll argue there may have been a malfunction. He’s not likely to doubt his two most *‘loyal’* soldiers is he?”

That seems to ease Adora’s mind. She takes my hand and we enter the Whispering Wood together… *Both of us oblivious that we were being followed.*

--

Brightmoon is in our sights. No wonder Hordak hasn’t attacked this place yet, it’s a lot bigger and brighter than I initially imagined. It’s very fitting for the name *‘Bright’moon*. The weaponry expansions and the robotic adjustment make a lot more sense now. Brightmoon is the powerhouse of the Rebellion and will definitely be the most difficult mission in the Horde’s entire history.

“Wow… it beautiful.”

“Not as beautiful as the view standing next to me.”

Adora blushes. She places her arm across my shoulder, pulling me closer to her before placing a kiss to my cheek. My fur is slightly bristled but not from the cold air. Adora is able to pick up on it straight away and attempts to comfort me.

“Everything going to be okay, I promise.”

“I… I hope you’re right.”

A deep sigh escapes me and Adora pulls me into a gentle, yet strong embrace, her head resting against mine. For a few moments nothing is said, we just hold each other, trying to clear our thoughts.

“It’s okay to be scared. I’m scared too.” Adora says softly and she places a kiss to my forehead. She always been able to tell how I feel.

“What are you scared of? You’re like the strongest person I know.” I ask, my voice trembling slightly when I speak.

Adora sighs deeply and holds me tighter, “I'm... I’m scared of losing you Catra. If something happened to you I don’t know what I’d do.” Adora’s hands come to rest on either side of my cheeks and moves my head so we looking eye to eye. Adora’s eyes appear watery with unshed tears. “Everytime something good happens in my life it gets taken away from me or I’m made to feel like I don’t deserve it. It scares me Catra.”

Tears slowly start to fall from Adora's eyes and her body starts to tremble. I place my hands onto Adora’s cheeks and wipe away her tears with my thumbs as they fall. I use my tail to pull our bodies even closer together.

“I know how you feel Adora… I really do. I thought I’d lost you after the battle at Salineas. My world shattered into a million pieces. I was angry, upset and hurt. I can’t even begin to describe how I felt when you woke up. Adora if something had happened like I thought it would I would have never forgiven myself. I don’t even know how I would have been able to go on. You don’t need to worry about losing me Adora. We’re a team, *soulmates* even. You’re the love of my life. I’m not going anywhere. *Where you go, I go*.”

“You Promise?”

“I Promise.”

Adora tears fade. I move my hands to the back of her head, stroking through her tied up hair. Her body starts to relax under my touch.

"Urm, *Hello*?"

Adora and I jump out of our sink, *technically fur if your me*, only to realize that Sparkles and Arrow Boy are standing behind us.

"How long how you two been standing there?" I ask slightly embarrassed.

"Long enough to understand how much ending this war means to the both of you." Sparkles responds with childish grin on her face.

Adora starts to giggle. Of course she finds it funny… to be honest, it is kind of funny, this would only happen to us. I start to giggle with her.

"What took you two so long anyway… *is he okay?"* I ask pointing towards Arrow Boy. He has tears in his eye.

"I'm fine. Honestly… **sniff**… I'm going to need a moment."

"Urgh, you want to try escaping that castle when you've got guards literally everywhere after your mom ordered them to guard the entire castle for more *Horde Scums*. Now come on, we need to go somewhere private so we don't get spotted."

Sparkles grabs mine and Adora's arms and pulls us closer to her.

"What are you… ****PUFF****"

--

Glitter forms all around us and I collapse onto my knees feeling dizzy and nauseous. Adora gently helps me up, helping me find

my balance.

"How about a warning next time."

"Oh don't be so dramatic. It's not *that* bad."

We've entered deeper into the heart of Whispering Wood. A mysterious tower stands before us.

"What is this place" Adora asks. She looks gob-smacked. Bow is the one who answers.

"*This?* This is a First-Ones Ruin?"

"What's a First-One?" Adora and I ask in unison.

"*You've never heard of the First-Ones?!"* Sparkles asked shocked. Adora shakes her head in response.

"Wouldn't be asking if we knew would we Sparkles?"

"What exactly do the Horde teach you?" Bow asks, partially out of curiosity and concern.

"Oh you know the usual stuff: *Combat training, Hordak's superiority, how to live a miserable childhood, how to defeat the evil princesses 101*… pretty standard for a day in the life of a Horde soldier." I respond with a slight smirk across my face. I didn't expect Sparkles and Arrow boy to look so shocked. Adora is still in a trance from the tower.

"Hey Adora, you doing okay?"

"Oh yeah sorry. Got a bit distracted there. I can't help but feel like I've seen these somewhere before."

"*Like where?* Adora we've never been here before."

"I know that but they seem so *familiar*, like I've seen them in a dream something."

Adora starts to trace her hands across the ruins writing, a puzzled expression appears across her face.

"Okay as fascinating as this must be for both of you we unfortunately don't have time to discuss the First-Ones ruins and history. We need to discuss what we're going to do now we can't communicate the same way anymore." Sparkles interrupts, frustration clearly written on her face.

"Glimmers right. I'm not sure how much time we've got before her mom realizes we're gone and let just say she's *scary* when she's mad."

Not sure if anyone can be as scary as Shadow Weaver but I'll take their word for it.

"We don't exactly have a plan as such, but we have a solution." Adora states as she looks towards me to explain.

"We got Entrapta to alter Scorpia's Horde badge so we can still communicate with you via the badge without the tracking system being activated." Sparkles and Arrow Boy avert their eyes from looking at us, "…they did make it to Brightmoon, didn't they?"

"Oh sure they did, *but Glimmer*…"

"… I kind of destroy the badges once they arrived so they couldn't be tracked."

"YOU DID WHAT!"

"I had no choice. I didn't know you got Entrapta to alter the badge so they couldn't be tracked. It's simply an accident."

Great there goes our new plan. Now what do we do?

A few frustrating minutes pass and nothing is said. I'm honestly not sure what we can do know. All hope seems lost…

“I may have an idea. It’s not the best but it seems like our only option left.” Adora says with confidence in her voice. She looks to me for reassurance, I smile and take her hand in mind, giving it a reassuring squeeze. Adora's not usually one to have great ideas but it's worth hearing what she has to say.

“We could transfer information between ourselves the old way. You could elect someone from the Rebellion, or even yourselves, and we’ll elect someone, more likely one of us, to meet them every night or so to transfer information between each other. If it gets to dangerous we’ll have to stop what we’re doing.”

“No Adora, I won’t let you risk it. It’s too dangerous.”

“Yes it is dangerous, but it may be our only chance. I’m not setting it in stone that it has to be one of us. There are people in the Horde who want out of this war as much as we do. We’d just have to work out if we can trust them.”

“Adora… *I know who you’re on about.* They told me they want out of the war after they saw what happened to you at Salineas. I want to trust them but…”

A few moment pass. I don’t know what to do anymore. I hear what Adora's saying and I want it to work, I really want to but we've just lost two of the only other people I trust. I don't want the same situation to happen again. Not to mention something feels uneasy about the whole situation, something doesn't feel right at all. I can't loose Adora, I won't lose Adora. She means everything to me... she's all I have.

My thoughts quickly spiral and panic quickly sets in. Adora realizes what is going on before I'm even able to recognize it myself. She immediately pulls me into a tight hug, whispering reassuring words into my ear*… ‘It’s okay Catra’… ‘I’m here’… ‘I’ve got you’… 'I love you"...* Adora doesn’t let go until she feels my body relax against her hold, my breathing steadying once more. I eventually move back slightly to find her beautiful eyes looking at me filled with nothing but love and patience.

“I understand that you’re scared, I'm scared too, but this may be the only chance we have left. Please Catra, *trust me*.”

I take a deep breathe before responding. “I trust you Adora. I always have and I always will.”

“Thank you.” She places a gentle kiss before turning back to Sparkles and Arrow Boy. Her hand never lets go of mine… “Okay, here’s what we’re going to do.”

--

We part ways with Sparkles and Arrow Boy shortly after agreeing on the final part of our new plan. It’s risky but it’s one I’m willing to take. I’m prepared to risk it all if it means I can have a secure future with Adora.

It’s a calm, silent walk back to the Fright Zone. My mind trails back to this morning, realizing that something needs to be said that I forgot to say this morning…“I love you too.”

Adora stops in her tracks and turns to face me.

“I didn’t get chance to say it back this morning. Just wanted to make sure that you still remember that I love you.”

Adora’s smile and she lifts my hand that is laced with hers, bringing it to her lips, before placing a gentle kiss to it.

“I know today was scary and I know you don’t really open up about your feelings much but I’m glad you did. I’m proud of you Catra and… thank you for trusting me.”

The love I have for Adora grows strong and strong every day. Scorpia was right, my love for Adora doesn't make me weak, it makes me stronger.

The urge I have had for a while comes back with vengeance. *I swear it's the commanding voice she used during our conversations with the rebels*. I lunge forwards, pushing Adora back into a nearby tree. Our lips aggressively meet each other. I deliberately push my leg between Adora's, pushing them a part, before ever so sneakily positioning my leg where I can sense she needs it. I'm rewarded with a delicious gasp.

"Couldn't wait till we got back?"

"It's *your* fault. You shouldn't be so beautiful looking then should you? Besides don't act like you don't want this, I can smell how turned on you are right now."

Adora pulls my body closer to hers, her hand stroking through my mane. *Are we really going to do this in the middle of the woods? Well, I'm always up for something new so why not.* It's then I notice the annoying clicking sound and I can't stop my ear from aggressively twitching. My eyes scrunch closed with annoyance as I try to ignore it. Adora notices this and breaks the kiss.

"Sorry was that a bit too rough?" she's asks gently stroking my twitching ear.

"No its not you. I can hear the emitter. We must be close to the Fright Zone."

"Think *you* can hold back until then?" Adora asks with a devilish smirk.

"I'm going to have to or I'm going to be tormented by that damn thing until we find it and turn it off".

I release my hold on Adora and we follow the sound back to our badges. Only there's a problem…

"They're gone!"

"What do you mean they're gone?"

“I mean they’re not here. They’ve been dug up and taken. The emitter’s gone too.”

“But you can still hear it right?”

Click, Click, Click

“Yeah I can still hear it… ***click, click, click***… it’s coming from inside the Fright Zone!”

Adora and I sprint into the Fright Zone, desperately trying to locate where our badges have been taken to. *Shit, how did this happen?*

“We must have been being followed?”

“I don’t see how. The coast was clear when I checked and I couldn’t pick up any unusual scents.”

The clicking noise gets louder the further we move down the corridor. I come to an immediate stop when the repeated clicking becoming a solid click. Adora slams right into the back of me, almost knocking both of us over.

“They’re in there!”

We both look at each other confused. *Why an earth would be they be here?* We enter the room cautiously and are shocked when we see who greets us…

“Want to explain what’s going on?”

Chapter End Notes

> Not another Cliffhanger. 😱 As you know I hate cliffhangers but I couldn't resit keeping you on edge. Who do you think has caught them? What are your theories?
>
> Hope you enjoyed reading Chapter 13. Thank you for all your kind comments last week. I loved reading your theories on

who/what you think is spying on them. Please keep sharing your theories with me. I love them all. The true answer will be revealed soon. Also I hoped you liked my headcanon that Catra sings for Adora. It's one of my personal favourites. The next chapter update will be this Friday. See you then. 😊

P.S - Warning for the next chapter: please, please, please read the tags and make sure your still comfortable reading this fic - they're all up to date. One of them is a spoiler tag so it won't be put in the chapter summary but at the end notes of next weeks chapter. Just wanted to give you a warning.

Consequences

Chapter Summary

Who's been spying on Catra and Adora?

The new plan is in action.

There are Consequences when you lose your loyalty to the Horde.

Chapter/Creator Warnings: Blood & Injury, (Spoiler Warning in end notes and tags)

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Want to explain what's going on?"

Shit! This is not good. This is not good at all. Of all the people who could have found out why them?

Adora and I can only look at each other in shock. Who knows how much they've heard or saw, or how long they've been spying on us. I'm not sure how to respond to this. We need to be careful with how much we tell them. For all we know they could be bluffing.

"Tell you what, how about we tell you what we think is going on and then you tell us if we're right?"

Six's voice comes across sharp and stern. She's not happy and rest of the squadron isn't either. They all look betrayed.

"You thought it would be a good idea to communicate with the Rebellion to try and end this war. We have no idea how long this has been going on for but I'm going to guess a good couple of months or even perhaps over a year, probably not too long after

Salineas. Then, in Delta's words, 'a spanner was thrown in the works' meaning you have to communicate with the opposition directly, which has risked you almost everything. *Am I right?"*

Great, they know everything. There's no chance of ending this war now. Chances of being sent to Beast Islands, or worse, are 100%.

I can't bear to look at them right now. The look on everyone's faces says it all. It would be easier to take if it was only the newest members of our squadron, but no. We also have to face our old squadron too. They show more hurt than the young ones, especially Lonnie. Not that I care, she hates me anyway. Adora chooses to answer…

"It's true, but we have our reasons for doing it. Please, give us a chance to explain…"

"There's nothing to explain. We watched it all on camera."

Wait, what Camera?

"What do you mean, you watched it all on camera!?" I ask as I turn to reface the team. *How long have they been spying on us?*

"Delta and I were finishing our daily tasks when we noticed both you and Adora making your way out the Fright Zone. You had been avoiding us for a few days and we assumed it was because you had *'commanding'* duties to attend to. We became concerned after we saw Scorpia and Entrapta leaving the Fright Zone and not returning. Not to mention that we recently heard that Hordak has suspicions that there are Rebel spies within the Fright Zone. So we decided followed you to the edge of the Whispering Woods. We wouldn't go any further as we would have had no idea where we were going. So Delta sent out one of her micro spy bots to follow you. We saw everything."

"That doesn't explain why you took our badges." I growl. Spying on us in one thing but taking our badges is another. *What if they had gotten into the wrong hands.*

"Catra has a point. I understand why you choose to follow us… well sort of follow us, but that doesn't explain why you took our badges."

"Isn't it obvious?! We all know Hordak tracks our every move through our badges. If he saw you standing at the edge of the Whispering Woods for the past hour he would have gotten suspicious."

I walk forwards ever so slightly. The rest of the squadron take a step back but Six refuses to move. Something isn't adding up.

"You could have easily sold us out to Hordak yet you didn't. Why?"

At first Six doesn't respond. She turns to face the rest of the squadron. It's almost as if they're telepathically communicating. They all nod in unison and she turns back to face me.

"We have all lost something because of the Horde. As you know I lost my family and my best friend. Delta was unwilling taken from her home after Hordak discovered how advance her skills with technology are. Shadow is constantly bullied by others who aren't members of our squadron. Those idiot refuse to accept that they are who they are and respect their pronouns. Stinger had his sting removed when he was young simply because he fought back. We have all been effected by the Horde in different ways. We have all felt like worthless misfits at some point during our lives..."

Stinger removes their prosthetic sting from the tip of his tail to emphasis Six's point. Adora's and I look at each other in shock. We never realized what our squadron members were having to overcome. I feel so blind for not realizing any of this sooner. No one should ever have to feel like their worthless. Sure everyone one is different but that's what makes them unique. It now becoming clear what Entrapta meant when she said ***'Imperfections are Beautiful'***.

"But then we met you two. You made us feel like we were worth something. Made us realize that we are more than just Horde

soldiers. We're individuals who deserve to live our lives how we want. But were not free to live our lives if the Horde conquers Etheria. Despite everything in this dark world we learned how to trust and love those around us because of you two. We became a family and over everything family stick together. We want to help. We want to end this war."

I need a moment. How after everything they have heard and seen on that little spy camera can they still trust and forgive us? That's not how things work in the Horde. People aren't forgiven just like that.

I turn to face Adora to find that she has an encouraging smile on her face. It reassures me that it is worth taking the risk. The rest of the squadron is also smiling as if in agreement to help, *all except Kyle, Rogelio and Lonnie that is.*

"And what about you three?" I ask. Kyle is the one to respond.

"We want to help. Like Six said, we're family and family stick together. We don't understand why you didn't tell us sooner. We could have helped."

"It's not that simple Kyle." Adora responds and she moves to stand beside me. "We agreed not to tell anyone anything as we didn't want anyone getting hurt because of us. The only reason I told Scorpia was because…"

"YOU TOLD SCORPIA AND NOT US!" Lonnie shouts, her face turning redder with every word.

"Yes Lonnie, I told Scorpia. At the time Scorpia was the only other person Catra trusted and you can't really blame her for that, especially with the way you treated her when growing up."

Damn Adora went there. That seems to put Lonnie in her place, she refuses to argue with that point. Adora continues…

"The main reason I told Scorpia was because I didn't want Catra to be alone should anything have happened to me at Salineas. I

wanted to make sure she had someone to look out for her should the worst happen. I love her and will do anything I can to protect her."

Great now I'm blushing. Adora takes my hand and gives in a gentle squeeze, before bending down an placing a butterfly kiss to my cheek. I can see from the corner of my eye that Kyle and Rogelio are smiling. Lonnie is slightly but she's trying to not make it obvious. Adora addresses them once more…

"So, do you want to help us?"

They all look to each other, confirming what they feel is the right thing to do.

"Raw, grumble, raw."

"Rogelio says he's in and so am I."

That just leaves Lonnie. We all look at her, patiently waiting for her answer.

"Alright I'm in, but this doesn't mean I'll make more of an effort to get along with Catra."

"Believe me Lonnie, the feelings mutual."

Although Lonnie and I don't get on, I think we can manage to put our differences aside if it means we can end this war once and for all.

"Before anything else, do us all a favor and save your love acts for when you're in your quarters please. We're all happy that your together considering you two were hopeless lesbians growing up but we don't want to see all the details of your relationship."

The rest of the squadron burst out laughing at Lonnie's remark as both Adora and I aggressively blush.

“Hehe, how much of that did you actually see?” Adora asks clearly embarrassed.

“Oh we saw enough.” Lonnie responds as she tries to stifle her laughter. I need to try and get the attention away from us, *or me at least…*

“It was Adora’s fault, she can’t resist me.” I respond in a flirtatious tone which causes Adora to giggle.

“Actually it looked like it was you Catra that made the first move.” Delta remarks as she flips the camera that has embarrassingly recorded our every move.

“Catra has always been the one to make the first move when it comes to Adora. We even had a bet going at one time when we expected Catra to tell Adora about her feelings for her. I won one of Kyles’ ration bars as he thought Adora would cave first and tell Catra about her feelings for her first. ”

My ears lie flat against my head and my tail twitches anxiously, my cheeks burning up even more. I’m more than embarrassed by the whole thing but getting to see Adora laugh makes it all worth it.

“Alright we get it. Although I do have to agree with them Catra, you did make the first move back there. Not to mention that you are also right with that fact that I can’t resit you… you are very cute.”

“I am not cute!”

“Are too.”

“Am Not!”

“You most definitely are and you can’t deny it.”

“Urgh, okay I’ll admit I’m cute but this is *not* because I like you.”

“Oh I know… it’s because you *love* me.”

How on earth did I end up falling in love with this beautiful dork?

Next thing I know, Stinger is pulling everyone into a group hug. He really is just like Scorpia, maybe even a slightly stronger hugger too. If he hugs us any tighter I might suffocate.

If I wasn't facing this way I might not have seen it. Something appears to be watching us in the corner of the barrack vents before it slithers away. I didn’t get a clear look at it simply because I was being crushed but it looked like it had a dark tail or tentacle of some sort, I'm not quite sure. Whatever it was it’s gone now but something seems suspicious about this, maybe even familiar. I almost looked like a…

“You okay?” Adora asks, making me jump out of my fur. I forgot she was standing beside me.

“Yeah I’m fine. I thought I saw something.”

Adora looks to where I was looking a few moments ago. The fact that this had happen a few times now makes me feel on edge.

“Should we be worried?”

I’m about to answer when Six interrupts “So what’s the plan?”

Adora gives me a look as if to say *‘we’ll talk later’* before she leaves my side to fill the rest of the team in on our mission. We can discuss what I saw later on tonight. That can be a discussion for future Catra and Adora. Until then we’ll have to be careful.

--

Our plan had been working perfectly. Messages containing vital information about Horde plans and developments have been successful passed between us and the Rebellion. It was so much easier having our team helping us. Some of Scorpia’s squadron were let in on the plan an immediately agreed to help, saying that they owed their life to their Force Captain.

Everything was going according to plan. That was up until Hordak called an emergency meeting.

Hordak stated that had reason to believe that the Rebellion was still somehow managing to obtain information of the Horde’s plans. At first we all thought he was bluffing, that was until he showed us one of Scorpia's squadron members in one of the Fight Zone cells. That’s when things started to get difficult. Hordak ordered more patrols within the Fright Zone making it harder for messages to be secretly transferred in and out of the Fright Zone. To make matters more extreme he threatened to send anyone who dares defy their loyalty to him to Beast Island. Many thought that place was a myth, told to young soldiers to make sure they stay in check. Turns out Beast Island was the one thing the Horde didn’t lie about.

We agreed that individuals carrying messages to the Rebellion would not return to the Fright Zone after they got out of the barriers, it was too risky. Our squadron members refused to abandon us but after a little persuasion from Adora some agreed to do as we asked. Lonnie, Kyle, Rogelio and Six on the other hand still need a bit more encouragement. I even attempted to reason with Six but she still refuses to abandon us after she had delivered the notes to the Rebellion, claiming that she has already lost some much and she wanted to continue to fight to the end like the others. As much as we all admire Six’s persistence, it was about to become her worst enemy...

--

“Some of you seem to think this is all a bluff. That Beast Island is nothing but a myth, a ruse to scare you all into pledging your allegiance to the Horde. I kid you not! These images you see before you are of the real Beast Island and these images are of all those who have betrayed me…”

Hordak has called every Horde solider to his lair. Adora and I initially thought it was about the upcoming attack on Brightmoon, which is planned to be in motion in three weeks’ time. We managed to persuade Six to leave the Fright Zone and meet us at Brightmoon on the day of the planned attack. Lonnie, Kyle and Rogelio had agreed to stay with us at the Fright Zone to avoid raising suspicions. The rest of the squadron left one by one taking notes with vital information to the Rebellion. Six was the last one to leave, carrying the message that gave the final details and date of the attack. We were surprised to find that this meeting was in fact about his *‘betrayers’*, when really the true betrayers are standing right beside him.

“Despite my warnings some of you still refuse to recognize that what I say is true. I thought I should introduce you all to the next person I am sending the Beast Island for their disloyalty, just to prove to each and every one of you who plans to betray me will suffer a similar fate. BRING THEM IN!”

The doors swing open and two Horde guards appear, dragging a small body across the floor. Whoever it is they're clearly trying to fight back. However, their sloppy movement makes it obvious that they have been beaten before coming here and quite badly from the looks of it. At first I can’t see who it is but as the guards throw their body down onto the cold floor it becomes all too clear…

“*Six?”*

Six’s body is covered in bruises and cuts, fresh blood seeping for one of the cuts on her lips. Her hands are tied behind her back

making it harder for her to get up from her position on the floor. Adora and I have to hold ourselves back for running forwards to help her. I turn to face Adora, trying to keep my emotions from showing. The look in Adora's eyes says it all… *fear, confusion and guilt*. I'd be lying if I said I didn't feel the same way. Six is in the position because of us.

But how did she get caught? She left when she was on 'scouting duties' under the cover of darkness? She should be with the Rebellion. How did this happen?

"This pathetic being tried to escape and failed miserably. My little spy spotted her returning to the Fright Zone after what can only be assumed communicating with the enemy. I personally saw to it that she was captured before she could attempt to leave again this morning. She will be being sent to Beast Island and you all shall receive a video of her arrival later this afternoon to prove to you that I never bluff. If you lose your loyalty to me you will face the consequences."

I refuse to listen to whatever bullshit that this bastard is saying right now. How can anyone do this and get away with it?

In all the commotion, Six has somehow managed to find her feet and now stands tall and proud. Hordak finishes his speech and takes a few steps towards her. If he dare lays a hand on her he's going to regret it. I don't care if that blows our mission, she's already suffered enough, she doesn't deserve this. They look at each other dead in the eye.

"Any last words *traitor*?" Hordak asks in his deep toned voice.

Six takes a few deep breathes, moves her eyes ever so slowly to look behind him, sees Adora and I, before moving her eyes to look back as Hordak. A proud smirk appears across her face and she speaks with pride.

"For Etheria!"

Those two words may not seem like much but to Adora and I they mean everything. Six, just like everyone else who has helped us with our mission, has never been fighting for the Horde… *they have been fighting for themselves, for us, for Etheria.*

Hordak orders his guards to take Six to the ship that is waiting to take her to Beast Island. Six meets his eyes as she's dragged out of the room, her proud smirk never leaving her face. Hordak actually starts to show signs of being intimidated. We are then dismissed. Adora and I can only hope that Six somehow finds a way to escape and survive.

--

I haven't been able to find Adora anywhere. She wasn't at dinner so I brought some ration bars back to our dorm. She wasn't there either. She wasn't even in the shower rooms or the training rooms, which is very concerning. I'm getting worried. The only place I haven't thought of looking is our old Barracks and the watch-tower platform. I'll check the barracks first as I pass them on my way to the watch tower.

The Barracks are dark and empty. Mine and Adora's sketches that we drew when we were kids is still on the wall of our old bunk. It brings back good memories. We have had may great memories in these 4 walls, like sleepovers, playing tricks on Kyle and whispering about… *whatever.*

I notice something on the bunk next to us. The bunk below Lonnie's was vacant when we last slept in the barracks and I remember it became Six's bunk when she joined our squadron. It's a piece of paper that has been folded multiple times. I open in. It's Six's handwriting and it reads ***'Adora & Catra'***. I fold it back over, refusing to read any further without Adora. She can't be too far.

--

“Adora! Adora are you up there?” I shout as I make my way up the watch tower.

When I reach the top I find Adora but she doesn’t greet me the way she always does. Her knees are tucked up against her chest, her arms wrapped around them. She has tears in her eyes. I immediately run over to her, wrapping my arms and tail around her body. She lets go of her legs and immediately wraps her arms around me as tight as she can. Her head rests against my chest as she continues to cry.

“Shhh. It’s okay. I’m here. I’m not going anywhere.. I’ve got you. I love you.” I repeat over and over. Adora eventually calms down but a few tears still escape her eyes. Her tight hold on me remains, she refuses to let go just yet. She then mumbles into my chest…

“Six didn’t make it to Beast Island.”

“What do you mean?”

“Hordak called me back after everyone left. He wanted to show me what was really going to happen to her after everyone left. He blew up the ship, he blew it up whist she was still on it. It was horrible Catra, no one survived that blast.”

Adora buries her head further against my chest and she starts to cry again. This time I join her. Of all the things Hordak could have done he took this too far. This is now personal.

“This is all my fault.”

“Adora don’t think like that.”

“But i-it is Catra. I-If we had l-left when it a-all s-s-started…”

“Shhhhh. Try and calm down. Deep breathes, breathe with me.”

Adora starts to breathe with the rising and falling of my chest although it is difficult for her to do when she's this worked up. After a few minutes, Adora's breathing starts to even out and she eventually calms down once more.

“Adora, I know exactly how your feeling right now. But you need to understand that we did everything we could. We told her to leave and she did. It was her choice to come back. I… I think she did if for a reason.”

I hand the note that I found on Six’s bunk to Adora. She looks at the folded piece of paper with watery eyes.

“What’s this?”

“It’s a note from Six. I found it on her bunk in the Barracks. I wanted to be with you when we read it. But we don’t have to read it right now if you don't want.”

Adora repositions herself so she lying against my chest, my head rests on top of hers. I move my legs to either side of Adora’s body and wrap my arms tightly around her waist. Adora wipes her eyes clear from any fresh tears and I move my tail to wrap around her wrist. Adora takes a deep breath and opens the note. She squeezes one of my hand as she reads it aloud…

**

Adora & Catra,

I don’t have much time so please excuse my handwriting. I know we agreed that I wouldn’t come back after the last message was delivered to the Rebellion but I couldn’t do that. It didn’t feel right leaving you behind without letting

you know how much you two impacted my life. I probably should have written this before I left last night, that probably would have been a better idea but then I wouldn't have been able to report back to you about the Rebellions' request. The Rebellion wants to have a final meeting with you in ten days at Brightmoon to discuss their 'after war terms'. If you ask me that Sparkly one seems a bit bossy. But yeah you need to meet them for the last time in ten days. Tell Hordak it's a final scouting mission or something like that. Sneak out if you have to. Do anything to make this work!

You guys have changed my life for the better really. Sure the Fright Zone is a horrible place to grow up but I have some good memories. I made friends, made a family, learned to trust again, met you two. You two inspired me. You made me realize that despite everything love can be found anywhere. You made me believe that tomorrow is worth fighting for. I don't know what's going to happen after this. Will I get caught? Will I make it out alive? I simply don't know. But one thing I do know is that I am grateful to have met you both. I know you two can do this. This war will be end. I just hope I'm there to see that day. If not though, I need you to know that whatever happens to me is not your fault. I chose to come back, I accepted my fate when I came back. I'm not scared of what the future holds for me. As long as there is love in the world, everything will be okay. I'm grateful to have known you both. Thank you for being my family.

For Etheria.

Six

**

Adora and I sit in silence for a few moment. It's a lot to take in. Six was so young and had her whole life ahead of her. That was taken aware from her by the hands of the Horde. *We won't allow Hordak to get away with this, he will pay for what he's done.* I wish I could have ended this war sooner. Adora's grip on my arm become slightly tighter.

"You okay?" I ask, placing a gentle kiss to the top of her head.

"Not really, but I will be. We've got to end this war Catra, for our squadron, for Scorpia and Entrapta, for Six…" Adora moves out of my grasp to face me but keeps a firm hold on my hand… ***"for us."***

Our foreheads press together and I take a few steady breaths. I hold Adora's hand slightly tighter.

"We will end this war Adora. We'll end it once and for all… and we'll do it **Together**."

Chapter End Notes

> **Spoiler Warning: Character Death**
>
> I hope you enjoy reading this Chapter. Did you guess who the spies were? However, Six and the rest of the team have only been spying on Catra and Adora when they went to the Whispering Woods, so who has been spying on them since the beginning? More answers will be revealed very soon.
>
> Once again, thank you for all your kind comments & theories last week. Reading them makes my day so much better. Please keep commenting, I love reading all your thoughts and theories. I hope you're all still enjoying this fic. The next chapter update is this Monday. It is the shorted chapter in this fic but I hope you enjoy reading it. Only five more chapter to go. See you on Monday 😊
>
> P.S - I'm sorry for killing off Six; her death was actually meant to be on screen but I decided that was way too graphic.

However, if anyone would like to read the alternative to this chapter I'll share it. I actually have a few alternative chapters that I'm more than willing to share when this fic concludes. 😊

P.S 2 - I have edited this chapter (the first part) to include a little bit of teasing from the squardon. Hope you like :)

Nightmares

Chapter Summary

Catra has a Nightmare.

Adora is there to comfort Catra.

Catra can't sleep so goes on a late night walk.

Chapter/Creator Warning: Nightmares, Reflections of the Past

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

***

Where am I? How did I end up here? What's going on? Fires are burning everywhere. This place it looks familiar but I can't figure out where I am.

"I'm sorry my Kitten."

Who said that? Who are you? What's going on? Please someone answer me.

***

Thaymor? What am I doing here? What's going on? Why are the Horde attacking? We conquered Thaymor almost two years ago.

"I can't go back Catra, not after everything I've seen."

Adora where are you? I can hear you but I can't see you. Adora! Adora where are you?!

***

The Fright Zone? How did I get back here? I was in Thaymor a few moments ago?

"Catra we have to get out of here. Hordak's on to us. He knows about the plan to stop the war?"

What? How? That's impossible. He can't know anything. We sent Scorpia and Entrapta away.

Wait, no! They didn't make it. They were killed at the barrier, the same fate as Six and the rest of our squadron. This… this isn't making any sense.

****

The Whispering Woods? What's going on? Why is everything shifting?

"Catra we need to hide. If she finds us she will kill us."

Who's after us? Adora you're not making sense. Adora what's going on? Adora please answer me!

****

Why am I surrounded by water? Salineas? W-why am I here? I-I can't do this on my own! I need to find Adora!

The fires are burning. The tide keeps swaying in and out. With every step I take the horizon seems to move further out of my reach. I have to get to Adora.

No… Please no! This-this can't be happening. I collapse onto my knees when I find Adora's body battered from fallen rocks. I cradle Adora's body in my arms, my tears burn my cheeks as they fall from my eyes. I call for help but no-one hears my cries…

"You worthless little creature!"… "Look at what you've done to Adora!"… "Adora suffers because of your failures!"... "You should

have stayed out of her way and none of this would have happened!"

No this can't be happened. This isn't real, I refuse to believe it's real. It's not real!

"Catra…"

Adora whispers my name as her hand moves to stroke my cheek. I hold her hand tightly against my cheek. The burning from my tears have started to burn into my skin underneath my fur.

"…I'm sorry."

What? Adora's body starts to fade from my hands. I try to hold on to her but it's no use.

Adora stay with me! Adora please! Please don't leave me! I love you Adora!...

"ADORA!"

***

--

I jolt awake, struggling to catch my breath. My fur is coated in sweat and I'm uncontrollably shaking. Adora's name is on the edge of my lips, I want to scream but my voice is dry...

Adora, where's Adora?

I frantically reach to my left side and I feel someone under the covers. Cautiously I turn my head to the side, afraid that it might not be her. Thankfully it is and I haven't disturbed her from her sleep. The reassurance of Adora's presence calms me down and I start to focus on my breathing.

It was just a nightmare. None of it was real. Deep breathes, it was just another nightmare.

This is happening all too often. My nightmares have been getting more and more frequent after the Six's death. It's been a lot for both of us to deal with. Survivors guilt has kept Adora and I awake for many nights. When we do eventually find sleep we're haunted by our memories and twisted events of what has and could have happened.

This is the sixth time this week I have been woken up by my nightmares. Everytime I close my eyes another nightmare begins. It's fair to say that that nightmare was the worst of them all so far. Sure it was only a dream but it all felt so real. The fear of losing Adora haunts me everyday. I don't think I'd be able to go on without her. Tears start to run down my cheeks.

Stupid fucking nightmares! Why do they keep happening? All I want is a decent night's sleep before our secret meeting with Brightmoon in four days' time. Is that too much to ask?

Adora starts to shift next to me. Shit I didn't want to wake her up. I should be better at controlling my emotions. My body starts to curl in on itself, trying to myself appear as small as possible.

Adora's hand blindly reaches for mine as her sleepy eyes starts to open. It takes her a few seconds to focus but it doesn't take her long to release what's happened. Adora immediately sits up and wraps her arms around me, pulling me into a soft, *yet strong*, warm embrace. I break down, unable to stop my tears from falling. I'm exhausted, angry, upset and scared. My breath starts to hitch and all I able to say is *"I'm sorry."*

Adora holds me closer to her as my tears fall. She guides one of her hands through my mane, gently stroking its full length. She knows doing this soothes me. Everytime I say *"I'm sorry"* she whispers back *"It's okay"… "I'm here"…"I've got you"..."I love you."*

It takes a while but I eventually calm down, but my strong hold on Adora remains. My puffed up tail moves from my waist to wrap around Adora's thigh. She gently hums and softly smiles.

Adora places a gentle kiss to the top my head... "Do you want to talk about it?"

"It was just another stupid nightmare."

My grip on Adora tightens and my ears flatten against my head. Adora continues stroking my mane, occasionally moving to stroke my ears, waiting for me to continue. We've been working on opening up and discussing our feelings to one another. It was something we started to work on after Scorpia suggested I tell Adora about my feelings for her. I know she won't push me to tell her anything, she knows I'll tell her when I'm ready.

"It was worse than the previous nights. I could see and hear things but nothing seemed to add up. At one point I could only hear you, I couldn't find you anywhere. It was a bit of everything: my past, Scorpia and Entrapta, Six, but it was all different. None of them made it. Then we were back at Salineas. There was only you and me there, no one else was around. Then she appeared."

My body tenses up and Adora instantly holds me tighter. I think she can tell this is the part that woke me up.

"She was taunting me. She made me believe that everything that had happened was my fault. I could hear her but she was nowhere to be seen. Then you started to fade away. I held you tight in my arms, my claws were digging into your jacket, trying to keep hold of you but it was no use. I tried calling for help but no one heard. I asked you to stay but..." tears start to fall again and I look into Adora's eyes. "Adora it felt so real. If something had happened to you…"

I'm unable to finish my sentence. Surely I shouldn't be getting like this. It was only a stupid nightmare but it felt so real, they all feel

real. Adora holds me even tighter and starts to gently rock our bodies side to side.

“I’m here Catra. You can feel me holding you tight can’t you? I’m right here, I’m not going anywhere… Why didn’t you wake me?”

“Because... **sniff*...* this is the sixth time this week I've woken up like this from my nightmares. You’re already struggling with your own nightmares. You’re exhausted Adora. I-I wanted you t-to rest.”

“Catra, I don’t care how tired I am. You should have woken me up. We’ve both gone through so much, you more than me. I hate seeing you like this. The least I can do is be here for you when you need me.”

Adora repositions us so I'm sitting in her lap. She places her hands on my cheeks, using her thumbs to wipe away my tears. My hands come to rest against hers and I nuzzle my cheeks further in her hands. The feeling of her touch eases my mind. My eyes quickly find hers, even though my vision is still a bit blurry from crying. Despite Adora's eyes showing obvious signs of being tired, deep down they clearly show patience, understanding and love.

“I would rather spend all night awake with you, protecting you from your nightmares than see you like this. We’re both exhausted but that doesn’t mean you shouldn’t not wake me up. I’ll always be here for you Catra. You look out for me and I look out for you. I love you.”

A weak smile creeps across my face. Adora moves forward and places a gently kiss to my lips before resting out foreheads together.

“Do you want to stay up a little bit longer, go and cause some trouble or…”

“Adora, as much as I would love to do any of that with you, I am really tired. I think our best bet right now is to try and get some

sleep.”

“Okay but promise me you’ll wake me up if you have another nightmare.”

“Adora I’ll be fine…”

“I mean it Catra. You wake me up if you have another nightmare and I haven't woken up already.” Adora looks at me with a stern face. It would be more intimidating if she didn’t look so tired.

“Alright I promise. But you have to promise to do the same.”

“Thank you and I promise to do the same.”

"Can you... hold me please. I feel safe in your arms."

Adora smiles, places a gentle kiss to my lips, and starts to move backward, lying us both down on our bed before turning us to the side so were now lying face to face. Adora holds me as close to her as possible. I rest my head against her chest, letting her steady heartbeat lure me to sleep once again. Adora places a kiss to the top of my head and I start to softly purr.

“Night Catra. I love you.”

“Night Adora. I love you too.”

--

It’s been about an hour now and I still can't sleep. I’m too scared to let me eyes close again, worried my nightmares will continue. I know I promised to wake Adora up if they happened again but she's exhausted. She needs her sleep more than me. Besides, if I’m awake then my dreams can’t hurt me.

A sudden chills makes its way down my spine. I don’t see how: I have a blanket over me, I am covered in fur and to top it all off I have Adora’s body heat keeping me even warmer. Then I hear something in the corridors. I might not have heard it if it wasn't for my incredible Magicat hearing senses. It doesn’t sound like someones footsteps and I can’t pick up any voices. I’m not sure what time it is but I need to investigate. Weird things have been happening recently and my mind keeps telling me that this is my chance to find something out. What that *'something'* is I don't know and that's why I need to investigate.

Adora is fast asleep, her hair has fallen flat across the front of her face. I gently move myself out of her hold which has relaxed over the course of her sleep. I quietly change into my Force Captain's uniform and exit our quarters. I wouldn’t want to have to interrogate anyone in my pyjamas, *now that would be embarrassing.*

The corridors are dark and cold. My fur stands on end, attempting to trap whatever heat it can. Stars I wish I had stayed in bed tucked up against Adora’s warm body.

Sssssss - *What the fuck was that?*

I turn around frantically and see something long and dark slither across the cold ground. It’s definitely not a rat and it’s moving at a fast pace. I start to chase after it, only for it to respond by quickly picking up speed and slithering its way up the side of wall.

What is the fuck is this thing?

I end up running on all fours to keep up with it. The creature, *or whatever it is*, eventually stops dead in the center of a room. It stands as it turns to face me. A bright red eye of some sort stares directly into my soul. On instinct I pounce, claws and fangs ready to tear this piece of shit to shreds. My pounce is accurate but upon landing the creature evaporates beneath my claws.

Where did it go?

I look up only to realize where I have been led. There's an eery blood red glow around the room.

No. This can't be happening. How could have I been so stupid? I have to get out of here!

I race to get up and sprint towards the door only for it to be slammed shut in my face.

Fuck it's a trap!

I sense a body looming around the corner. My whole body tenses up in response. I should have stayed in my quarters. I should have stayed with Adora. It was safe there. I guess tonight I'm going to find out how *'curiosity killed the cat.'*

"Hello, Catra."

Chapter End Notes

> Another Cliffhanger. 😱 As you know I hate cliffhangers but I couldn't resit keeping you on edge. I promise this is sort of the last one for this fic. Have you figured out who is responsible for spying on Catra and Adora? What do you think will happen to Catra now?
>
> Hope you enjoyed reading Chapter 15. Thank you for all your kind comments last week. I can't even begin to tell you how much your kind words mean to me. I also love reading your theories on what you think will happen next. Please keep commenting. I have also added a small update to the first part of the previous chapter based on your comments. Go and check it out. The next chapter update will be this Friday. See you then. 😊
>
> P.S - Warning for the next chapter: please, please, please read the tags and make sure your still comfortable reading this fic - they're all up to date. One of them is a spoiler tag so it won't be put in the chapter summary but at the end notes of next weeks chapter. Just wanted to give you a warning. It

may be worth reading what Entrapta said about the Black Garnet in Chapter 7 - 'Sting of Emotion'.

Scars

Chapter Summary

The spy is revealed.

Catra fights for her life.

When all hope seems lost, promises are kept.

Chapter/Creator Warnings: Graphic Content in this Chapter, Blood & Injury, Description of Physical Abuse, Burns, Scars, (Spoiler Warning in end notes and tags)

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"*Hello, Catra."*

I turn to find Shadow Weaver looming behind me. I feel trapped, unable to move.

"What a pleasant surprise this is to have to show up in my chambers unannounced. It's been so long since we last spoke. I was beginning to wonder if Lord Hordak had finally seen how worthless you are and had finally sent you Beast Island. Unfortunately my shadow spies told me otherwise. I wonder how Lord Hordak would feel knowing that his most *'loyal'* and superior ranking soldiers are the true traitors."

Shadow Weaver's wicked voice slices through the air, making the area feel even colder than before. Pure evil is written across her face. I knew from the first moment I met her she was evil and this only reinforces that fact. I guess this is what she meant by *'this isn't the last you've seen of me.'*

Whatever you do, don't let her know you're afraid.

"So you've been the one sneaking around watching our every move."

"No not me, my *shadow spies*. In case you have forgotten Catra, I have been trapped here since the day Adora took my position from my hands. I had high hopes for her but never thought I'd be pushed aside. I've been trapped here plotting my revenge ever since. I was only trying to find Adora's weaknesses but I found out something far more interesting in the process."

Shadow Weaver floats further towards me. I extend my claws ever slow slightly prepared to attack. It may have been a while or two since Shadow Weaver last attack but I still remember where to strike.

"I discovered about yours' and Adora's plan to end this war. It was me who was spying on you the day Scorpia and Entrapta left the Fright Zone. It was me who was spying on you when you squadron when they found out your true plan. It's a shame so many have suffered from *your* failure to protect them, especially that young girl. What's her name… *Six?*"

A low growl emits from my throat. She has no right to talk about Six. She never met her or even cared about her.

"*Ah yes, Six*. She would do anything for those she saw as her family. Such as shame that a young person with such skill and intelligence had her life taken from her because *you* couldn't protect her. It's very similar to how you failed to protect Adora when we attacked Salineas. Face it Catra, if you had got up and ran for your life when those rocks started to fall Adora would have been fine. The scars on her body are a reminder of how *you* failed. You were always a failure Catra, and that's all you'll ever be."

No! That's not true! Adora scars show her how far she's come, the challenges she's faced and how she strives through each and everyone. I may have failed to protect her once but I kept my promise… right? I won't fail her again.

“What are you going to do to me?”

This is clearly all simple chatter before she does something to me. Shadow Weaver does this all the time, I’m used to her game… *make you feel like you deserve your punishment before she strikes.*

Shadow Weaver chuckles under her mask. “Oh I have nothing planned especially for you. It’s what I plan to do to *Adora*.”

“If you dare touch her…”

“You’ll do what? I fully intent for you not to be around when get my revenge on Adora. Besides, the best way to hurt someone it to strike at the *heart*.”

Shit, it all makes sense now. Shadow Weaver plans to kill me to take revenge on Adora.

“YOU BITCH!” I dart forwards with every intention to hurt, even kill Shadow Weaver if I must. I won’t let her do this!

Unfortunately for me, before I can do any damage to Shadow Weaver, she catches me in s series of dark tendrils and tosses me towards the jagged wall.

“Ahhhhh!”

I scream as my body slams against that wall. I quickly regains my strength and dodge another four attempted attacks. I locate Shadow Weavers’ blind spot. I pounce and target her back, digging my claws into the back of her cloak. She falls to the ground hunched over in pain or at least that’s what I thought. Dark shadows form behind me, tossing me off Shadow Weaver, before pinning my to the ground. Red electricity starts to form around my body and the shadows begin tightening, attempting to crush bones and suffocate me. I try to escape but there is no way out. I am physically trapped.

“You’re weaker than I thought Catra. You clearly don’t know the true power of dark magic… and now it will be the death of you.”

I try even harder to escape the shadows grasp but the more I fight the tighter they get and the more the electricity burns. It burns straight through my fur and cuts into my flesh. I scream in pain but I know all too well that no one can hear me… *is this really the end?*

“Any last words, *Catra?”*

I have no final words, only final thoughts… *Adora*. I’m sorry I failed her. I can only hope she finds a way to end this war without me.

Shadow Weaver forms some sort of ball, which it contained by that evil red electricity in her hands. I close my eyes waiting for this nightmare to finally be over.

BANG, CLANK, BANG!

The door screeches open. I give it all my strength to see who it is as i try to call for help one last time. It's...

“Adora?”

How did she know I was her?

“GET AWAY FROM HER!” She shouts as she charges at Shadow Weaver.

“*Adora*, how nice of you to...” Adora quickly shuts her up by punching her directly in the stomach and she isn’t finished yet. Adora aims wherever she can, making sure Shadow Weaver can’t use her hands under any circumstances. If she can’t use her hand, she can’t cast spells.

“I warned you if you ever hurt Catra again you’d be sorry!” Adora rages between attacks.

I start to fight my way out of the shadows. With Shadow Weaver occupied they've started to loosen their grip but the pain they're causing just from trying to escape still cuts likes knives. It's a pain I'll work through to protect Adora.

I'm free, I'm finally free. My skin burns but I'm free.

Adora is focused on keeping Shadow Weaver occupied, both of them unaware I have escaped her dark powers. I make my way behind Shadow Weaver once again to her blind spot. Adora's fall to the ground with a thud. She wipes away some blood running from the side of her lip with the back of her hand. Her sword in its dagger form has fallen to the side.

How did she manage to sneak that in here?

She reaches for it but Shadow Weaver uses her magic to swipe it to the back of the room, right where I'm hiding. Thank stars she hasn't seen me yet. I reach for the dagger and move myself behind the Black Garnet.

There's got to be some way I can overpower this thing. Come on brain think. Think like Entrapta!

"*Adora*, why must you be like this? That creature is clearly not worth any of this. What could you possibly see in her?"

"Her name is Catra and I love her!"

I haven't got much time. I need to act fast. I search around the room looking for something, anything that'll give me the chance to make this thing too powerful for Shadow Weaver to control, even if it's only for a few moments. That's when I spot it. A loose electrical wire on the ground…

"Too much power will cause the Black Garnet to become electrified once it has reach full power. It's highly dangerous and I would not recommend it without further test".

Entrapta you're genius.

I’ll only have a few moments to make my move before this thing become completely electrified. I grab the wire, cutting the ends loose with the dagger. I then attach it to the nearest empty socket that’s attach to the Black Garnets’ base…

"You love her?!" Shadow Weaver cackles with that evil laugh of hers. “The one who's responsible for your near death experience? Hah. It’s a shame really. I had such high hopes for you Adora. It’s a shame *your Catra* couldn’t protect even at the end.”

Shadow Weaver forms another ball of red electricity in her hands but this time aims it at Adora. I’m not going to let her hurt her. This ends now, once and for all!

“HEY SHADOW WEAVER!”

“Catra?” Adora says as she looks up above Shadow Weaver in shock.

I dived down from the top of the Black Garnet, my claws extended as far as they’ll go. Shadow Weaver turns around but with her hands occupied she isn’t able to block my attack. My claws slice her mask in two, cutting the red diamond in the middle to smithereens. Her powers completely drained. I tumble to the ground landing by Adora’s side. Shadow Weaver turns in my direction, her hands covering her face. With one powerful kick to her chest, I propel Shadow Weaver backwards, sending her directly in the direction of the now electrified Black Garnet. Adora catches me as I fly backwards. Long strands of red electricity form over Shadow Weavers body, her cloak lighting a flame.

“Now you know how it feels to be tortured by your own powers!” I scream as the scene before us unfolds.

The full power of the Black Garnet is too strong to control, it eventually overpowers and cracks in two. Shadow Weaver's body slowly sumps to the ground. The Black Garnet’s light fading. It’s over.

Adora turns to face me and notices the blood, the burns, and the cuts that are visible through my ripped uniform. My knees give way and I fall to the ground but Adora manages to catch me. My body starts to shake and tears start to fall from my eyes. Then I notice Adora's eyes have begun to water too. She has a few cut's on her cheeks and chin but nothing to serious.

I'm not sure why I suddenly feel so… *empty*. Maybe it's the shock that I feel or the relief that this living nightmare is finally over. For a while nothing is said but then Adora speaks… "We should go."

"Okay" Is all I'm able to say. Adora helps me up and carries me out of the room. I look back one more time before the door closes behind us.

--

This is my least favourite place to be but all I want right now is a shower. Adora helps me undress and turns the shower on. For once it's running warm. It's probably because there are less people here than usual, only Adora and I are here.

"I'll join you in a minute." Adora says as I step in the shower.

The running water soothes my skin. It stings a little when it hits my injuries but the pain is worth it if it means my wounds don't get infected. Besides, the pain is only temporary. The water starts to change from bright red to clear, my injuries become clearer too. They're going to scar for sure. Tears start to fall down my face again and I hold myself. I feel Adora's arms make their way around my waist pulling me closer to her. I turn in her hold and cry against her shoulder as she reassures me that this nightmare is finally over.

"Thank you" I say through a series of hiccups as my tears subside.

Adora holds me close and places a series of kisses to the top of my head, ears, cheeks and finally my lips. She helps me wash the rest of my body free of blood, being extra careful to avoid were I have been burned and scarred. We eventually dry off and head back to our quarters to patch each other up.

--

"How did you know where I was?" I ask as Adora straps up one of the burns on my leg. It stings slightly but she being so careful and caring through this all. *What did I do to deserve her?*

"I woke up from one of my nightmares and realized you weren't here. I was about to panic but then I saw that your uniform was gone. I remembered you saying that you saw something a few times and I decided to investigate myself. I took my sword because… *you know*… and then I heard you screaming. I might not have been able to protect you the first time it happen, *or a few times after that*, but I wasn't going to let her get away with it again Catra. I promised to look out for you and I swore to make her regret everything she ever did to you."

"Adora I'm so sorry I wasn't there when you woke up. I…"

"Hey it's okay. I get it. You had to go see what it was. I would have done the same thing. I'm just glad you're okay. Catra I was worried sick when I found out where you were. I was worried she was going to kill you."

"You know that was her plan right? She was going to kill me to hurt you."

Adora's hand reach for mine and she holds them ever so tightly. Her other hand rests on my cheek, her thumb brushing through my fur.

"I don't know what I would have done if I lost you Catra. You're my world, my everything. At least now we no longer have to live in fear of her every again. *We're going to be okay."*

Adora draws me into a hug and I slightly wince in pain. Her hug is gentle and warm. I feel safe in her arms. She eventually releases me but looks at me with concerned eyes.

"You ready to sort that one out?" She asks as she points to my back.

It's the most painful injury of the night. Adora describes it as a series of electric burns along the right side of my back. They spread from my shoulder blade to my tail bone. We agreed to leave disinfecting and patching it up till last as it was the most painful to clean in the shower.

"Better now than never I suppose. Just warn my before you do anything."

Adora kisses me gently before moving to sit behind me.

"This is going to sting a bit. You ready?"

I take in a deep breath and nod my head letting Adora know I'm ready.

"Shit!" I growl through gritted teeth. It burns all the more. My hands grips the sheets of the bed and my tail instinctively wraps around Adora's arm.

"Are you okay?"

"Yeah, I'm fine. It burns that's all. Can you please hurry up and get this over with."

Adora works swiftly to disinfect the area. My tail grips her working arm tighter. This is something I used to do when we were younger. Whenever something really hurt, I'd wrap my tail around Adora's arm. It kept her close to me and reassured me that

everything was going to be okay, she was only trying to help. My eyes start to water from the pain.

Why would anyone want to inflict pain like this upon someone? Oh wait, this is Shadow Weaver we're talking about!

"All Done."

I'm relieved it's finally over. Hopefully, I can now get some rest. With Adora occupied putting the medical kit away I look at my now patched up injuries. All I see is a wounded animal, unable to defend themselves from a vicious predator who took advantage of their prey's weaknesses. My body shaking and my vision becomes unclear from how watery my eyes are. I thought my tears would have run dry by now but clearly not. Adora notices and rushes to my side.

"Catra what's wrong?"

I try to speak but my words run dry. My vision starts to blur but the feeling of Adora's hands on my shoulder and the sound of her voice grounds me.

"Catra try and calm down. Focus on my voice. It's okay we're safe. I'm here, I'm not going anywhere."

I listen to Adora carefully and follow the patterns of her breathing. Breathe *in, hold, breathe out… repeat… breathe in, hold, breathe out.*

I open my eyes once more and clear images starts to form. I'm met with those beautiful blue eyes staring back at mine. They show concern, patience but above all, love.

"Are you okay. I know that's a bit of a stupid question to ask after what just happened but I need to know if you feel okay to talk."

I take a deep breath and wipe my eyes clear from my tears. "I'm fine, well I'm not but I'm alright to talk. Can you hold me for a bit… please."

Adora smiles and moves to my side, pulling me into her lap. My tail wraps around us both, my claws hold on tight to her night shirt, my head tucked under her chin. Adora holds me close and softly hums as she gently strokes behind my ears. Once I'm calm enough I let me heart open up to her.

"How can you still love me after everything?"

"What do you mean?"

"Shadow Weaver… she-she made me realize that I'm the reason you got hurt. I-I'm the reason you nearly died at Salineas. I'm responsible for Scorpia and Entrapta having to leave the Horde. Six is dead because of me. I'm the reason everyone keeps getting hurt."

It's hard to keep the tears back. My eyes will for sure be red and sore in the morning.

"Catra I want you to listen to me okay and I mean really listen. If you hadn't found me at Salineas when we were being attack we wouldn't have won. If you hadn't stopped to find help when taking me back to the Fright Zone I wouldn't be holding you right now. Scorpia and Entrapta are alive and are helping us win this war because you got them out of here safely. Six, despite how upsetting her ending was, learned to trust again thanks to you. I learned to love because I met you. Catra you are the reason people are surviving. You're the reason why people are learning to change, to live, to trust and to love."

"But how can you still love me with these scars?"

Adora looks down at me in shock. I move out of her hold so I can face her properly. I don't know where it came from but it's how I feel right now. After everything how can she still love me?

"Look at me Adora. I'm weak. I'm worthless."

"Catra don't say things like that. Your none of those things..."

"But that's how I feel Adora. I'm covered in burns and wounds that you patch up every time. Those injuries leave scars, a permanent mark on my skin. Sure my fur hides some of them but they're still there. How can you still want to be with me after everything. You could have left the Horde after Thaymor but you chose to stay. How can you still want me in your life when nothing good in my life ever seems to last. How can you love me when I don't even know how to love myself?"

Adora remains smiling at me, her hand keeps a tight hold on mine. Once she's certain I have finished, she reaches for my other hand and hold its tight.

"I love you Catra because you're true to yourself. When I'm scared or worried about something I think to myself *'what would Catra do?'* I wish I had your confidence, your sense of humour, your skill, your passion. I'm still learning how to love myself but loving you is making it easier. You should never be ashamed of who you are. Your scars, regardless of whether they're visible or not, do not make you weak or worthless. They make you strong. They tell stories of the battles you have been through to overcome the barriers to get where you are today. If I have to kiss every scar on your body to make you realize that then so be it. I'll keep doing that until you see yourself the way I see you. You are the strongest, most daring and most caring person I know Catra. Nothing is ever going to change the way I feel about you. I love you. I always have and I always will."

Adora pulls me into a gentle, heartfelt kiss. She kisses every single scar on my body both old and new, before laying us down to try and get some rest. I wrap around Adora's body and she holds me close, protecting me from my nightmares.

How I ended up with someone like her in my life I will never know, but I'm thankful to be the one she chose to love. I thank the stars that I get to call her mine… *My Adora.*

Chapter End Notes

Spoiler Warning: Character Death

What a roller coaster of emotions. Shadow Weaver is finally gone. Well done to those who guessed it was her. Adora and Catra kept their promises to protect each other no matter what. Now all that's left to do is meet with the Rebellion and win this war. Can you believe they're are only three chapters left? 😱

I hope you enjoyed reading this chapter. Once again, thank you for all your comments last week. I enjoyed reading them all and hearing your theories. Please keep commenting. In the next chapter we meet with the Rebellion (all of them) for one last time. What do you think will happen? Find out on Monday when the next chapter is uploaded. See you then 😊

P.S - There is also an alternate version of this chapter which I will be sharing with you all when the fic concludes. I also have a series of outtake/extra chapters that I have been writing up for this story (prequel chapters) that I will be sharing with you too. 😊

Now or Never

Chapter Summary

Catra feels drawn to her mask.

Getting into Brightmoon is easy, communicating with the Princesses is a different story.

Scorpia and Entrapta make an appearance.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Sleep hasn't come easy these past few nights. Every night I've been jolted awake by my nightmares. One night it was a repeat of events, the next was Shadow Weavers return. I know it's not possible *because…*

My scars from that horrific night have been healing well. *The powers of magicat healing*. Adora has still insisted on helping to clean and patch them up though, its just the way she is. Everytime I tell her 'I'm fine' I usually get the comment back…*"Magicat healing or not I promised to take care of you and that's exactly what I'm going to do. Now stay still or do I have to pin you to the ground like last time?!"* I eventually give in, reminding her that I can take care of myself; secretly I like her taking care of me. I don't know what it is but there is something about the way she takes care of me that makes me feel safe and loved.

What did I ever do to deserve her?

The past days and nights before tonight's secret meeting plan with Brightmoon went slower than I ever thought possible. Hordak has been set in making final battle preparations, ensuring that our weapons and defense systems are up to scratch. Hordak aims to return victorious with all of Etheria knowing his name.

Why is it so important to him that he conquers Etheria? What the fuck does he think he's going to achieve from this victory other than spreading fear into the heart of innocent lives like some sort of virus.

"You ready?"

Adora is standing at my side. I hadn't noticed her standing beside me because of my thoughts racing in my mind. I haven't moved from my position on our bed, my mask held tightly in my hands.

Why am I feeling like this.

"Hey what's wrong? I can tell something's on your mind." Adora asks softly as she moves to sit next to me our bed, her arm wraps around my shoulders and she pulls me closer to her. I rest my head against her shoulder, breathing in her calming scent as she lightly traces soothing patterns up and down my arm. My tail instinctively moves to wrap around her waist. My hands still have a tight hold on my mask.

We sit in silence for a few more moments. Adora doesn't pressure me to say anything, she knows I'll tell her what's bothering me when I'm ready. Adora owns my heart, I trust her, I feel safe when I'm with her her. I know I can tell her anything. My gaze is fixed on my mask.

"I… I don't know what I'm feeling Adora. I don't know how to describe it. I just feel so… *empty."*

Adora tightens her grip around my shoulders before placing a gentle kiss to the top of my head where my mask would sit. I lean in closer to her, letting my thoughts be grounded by her presence, but my eyes never leave my mask.

Why do I feel so drawn to this? I have owned it for years so why now? Why now out of all the times I have held my mask in my hands, does this feel different?

Adora waits for me to continue but I have nothing more to say. One of her hands moves to encase both our hands around my mask.

“She’d be proud of you, you know.”

For the first time tonight my eyes leave my mask to face Adora, only her eyes don’t turn to find mine, they remain fixated my mask.

“Your mother, she’d be proud of you. I can see her smiling with pride and joy over how strong you have become.” Adora’s eyes leave my mask and find mine. “You are the strongest, most courageous, loving, sometimes stubborn but most determined person I know Catra. Your mother would be so proud of how far you come.”

“How do you know?”

Adora turns slightly to rest our foreheads together. Her eyes never leave mine. A slow purr starts to emit from my chest when I notice that she has placed one of my hands on her heart.

“It’s hard to describe but it something I can feel… something that I feel in here. That strong heartbeat you feel right now, that is all because of you. Your mother, your family, I know they’re all proud of you Catra, I can feel it. I know they're proud of you because I'm proud of you. The beginning of your story may have had some hardships, but you have come so far. You’ve gone from being this tiny scared magicat kitten I found in a box all of them years ago, to being my best friend, to being the person I feel in love with before I even knew what love was. You give me strength Catra, you are part of the reason why I am the person I am today. You’re my everything Catra. I love you so much.”

Oh great here come the water works.

My mask drops out of my hands and clanks against the floor. I pounce into Adora’s arms, holding her tight, burying my face into her chest in an attempt to prevent her from seeing my tears.

Adora holds me close, whispering sweet nothings as she draws circles on my back. The purring in my chest eventually gets louder. When the tears eventually run dry I move out Adora's strong embrace.

"Thanks Adora, I-I really needed to hear that… I love you". I place a gentle kiss to Adora lips before moving to stand. I reach my hand out to her… "You coming?"

Adora smiles back and places my hand in her, "Guess it's now or never."

--

Getting into Brightmoon was easy. Trying to communicate with those you have attacked is a very different story.

Princesses Sparkles has apparently managed to persuade Queen Sparkles to allow two *'Horde scums'* into Brightmoon, but she *'forgot'* to mention it to the rest of the Rebellion.

"WHAT THE ACTUAL FUCK GLIMMER! ARE YOU TRYING TO GET US KILLED! YOU SAW WHAT THEY DID TO MY KINGDOM!"

Damn that sea princess has an attitude problem. She needs to take some anger management classes.

"Mermista, please try and calm down. I get that you're upset but they're here to help."

"HELP! HOW MANY KINGDOMS HAVE THEY ALREADY DESTROYED? I SAY WE TEACH THEM A LESSON."

This is hilarious. The tiny princesses is just as bad the sea one.

"We'd like to see you try tiny. What age are you anyway, *twelve*?"

“Catra!” Adora lightly says between the grit of her teeth as she gives me a firm punch to my arm.

The small princess forms some sort of thick ice blocks around her wrists. She really needs to learn how to take a joke. Part of that was a serious question. *Who would let a kid be part of the Rebellion anyway? Mind you, the Horde trains soldiers as children so I can't really argue against a young princess in the Rebellion.*

“Maybe we should all try and stay calm and hear what they have to say.”

“Perfume has a point. As much as I don’t like having two Horde leaders in my Kingdom, I truly believe they are here to help. I just wish *Glimmah* had informed me of her co-operation with these two a long time ago.”

Wait, Glimmah? I thought it was Glimmer. Urgh why is everything with the Rebellion so complicated. It's going to be easier to stick to calling her Sparkles.

The princesses eventually calm down and take their seats around what looks like a giant holographic table. Why does everything in Brightmoon have to be so pink and purple and covered in sparkles, it makes my eyes hurt. A series of holographic files appear before us, each one has a specific date written on them as well as a kingdom location.

“Look, I know you’re not happy about this but I promise you all that Catra and Adora are here to help. These files will prove that. We’ve been working together to end this war for quite some time now…”

“How long?” Queen Sparkles interrupts as she stares into princess Sparkle’s soul. Now I see where she gets her death stare from.

A nervous laugh escapes Sparkles's lips, a panicked expression appears on her face. *“Well, urm… literally the day that the Horde attacked Thaymor.”*

The whole Rebellion outbursts in rage. There's to much going on to fully comprehend what's actually being said. At this rate we're surely doomed.

WHISTLE

Everyone falls silent and turns to face Adora. I never knew she could whistle that loud or whistle at all for that matter.

"Look, I know you're not happy having us here…"

"DAMN RIGHT WE'RE NOT!"

Everyone turns to face the princess called Mermista and she immediately retakes her seat, allowing Adora to continue.

"But before you all have a go at Glimmer can you please hear us out. Then if you don't want our help we'll walk away and work on our own to end this war. We didn't choose to fight for the Horde, we weren't given a choice. We want to end this war as much as you all do but we can't do it alone. We just want to help."

A few silent words are passed between the princesses before they all turn to the queen. She nods to Adora signalling that she is free to continue.

Adora speaks with passion and truth. She tells the story of how our story began, the two of us being brought to the Horde as orphans, only knowing that the Fright Zone as our home and we were to serve the one they called Lord Hordak. She spoke of how we never knew what was really going on outside the Fright Zone until the day of the attack on Thaymor. She allows Sparkles to explain to the others how communications between us occurred and how we managed to alert them of planned attacks. It became clear that none of the princesses were aware of this and they came to realize that if it wasn't for our help things would have been far worse. Adora then goes on to talk about Scorpia and Entrapta, it's only then that I realize that they aren't at this meeting. *I wonder where they are?* When it eventually comes to taking about our squadron and Six I take over. I explain how Six

gave her life to protect us and her last words in the face of evil were *"For Etheria!"* I explain how she was once an orphan like us, caught up in a war that was never meant to be hers. Some of the Rebellion members had tears in their eyes. Arrow Boy and Sparkles have obviously meet Six a few times as she was always the first to volunteer to pass vital information between us. The word of her death was a clear shock. Adora then briefly explains what has happened since then, leaving out the brutal detail of the battle between myself and Shadow Weaver, *'forgetting'* to mention that she is no longer a problem. The queen seemed to shiver at the name. Her eyes averted to the empty chair next to her before looking back at us with a soft expression.

"…and now we're here. Hordak plans to attack Brightmoon very soon, less than two weeks' time to be exact. He's ready for you, but what he doesn't know is that we're about tell you everything. He's strong but only because he doesn't know what we're doing. We know his secrets. We know what he's planning and we know how to stop him. But we can only do some much. We have to work together if we're going to end this war once and for all."

Once again the room falls silent. The atmosphere feels tense. There are a few whispers around the room. Arrow boy is the first to speak.

"I know I want to help and I trust you. But I can't speak for the others."

"I'm with Bow. I saw what Catra did for that kid trapped at Salinas and it makes me think if you hadn't helped us what would have happened. How many more lives would have been lost that day? Like I said before, we're two sides of the same coin, caught up in a war that wasn't meant to be ours."

Sparkles smirks at me and I give a toothy grin in response. Adora looks at me with a confused expression as if to say *'when did this happen? Why haven't you told me this before?'* I wrap my tail around her calf and give her hand a gentle squeeze as if to say,

'I'll tell you later.' Now we just have to wait for the rest of the Rebellion to respond.

"As much as I don't like you or your face, I'm in too. I may be the youngest in the Rebellion but I was left with a kingdom to protect. If the best chance of protecting my kingdom is to work with you two then so be it."

"I agree with Frosta. Sure the Horde have done a lot of bad things, but from what you've told us it's clear that many weren't given a choice. I mean look at Scorpia, her story is similar to yours and if she trusts you then so do I."

The princess called Perfume seems to blush when she mentions Scorpia's name. Its nice to know she's made a friend outside the Fright Zone. I get the feeling that there may be more than a standard friendship going on here.

"Perfuma's right. If we have learned to trust an ex-horde soldier and a tech princess who left us to work with the Horde, then we can learn to trust them too. Not to mention we can turn this into challenge, right Spinny."

"Trust you to turn a mission into a challenge darling. You're on."

The two older woman share a tender moment and the rest of the Rebellion *'aww'* over the display of affection. I never thought that displays of affection in front of others would be allowed. In the Fright Zone, displays of affection are strictly forbidden. It's why Adora and I have kept are relationship quite. I can't wait for this war to end if it means I'll be free to kiss and hold Adora whenever I want and not be judge by others or be scared about what might happen to us if we were caught.

"Will I get to set a boat on fire?"

What sort of question is that? Wait, is he the fire boat guy we saw at Salineas?

“Yes Seahawk, I’ll make sure my mom gives you a boat you can deliberately set on fire.”

“Well in that case… FOR ADVENTURE!”

Adora looks at me with pride but she’s forgetting that there is still one princess we’re waiting to hear from. All eyes fall on her. Sparkles addresses her directly.

“Well Mermista. We’re all waiting on you now.”

“Urggghhhhhhh, fine. Just to be clear I’m only doing this because Hordak destroyed my kingdom.”

With that the rest of Rebellion cheer and Adora draws me into a tight hug. I think she’s forgotten that there are other people watching. Both of our cheeks turn bright red with many of the Rebellion looking at us in awe.

I take back what I said about showing affection in public. I’m not ready for that.

When everyone is settled the queen speaks, “What do you suggests?”

--

“WILDCAT!” Scorpia practically squeals as she tackles me into a bone crushing hug. She’s gotten stronger, I can barely breathe.

“Hi Scorpia, can you maybe, loosen your grip a little?”

“Oh gosh sorry.”

Scorpia lets me out of her death grip just enough for me to catch my breath. I then let her hug me again and she makes sure not to crush me in the process.

“It’s good to see you Scorpia. How have you been?”

“Great, I’ve been great. Been weird having to adjust to a new place. Its so pink and sparkly.”

“You can say that again.”

We both end up laughing and chatting for a while. It feel like she never left the Fright Zone. Eventually Entrapta joins us and we end up talking about everything that's been happening. Series of laughter and tears are shared. I can’t wait to be able to live my life like this. It’s within my reach but it seem so far away.

“So what happens now?” Scorpia asks as Entrapta tinkers with her new technology device.

“The Rebellion have agreed that Horde soldiers will be given a second chance if they want to prove themselves of their crimes against Etheria. Those who choose to remain loyal to the Horde will be exiled to some part of the Crimson Waste under the guard of the Rebellion authorities. I’m happy with that decision, I can't see anyone passing up a second chance. Many were forced into this war without a choice, practically the Horde is made up of orphans like me and Adora. ”

“What about you and Adora? Surely you two won’t have to prove yourselves when you risked some much to help end this war.”

“The queen has offered to let Adora and I stay here in Brightmoon if we wish to when the war is over.”

“That’s great! Do you think you’ll take the offer?”

“I… I don’t know. It’s nice to know we have somewhere to go when this is all over but I can’t see it being as easy as just walking in the front door and be like *‘so this is our life now’*.”

Scorpia chuckles. That is basically what happened for her. She walked in here and her whole life changed.

“All I’m certain of is wherever Adora goes I go. When I’m with her I am home. She is my home.

Scorpia looks are me with sparkles in her eyes and a beaming grin on her face…

“Stop looking at me like that… I mean it stop!”

I push against Scorpia’s shoulder and we both end up giggling. It’s at that moment Adora appears.

“Hey Scorpia, Entrapta. Glad to see you’re both doing well.”

Scorpia moves to pull Adora into a hug, which Adora gratefully return.

“Hey Adora. It’s so good to see you.”

Scorpia squeezes Adora a little tighter at the end of her sentence. It becomes clear that even Adora is now struggling to breathe. It’s funny to watch.

“Alright Scorpia, let my girlfriend go before you suffocate her.”

Scorpia places Adora on the ground and they both chuckle as she catches her breath.

“Sorry, sometimes I forget how strong I am. You know I’m a hugger.”

“It’s okay Scorpia. We really missed you too. I’m sorry we can’t stay much longer but we really need to get back to the Fright Zone before anyone discovers that we’re missing. We left our Horde badges behind so we couldn’t be tracked.”

Shit she’s right. Its getting dark and the longer we're gone the greater chance there is of our plan being exposed. That would be a disaster, especially when we're so close to pulling it off.

“You’ll need these.” Entrapta says as she hands us what look like replica designs of our Horde badges.

“Entrapta… what are these?”

“Did Glimmer not tell you? They’re you’re new communication badges. I’ve designed them to look exactly like the Horde badges so no one gets suspicious. They’ll allow you to communicate with us when needed. Only you’ll have to be careful. See this button on the back, if you hit that button on the side, the badge will explode and most likely burn through your uniform if your wearing it.”

“Why would you even add a self-destruct button to a communication badge?”

“So if they fall in the wrong hands it will buy the Rebellion some more time to attack. Did Glimmer really not explain any of this to you?”

“Entrapta to be fair you did make things sound really complicated when you were discussing this with Glimmer.”

“Well you understood what I was saying.”

“Only because I have adapted to understand your '*tech language*' when we were in the Horde.”

“Okay I think we get it. Thanks for the badges and it was nice to see you both again. Sadly Adora and I should really get going now.”

Scorpia pulls us into a group hug but thankfully this one isn’t as tight. *I wonder how tight her hugs will get after the war?* When we’re eventually released from the hug Adora and I lace our hands together and start to walk towards the exit, only to realize we have no idea where the exit is. Scorpia and Entrapta offer to walks us there. Sparkles and Arrow boy meet us at the steps of Brightmoon, ready to teleport us into the Whispering Woods.

"You ready?" Sparkles asks as she places her hand on mine and Adora's shoulders. I hate this part. Adora responds after I give her a nod to let her know I'm prepared for the nauseous that comes after teleporting.

"Ready."

"*Wait aren't you going to tell us about the plan? What are we going to do about Hordak?"*

Adora stuns a bit when Scorpia mentions Hordak's name. She looks to me and her grip on my hand becomes slightly tighter. I give it a reassuring squeeze and my tail lightly brushes against her leg. I smile lightly at Adora before turning to answer Scorpia and Entrapta.

"Glimmer will fill you in on everything you need to know. With regards to Hordak, you don't need to worry about him. *We've got that covered."*

Chapter End Notes

> Who said dealing with the princesses would be easy? A plan is set and ready to be put in motion, but what does this plan entail? Find out in the final two chapters? Wait two chapters... there's only two chapters left!? 😳😱
>
> I hope you enjoyed reading this chapter. Once again, thank you for all your comments last week. I enjoyed reading them all. Please keep commenting. In the next chapter we get some more fluff and smut action, more fluff and smut that what was in chapter 11 😏. Next chapter is update is on Friday. See you then 😊
>
> P.S - I wanted to ask you all something with regards to TATEOTW prequeal stories. There are six stories which I'll share with you when the fic concludes but one of the stories (about Catra & Adora growing up) has eight individual chapters/parts. Would you rather me to post all chapters

together or post one chapter per day for eight days so you have longer time reading parts in connection to this fic. I'm more in favour of posting a chapter everyday day for eight straight days but the choice is yours. Please let me know.

Promise

Chapter Summary

Adora loves Catra with all her heart.

Catra loves Adora with all heart.

Catra makes a promise to Adora.

Chapter Content: Explicit Sexual Content

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Adora stop it! That tickles."

Adora holds me close against her naked form, my back resting against her breasts. I *'try'* to escape but its no use, she's got a really strong hold on me and refuses to let go despite my protests against her displays of affection.

"Nope. I'm not going to stop showing my girlfriend how much I love her."

Adora leans forward, lightly nipping at the lower end of my ear which she knows drives me crazy. A faint moan of pleasure escapes my lips when she does.

"You've already showed me how much you loved me earlier. But I'm not going to protest if you're up for another round -*That's if you think you can handle me*."

The last few nights have been filled with passion and love. We've both been in need of a distraction from what's to come and what better way to do that than blissfully enjoy the feeling of each other bodies against each other, merging to become one as the

days troubles are forgotten and all that remains in this world is Adora and I.

I turn around in Adora's hold so we're now face to face, chest to chest, heart to heart. Adora's cheeks are bright red. Hers eyes lower to scan my body. I'd be lying if I said I didn't do the same. How can I not, she's stunning, the most beautiful thing in the universe. She could have chosen to love anyone in the eternity of Etheria and yet she chose me.

"*See something you like Adora*? It's nothing you haven't seen before. Didn't think I've ever seen you this flustered."

I'm not even sure it's possible, but Adora's face glows even more red and her smiles becomes even wider. It's hard not to laugh.

"Sorry, I-I didn't me to stare or make you feel…"

I silence Adora with a long, heated kiss. Adora moves to rest on top of me, our naked forms fitting perfectly against each other as if we were made for each other. My arms wrap around her neck. We eventually pull a part but only because we need to breath. My claws strokes through her long blonde hair that she has left loose tonight.

"Adora will you stop being such a *dumb lovable idiot* that you are. You are allowed to stare and look at my body. You didn't in anyway make me feel uncomfortable. If I'm being honest, it actually turns me on a little bit. It makes me feel attractive and sometime… *sexy*. I struggle to see myself the way you do but as long as you keep looking at me the way you do and make me feel things that only you have the power to do, I know that I'm worthy of being loved. For once Adora be selfish and take whatever you want, you deserve it."

My tail impatiently starts to sway between Adora's legs, lightly stroking up the inside of her thigh. Although it's nowhere near where she wants it to be I can sense how turned on she is. Her

body slightly shivers as my claws lightly scratch the back of her neck. *Use your words Adora.*

"What do you want Adora?"

Adora's beautiful blue eyes meet mine. Her hand reaches behind her neck to take mine. She brings it to her lips kissing every fingertip, knuckle and then my palm before she intertwines our hands together.

"I want you."

I reach up, deliberately missing her lips and seductively whispering into Adora's ear… *"Take me then. I'm all yours."*

Adora wastes no time finding my lips, lowering our bodies back against our bed once more. Our kisses are passionate and lustful. My tail wraps around her strong muscular thigh. I part my legs further to allow Adora to completely sink against my body. A gasp escapes me when Adora eagerly thrust her hips against mine. She takes the opportunity to allow her tongue to search for mine.

Adora eventually moves from kissing my lips to sucking at the pulse point on my neck. She knows this make me feral. Adora moans as my claws lightly rake against her muscular back, careful not to cut too deep. It wasn't too long ago that I discovered that this is one of Adora's many kinks. My claws lightly raking across her body, as well as my fangs gently nipping at her sensitive spots located across her body that drive her wild.

Our kisses become more heated and our limbs become more entangled. I can feel how wet I'm becoming down there just from Adora touch. It's crazy how she is able to have this much power over me. Adora moves lower down my body. She kisses the underside of my left breast, gently teasing by taking my nipple between her finger and thumb.

"Adora."

Its comes out more of a whimper than the lustful tone I was aiming for. Adora giggles under her breath, clearly she's enjoying this. Before I'm able to catch my breath she take my whole nipple into her mouth, lightly sucking whilst teasing the other with her free hand.

"Mmm-Adora."

My chest arches into her touch, encouraging her to explore further. One of my hands falls to her hair, pulling her closer to me. My tail loosens it grip and gentle stokes against her sex.

She's as turned on as I feel. As much as I enjoy this, we could do with picking up the pace.

Adora releases me with a loud pop. *"Did you like that?"* She asks in her sexy tone, before kissing my sternum and moving across to my other breast. Before she can continue with her plans, I place my hand against her cheek, a silent request asking her to look at me. Adora listens and moves to gently kiss my lips before rising on her elbows. Her lose hair falls gracefully over her shoulder, her smile never fades.

"Stars, you're beautiful."

"I'll never get used to hearing you say that. It's usually me that says that to you."

"Can't deny what's true." Adora responds and she lowers herself once more kissing my lips cheeks and then kissing under my right ear.

Adora's body starts to rock against me again, my hips rising to meet her gentle thrusts. I become all to aware again that her attention is desperately being called somewhere else.

"*Adora*… a-as much as I love this… *mmh*… do you think we can speed things up a little. *Ah- I need you."*

Adora lightly giggles against the fur on my neck, her warm breath sending a delightful shiver down my spine. I have to rub my legs together slightly to relieve some of the tension.

Star how does she do this to me?

"What do you need?"

"I need you, all of you. Please Adora… *make me feel you*."

Adora lips crash against mine, one of her arms supporting her position over my body whilst the other ever so *painstakingly* slowly makes it way down my body to where I need it most. However, she not close enough for my liking. My arms wrap around Adora's shoulders, lowering her, pulling her as close to me as possible. I need to feel as much of her as possible. It's the only way to relieve this burning desire.

"Adora I'm going to need you to move a little bit faster that."

"Getting impatient are we?" **giggle-snort** "I promise I'll make it worthwhile."

"It's a good job I love you, know that?"

"*Yes, I do.* I love you too."

Adora's hand rests at the dip on my left hip, lightly tracing circle with her thumb. She pecks my cheek, silently asking if she's okay to continue. It's something Adora's always done and I couldn't not love her for it. She makes me feel safe. I slow blink in return, Adora knows exactly what this means, and her hand starts to trail lower almost where I need it most.

"Wow, you're really wet."

"Yeah no shit! Now please shut up and fuck me already!"

Her hand makes contact with my pulsating swollen and wet bud at the top of my entrance. My hips arch to meet Adora's stroked

but she pins me down with the weight of her body on top of mine.

"*Ah-Adora*."

My whole body feel like its on fire, yearning for something that is only just out of reach.

"*Does that feel good? I love how wet you feel. Did you get this worked up just for me?"*

"Ah, all for you, only you… oh!"

Adora hand moves further down towards my entrance, slightly teasing by lightly adding pressure where I need it most before taking it away. It make me want her move. *I need to feel her, I need her…*

"Adora please."

"Please what? Use your word Catra."

"Inside. I want to feel you. Make me cum."

Adora places a gentle kiss to my cheek before moving so we're once again face to face.

"Tell me if you want me to stop or slow down okay?"

I'm only able to nod in response, unable to form any words due to the intense heat building up in my core. I gently pull her lips mine. *I need this, I need to feel her, I want to feel her I'm ready…"Ah!"*

"Are you okay?" Adora asks as she holds my body close to hers. This isn't anything new for either of us but the first stretch still burns a little.

"Yeah I'm fine. Just the initial stretch that's all. You can start to move if you want."

"Are you sure?"

I gently nod in the break of Adora's neck, taking in her scent, allowing her to ground me. My arms wrap around her body tighter as she slowly starts to move. She's gentle at first, slightly picking up in speed as she goes.

"Is this okay?"

"Yes, ah. Faster please."

Adora wastes no time. Her fingers pump faster in and out, curling at the right angle to hit the right places everytime. My eyes shut tight in response to the pleasurable feeling.

"Yes. Ah, Adora… oh… don't stop, please don't stop!"

My body arches upwards against Adora's hold to meet her thrusts. I can feel something building up inside, *something amazing, something that I can't control.*

"*Ah Adora, I-I'm gonna…"*

"Open you're eyes for me Catra. I want you to look at me when I make you cum."

As much as my body tells me to keep them closed, to succumb to the pleasure that's about to take over my body, I meet Adora's command. I open my eye's to find hers staring back into mine. Those beautiful eyes of hers that I fell in love with so long ago look back into mine with the exact same emotions.

"I love you Catra. You're beautiful, stunning, gorgeous, I love that only I get to see you like this. Only I can make you like this. I'm all yours Catra, tell me… are you mine?

"Ah… I love you Adora! I'm yours, I-I've always been yours! Ah, Adora I'm… ADORA!"

My head falls back against the pillow. Fresh warm heat forms down at my core as my climax hits. White stars enter my vision

and my body trembles as Adora works my through the aftershocks.

After a few minutes, my vision starts to become clear again, my breathing starts to calm and my body relaxes even more. I turn to my side to find Adora lying beside me with the smuggest of all grins on her face. Her hand continues to trace lazy patterns up the side of my waist.

"Well, I think you gave me the most intense orgasm of my life."

We both end up falling into a fit of giggles. It's only then that I notice how dry my throat is. *Damn that really was the most intense orgasm I have ever had.*

"Here drink this." Adora says as she hands me a glass of water after helping me to sit up. She places a gentle kiss to my cheek before intertwining our fingers together.

"How you feeling?"

"*Peachy, amazing, wonderful.* That was probably one of the most intense making out sessions that we've gone through. I love you Adora. Give me two minutes and I'll do you."

"You don't need to worry about me. I'm fine."

"Adora, what have we said about putting others before yourself? Besides, I want to make you feel good too."

"Catra, you really don't have to. Making you feeling feel good makes me feel good."

"I know that but there's no harm in showing *my girlfriend* how much I love her."

I place the now empty glass at the side of our bed. I move closer to Adora, moving a strand of her hair behind her eyes so I can see her beautiful features more clearly. My tail playfully bats against her twitching leg muscles.

"What do you want Adora?"

Adora's breath shudders and she faintly shivers under the touch of my palm. Adora is my world, my universe. She can ask anything of me and I'd give it to her.

"I want to feel Catra, you on top of me, making me your. Your mine and I'm yours. I'm forever yours."

"Anything for you."

Our lips meet once again like so many times before. It's almost as if it's become instinctive. I gently lower Adora so her back in now flat against our bed. I can already sense how turned on she is and I know she won't last long judging from the noises she's making and the way she moving her body.

"Catra please… I need you."

Suspicions confirmed.

"Don't worry Adora, I'll make I worthwhile." I chuckle slightly; using her own words against her. She teased me now I can tease her.

I gently nip at her pulse point before lowering myself further down her body to her breast. Her bright pink nipples are erect from pleasure, yearning for my attention. I gently nip at the underside of her breast, marking her there, before wasting no time taking her whole nipple into my mouth. Adora's delicious moans encourage me to suck harder, to tease more, her chest rises to meet my massaging hand. One of her hands scratches behind my ears. My tail excitedly sways behind me. I release her nipple with a pop and kiss my way further south.

Adora's muscles slightly twitch underneath my lips, eagerly anticipating my next move. I gently nip at the dimple on Adora right hip. Her breath hitches ever so slightly, she knows what's coming next.

Or does she?

Rather than giving her the attention she wants, where she needs it, I move even lower placing a series of kisses to the inside of the legs, then swiftly move onto the other. Adora whines when I don't give her the attention she wants, although from this view it's more like her body is begging for it.

"Please Catra, don't make me beg?"

"Me, make you beg? I'd never do such a thing."

I lower myself completely between her legs, lifting them over my shoulders to support her. Her scent fills my lungs and it drives me crazy. *I want her, I want to taste her. I want her now.*

A palm comes to rest on my right cheek. I look up to find Adora smiling down at me. I nuzzle my cheek further into the palm of her hand, enjoying the feeling of her thumb brushing through my fur.

"I love you Catra."

"I love you too. You ready?"

Adora nods and I drive into her delicious scent, taking all that she gives. Adora collapses back against the bed, one of her hands tightens its hold in my mane. I pay special attention to her gorgeously swollen bud, purring as I go, sending vibrations down her core.

"Catra… fuck... Oh don't stop… please don't stop!"

Adora's movement become more erratic, her gasps and moans becoming louder. Her hips buck eagerly to try and meet the strokes of my tongue. I pin her down the best I can by digging my claws into the sensitive parts of her thighs. I can tell she getting close, *I can feel it.*

"C-Catra, Catra… I'm… I'm…"

Yes Adora, just a bit more. I'm ready for you Adora, cum for me!

"CATRA!"

Adora screams my name as her climax hit with full force. My efforts are rewarded with her delicious taste. Her body twitches from the aftershocks but I help her through them. Proud of my accomplishments, I make my way up her body once more, kissing every part of her before I reach her lips once more.

Gently, I brush a few strands of hair out of her face, waiting for her to come down from her peak. Her breathing eventually steadies and her eyes start to open once more. Her hands find their way to my back and she starts to draw lazy patterns through my fur. A low purr emits from my chest.

"Hey Adora."

"You're… you're really good at that."

A faint chuckle leave my lips before Adora draws them together once more. Adora gracefully rolls me off her to her side, our limbs still entangled. I rest my head against her chest, listening to her heartbeat steady once more.I pass her a drink to make sure that her throat isn't sore.

"How you feeling?"

"Lost for words. I can't even begin to tell you how good you make me feel Catra. You're amazing, you're perfect."

My purr becomes louder and my eyes start to become heavy.

"I love you Adora."

"I love you too Catra."

--

I awake to a chill up my back. My hand blindly searches the bed to find Adora but I can't find anything. My eyes immediately open, panic setting in. *What time is it anyway?* I look at the clock that Entrapta made us to find that it only 03:00am.

Where is Adora? What would she be doing at this ridiculous hour?

My eyes scan our quarters, looking for any indication of where Adora may have gone. That's when I notice a folded piece of paper on her pillow. I reach for it and open it…

'Gone to get some air.'

That's when I notice that her pajamas, that were folded on at the side of the bed earlier today, are no longer there. Yet her Horde badge and jacket and still located on desk.

There's only one place she'd be at this unlikely hour.

I get out of bed, shivering a little when the cold night air hits my naked form. *I have fur, I'm never usually this cold.* My pajamas are still at the side of the bed. I decide to put them on rather than faffing around trying to get my uniform on. Once dressed, I grab hold of Adora's jacket and make my way to the one place I know she'll be.

--

It's not hard making my way up to the watch tower. The metal is cold under my hands and feet but it's nothing I can't handle. When I reach the top I find exactly what I came here looking for.

"Thought I'd find you here."

Adora startles a little but relaxes ones she realizes it's me.

“Catra! You scared me.”

“Well this place is called the Fright Zone. Got to live up to its name somehow.”

Adora softly giggles at the statement but then her smile slowly fades and she turns to face away from me, looking over the Fright Zone. I move closer to her, placing her jacket over her shoulders before sitting down next to her, our legs swinging off the platform edge. The space between us, even though it is only very small, is clearly too big for Adora. She opens one end of her jacket inviting me to cuddle up next to her, both of us protected from the cold night chill.

The views of this place haven't changed, they've looked the same for years. We found the watch tower when we were little, we made it our secret spot. We have been coming up here every single day since we found it, sharing stories, having a laugh, occasionally sparring and more recently making out. Up here it feels like we can take on the world. We can share anything and say anything we want.

“What are you doing up here anyway?”

“Did you not read the note?”

“I read the note but I know you Adora. I know when something's bothering you. You know you can tell me if you want to. You don’t have to face whatever is worrying you alone.”

Adora sighs deeply. Her hand blindly searches for mine. When found, our fingers lace together, gripping strongly with one another. Adora has helped me when it comes to showing my true emotions and communicating with her when something is bothering me. It’s about time I return the favor. I don’t push her into saying anything, I know she’ll speak when she’s ready. Adora remains fixated on the horizon, her body slightly trembling.

“I’m scared Catra.”

Adora’s grip on my hand becomes tighter. I know she’ll tell me more in a moment but right now I can sense that she’s trying to calm herself. I rest my head against her shoulder, my tail coming to wrap around her waist. I steady my breathing in hope that Adora will try and match my steady movement. She does and takes a few more deep breathes before continuing…

“I’m scared of what’s to come Catra. With the dawn comes the final stages of our plan, our mission, our only chance to get out of here and live a life we deserve. I'm scared that something will go wrong. I’m scared that everything we have worked so hard for will crumble beneath our feet. But above all, the one thing that scares me most Catra, is the fear of losing you.”

Adora now turns to face me. Her eyes are watery with unshed tears. I open my mouth to say something but Adora shakes her head asking me not to. She has more she wants to say, its better to let her get it all out.

“I don’t want a life without you in it Catra. You are my everything, my world, my home. I don’t think I could go on without you. I know we always said it would be ***you and me together at the end of the world***… well, here we are. I’m scared about what comes next. Catra, with you at my side I can take on anything. I promised you all my life I’d protect you and I’m scared that I’m going to fail, *just like I failed with everyone else.* You’re the only good thing in my life. I can’t lose you Catra.”

Tears start to fall from Adora's eyes. I pull her into a gentle but tight embrace. I move to sit in her lap to hold her better. Adora’s head rests against my chest. With every hiccup I gently stroke through her hair, whispering soft promises, telling her how much I love her. Her tears eventually subside and her breathing steadies once more. Adora's grip around my waist remains strong.

“You are not going to lose me Adora. That is not going to happen! I won’t let it happen. You, me, we’re a team. We’ve come so far

and we’re going to finish what we started. You are not a failure Adora, you’re a hero. *Do you hear me?* A hero! I love you Adora. No matter what happens we will find each other, we always do. It’s like we always said ‘**You, me, together at the end of the world.**’”

Adora loosens her grip on me ever so slightly so she can move to face me better. Using my thumbs, I wipe away the tears from her eyes and rest my forehead against hers. A calm purr emits from my chest and a faint smile appears across her face.

“You Promise?”

“I Promise.”

Chapter End Notes

> I hope you enjoyed reading this chapter. This is only my second time ever writing explicit smut and I wanted to make it passionate and more explicit. I hope it turned out alright. These two really love each other and will take care of each other no matter what. They made a promise to each years ago and they will keep it forever.
>
> Can you believe that there is only one chapter left 😱. I'm sad my fic will be coming to an end but I can't wait to share the finale with you. What do you think will happen?
>
> Thank you for all your kind comments last week. I loved reading them all. Please keep commenting. Also, thank you for helping me decide with the prequel story chapters last week. I will post the link to these stories in the end notes of next weeks chapter. One of the prequel stories will have eight individual chapters with one chapter being published everyday for eight days. The final chapter will be posted at 7pm/19:00BST on Monday. See you then 😊.
>
> P.S - Warning for the final chapter: please, please, please read the tags and make sure your still comfortable reading

this fic - they're all up to date. One of them is a spoiler tag and won't be identified for the stories sake. But I think you can all guess what's coming. See you Monday 😊.

Together at the End of the World

Chapter Summary

Catra and Adora spend the morning cuddling: emotions run high.

The final part of the plan to end the war into action.

Adora and Catra plan to keep their promise - Together at the End of the World.

Chapter/Creator Warnings: Descriptions of Battlefield Scenes, Blood & Injury, (Spoiler in Tags)

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Morning soon arrives. I awake to something, or rather someone, playing with my ears. They twitch everytime Adora's hand scratches from the base of my ear to the tip. It's Adora's light-hearted giggle that encourages me to fully awake.

I look up to find the beautiful blonde watching over me. Her head is propped against her hand whilst the other continues its missions of attempting to make me purr even louder. Adora's baby blue eyes look back at mine. Her beautiful smile radiating the room. Her golden hair loosely hangs over her right shoulder just out of my reach.

"How long have you been watching me?"

Adora's hand stills and her smile slowly fades into a straight line. Her cheeks being to redden. She's clearly embarrassed about something. "

"Not long." Adora responds all too quick with a faint chuckle at the end. She's such a terrible liar, I can read her like an open

book.

My eyes remained fixed on Adora's, a devilish smirk appearing across my lips. My tail slowly sways side to side as I lightly trace patterns across her waist with one of my claws. Adora eventually surrenders…

"Okay. I was watching you for maybe… fifteen minutes… *probably slightly longer than that*."

I try to hold back my laugh but it's no use. Adora's face turns even more red with embarrassment. She should know by now she can't outsmart me. I bury my face against her chest trying to stifle my laughter. Adora attempts to justify her answer, stumbling over her words…

"You-you look so beautiful when you sleep an-and you looked comfortable. I didn't want to disturb you."

I eventually manage to get my laughter under control and move back slightly to face Adora. Her cheeks are burning up with embarrassment, some might even say it's *'Adora-ble'*. My hand moves to brush a few loose strands of hair away from her eyes, before resting my palm on her right cheek, my thumb lightly stoking her cheekbone. Adora's hand covers mine and she leans further into my touch.

"You're such an idiot… *but you're my idiot*."

My lips find Adora's and we fall into our usually morning routine with a series passionate kisses. After last night's, or rather our very early morning 3am conversation, we made our way back to our quarters to get the last remaining hours of sleep under our belts. There's no telling how things will play out today, all we can do is hope for the best. The best being that Adora and I manage to get out of here alive.

Adora's hand gently rakes thought my raised fur on the back of my neck, immediately calming my senses. I hadn't even realized that my fur had stood on end, guess I got a little carried away

with my thoughts. Adora holds me close against her body, her grip is strong. One of her hands lightly tracing patterns through the fur on my back. She places a series of light kisses to the base of my ears. Instinctively, my tail tightness around her calf and my arms wrap around her waist, holding her as close to me as possible. My claws extend ever so slight. They're probably poking holes into her night shirt but I don't care, right now I want to hold Adora as tight as possible and never let her go. I bury my head in the grove of her neck, taking in her scent as I rub my cheeks against her, marking her. It's relaxing for us both, which is what we need right now.

I feel comforted, lost, scared and loved all at the same time. My emotions are on a high. I'm scared of what's to come, *'fear of the unknown'* as they say, but there is no escape from destiny. We both knew today was coming. Now's our chance to make things right, to fight for a life worth living, to fight for a life we've always wanted, the life we deserve.

Adora's body starts to tremble and I can feel her breathing slightly hitching. My eyes start to water and my fur starts to bristle. Our hold on each other becomes stronger, holding on tight to the only thing that matters.

"I love you Adora."

"I love you too Catra."

--

"Do you remember the plan?" I ask. It's important that this plays out as effective as possible if we are going to stand any chance of getting out of here for good.

"We go the Hordak's sanctum, hear what he has to say. Then you'll leave and monitor the cameras. You'll do what you need to

do and I'll do what I need do. We'll sneak out safely and we'll find each other somewhere in the Whispering Woods."

I'll admit, having to rely on our own senses and abilities to find each other after this is all over is not the best idea. However, it's better than getting caught heading to Brightmoon by some guards who have no idea of the fucking plan or accidentally giving away our location to any Horde soldiers only for us brought back to the hell house. We can work out what to do and where to go after all this. Besides, the universe has found ways of getting us back to each other before. It's almost as if the universe is on our side, *wanting us to be together.*

"Good. Remember, we've got this. We're going to be okay… I love you."

Adora pulls me into a passionate kiss before we reluctantly have to pull away… "I love you too. Promise me you'll stay safe. Promise me we'll find each other after this is over."

"I promise. Promise me you'll stay safe too?"

"I…"

Our quarters doors swing open before Adora can finish what she was saying. We jump out of each other's embrace, fear strikes us that someone might have overheard us before this nightmare has even begun. But no one is there.

Why the fuck did that happen? Our quarters doors are always locked.

I peer out to find that all room doors have done the same. Must be an electrical fault.

Relieved, I turn to face Adora once more. Her hand reaches out for mine, fingers interlacing with one another. She gently kisses my hands before placing a final kiss to my forehead. Adora speaks, finishing what she originally wanted to say.

"…I promise."

With that we exit our quarters, acting like nothing happened. It's time to end this war once and for all. It's now or never.

--

Hordak gave his pre-victory speech, promising that…

"Today the enemy will fall and all of Etheria will bow before me. All those who have followed me shall be rewarded…"

I zoned out for the rest of it. I was more concerned about Adora. I had to leave her with that bastard after he gave his final orders to *"prepare for battle!"* There is nothing I can do now to help Adora. Her only defense is her weapon that was specifically created for her. I haven't heard anything from the Rebellion yet. We weren't even guaranteed that these new devices of Entrapta's will work.

It's not a far walk to the control room. I know no one will be there when I arrive anyway. Hordak is certain that the Rebellion have no idea of his *'surprise'* attack so has order all of the Horde soldiers to prepare for battle, even if that means leaving the Fright Zone *defenceless*.

As I predicted, the room is abandoned.

Perfect. Now I just need to figure out how to hack the system to get the hidden camera in Hordak's sanctum activated.

Entrapta installed it before she and Scorpia had to make their getaway, saying it may come in handy one day. Thankfully, I know the one in his sanctum is already wired up. It's just this one that had to be connected. Only problem is I have no idea which wires to move without setting the entire room a blaze.

Fuck sake! How the fuck do they expect you to do something when you have no idea what your doing.

BUZZ, BUZZ

One the Rebels must be psychic as Entrapta's new badge device has started to rumble. I hope it's only mine that the communications has come through on. I hit the badge logo, waiting for some form of communication to come through.

"Catra?"

Thanks stars it's works.

"That's me Sparkles. What do you want?"

"We wanted to let you know we're ready and outside the Fright Zone. Entrapta has been experimenting with electrical surges and has managed to detect one that we think we can use...

Well that explains why our rooms doors opened earlier if she's been faffing about with it.

"We have the area surrounded. Should we attack…"

"NO! NOT YET! We need to wait for Adora to do what she needs to do. Is Entrapta with you? I can't let you in until I hack the system so I can see the camera in Hordak's sanctum."

"Yeah she's here. I'll put her on."

"Hi Catra. What technological problem can I help you with. Also Scorpia says hi."

"Entrapta, I need to know which wires to switch to get access to the camera in Hordak's sanctum."

"Really? That's like the easiest thing to do? Even Emily could do that if she had hands. Oh I wonder if I can create something that will allow her to make modifications to…

“ENTRAPTA! We don’t have much time. Just tell me what I need to do.”

“Oh sorry. There should be a blue and red wire located loosely at the side of the control panel to your right. The blue produces picture and the red produces sound. Be careful not to hit the yellow one next to it. I added that in so it wouldn’t look suspicious to have only two loose wires. If you connect that one to the screens the whole system will explode.”

This is why I need Entrapta. Activating one wrong wire could result in everything could have go wrong. I look around trying to locate them. I find them hanging from the ceiling.

“Got them. Now what?”

“Right, the screen closet to them should have a silver wire already plugged into the middle socket of the screen. Make sure you put the blue wire in above it and the red wire underneath it. It won’t work if they don’t go in that way. You’ll get a static picture if you do it incorrectly.”

Sure enough the screen produces a clear image of what is currently happening in Hordak’s sanctum. Now all we can do is wait.

“Thanks Entrapta. Put Sparkles back on.”

“What’s going on are we ready to attack?”

“Geez calm down Sparkles. I’ve been able to get the cameras working. I’ll call you when we’re ready for you to attack. Be ready.”

With that I end the call and turn my attention to the screens.

--

"Today will go down in history as one of the greatest battles in all of Etheria's history. You, Adora, shall also go down as being one of the Horde's most powerful soldiers."

Not again with the pre-victory speeches. How much longer is he planning on torturing her for.

"Thank you Lord Hordak. It has been an honour to serve beside you."

"Indeed. Not many have been able to make it this far Adora and yet here you are, standing by my side as we conquer Etheria. Here you are ready to complete our most daring mission and yet, you still seeks to protect those you love."

What the fuck is he on about? Adora's body does not move from her current position, even when Hordak rises from his thrown to circle her, trying to come across as intimidating. He better not fucking hurt her!

"I had my suspicions about you and your Second-in-Command after your squadron members mysteriously went missing. However, your 'loyalty' to me made we questions those roots further. Did they mysteriously disappear without you knowing or were they ordered out of the Fright Zone?"

Adora stiffens at the question but makes no move to attack. Now's not the right time.

****BUZZ, BUZZ****

Oh for fuck sake… "WHAT DO YOU WANT SPARKELS!"

"Entrapta has managed to disable all the Horde's machinery from the outside. Something about an electric impulse underground that she's been able to use to our advantage. I think the soldiers are starting to get suspicious. We need to attack now!

"NO SPARKLES! NOT YET! Adora is still with Hordak. We can't do anything until she's safe. Just wait a little longer… *please*."

Although I can't see her, I can imagine Sparkles frustratingly nodding her head in agreement. I choose not to end the call. It might be more beneficial for Sparkles to hear this rather than having me cut her off.

"*You've always been the strongest member of the Horde Adora. At one time you were probably the most loyal. But now it's clear that your loyalties lie elsewhere. They lie with those you seek to protect, more importantly the one you love. Am I wrong?"*

There's no point in denying that Hordak has somehow obtained vital information about us. Now would be the best time to do what must be done but Adora needs a better angle.

"You're right. I was once loyal to the Horde and you're right that I seek to protect those I love. I thought we were bringing peace to Etheria. Instead, I had to face the truth that everything I was told, everything I was taught, was nothing but a lie. I now fight for a better future, a future worth living for, for the people I care about, for the person I love. You will never win!"

Hordak chuckles under his breath and stares Adora down with his evil glare. He's still not in the right position for Adora to strike.

"What's going on?" Sparkles voice mumbles through the communicator.

"You have no idea. You might want to get ready," I respond before turning my attention back to Adora.

"Well unfortunately for you this war will soon be over and someone will stand victorious. That someone will be me. It's a shame you couldn't protect those you love in the end. Everything you did, everything you worked towards, was for nothing."

At that moment Hordak chooses to turn and Adora reaches her dagger that is attached to the side of her leg. Her hand pressed

firmly against the hilts' transformation emblem.

*"You're wrong. Everything I did was **for Etheria** !*

The dagger transforms into a sword. Before Hordak has time to react Adora strikes, stabbing him straight through his back and through his chest. The sword pierces through Hordak's armour as if he was a thin sheet of paper. There is no screaming, only a grunt of pain. I hit that control button that opens the doors access the Fright Zone and the Rebellion launch their final attack. I turn back to the screens to find that Adora has disappeared from Hordak's sanctum. All that remains is her sword and a lifeless body on the cold metal floor.

--

Sirens are going off everywhere. Horde soldiers are actually running away from their posts, unprepared to put up a fight. The Rebellion might actually win this thing. Right now my only priority is to get out of here and head towards the Whispering Woods to find Adora. With any luck I may find her before we even get to the Whispering Woods.

Despite all the chaos happening around me, I suddenly come to a haul. I can't explain why I came this way but something told me I need to come here before I leave for good.

Mine and Adora's quarters? – No

Our secret spot on the watch tower? – No

This place is where it all began… the barracks.

It's empty, which is no surprise, yet this room feels so full of life. There's some sort of pull that guides me towards our old bunk. Who would have guessed that after so many nights of sleeping at

Adora's feet I'd one day be able to hold her, to cherish her, to love her like I do now. It's hard to believe that our old drawings still haven't faded after all these year. Maybe it's a sign. Maybe our drawing hasn't faded because our love for each other never will.

There's a reason I came here. When I came to the Fright Zone I was nothing more than a young, scared Magicat kitten. Adora found me, saved me, gave me a name and a reason to live. All I ever wanted was to one day rule the world with Adora by my side. Now I realize I never needed that, never truly wanted that. All I ever needed, all I wanted, was Adora.

I remove my mask from my head, holding it tight in my grasp. It's full of scratch marks, both old and new. I had it ever since I arrived at the Fright Zone, but now, there is no need for it anymore. I have all I need, all I ever wanted. I place it on our old pillow underneath our drawing. A part of me will always remain here, a reminder that no matter where you are from, no matter what challenges you face in life, you have the ability to forge your own path and love can be found even in the darkest of places.

I exit the barracks, turning to look at my old mask and our drawings one last time before continuing my mission.

--

I don't know how I ended up in this part of the Whispering Woods. It was almost as if I was guided here by something more powerful than any of us. It was almost as if it was… *magic*.

But that's stupid right? Magic only occurs if you happen to be one of those sparkly princesses or some powerful sorceress. There's no wild magic in the entirety of Etheria, or at least I don't think there is.

I have never seen this area of the Whispering Woods before. It's looks and smells all so new. I just hope Adora can find me. I hope she's safe. It's been a while now and I'm starting to get worried.

What if she can't find me? What if she's lost and I can't find her? What if she's been captured by the Horde when she was trying to escape? What if I never see her again? What if…

Rustle

A faint rustling sound comes from one of the nearby bushes. I extend my claws ready to attack. I don't know what's out here. I could have been followed by a Horde soldier, or a defected bot that wasn't disabled during the electrical surge, or a creature that has picked up my scent and wants to make and easy meal out of me or…

"Catra?"

Adora emerges from the bushes, stumbling of her own feet as she tries to regain her balance after tumbling over a bush.

"Adora?"

"CATRA!"

"ADORA!"

We run towards each other and I leap into Adora's waiting arms. If It wasn't for Adora's strength I would have easily knocked us both to the ground. I can't hold back the tears, they start to fall freely. My tail tightly warps around Adora's waist as I slightly move back, bodies still tightly pressed against each other, so that I can hold Adora's face in my hands and clearly see those beautiful blue eyes of hers. Her hair has fallen loose, a smile across her face, tears brimming in her eyes. I pull her into a tender kiss, *then another, then another, then another*. When it becomes evident that we both need to take a break and breathe we return to holding each other even tighter in our arms. I'm certain that my purrs can be heard throughout the Whispering Woods. I never felt

more relieved. She's alive, she’s safe and she’s here held tight in my arms.

“We did it. We won. Catra we Won!”

I lightly giggle through the tears as they slowly start to fade.

“Of course we won! Adora we’re free!”

I kiss her again. I don’t think I’ll ever get tired of feeling her lips against mine.

“How did you even find this place Adora? I was so scared that I’d gone too far and you wouldn’t be able to find me.”

“I don’t exactly know but it was like something guided me here, telling me that I’d find you here. Call it *magic, love, destiny* but whatever it was it brought me here Catra… *it brought me to you*.”

My head rests against Adora’s. My grip on her body never slackening. It’s only when my claw slightly dig into her back that I realize something isn’t right…

“Adora… where’s your jacket?”

“Oh, I urm… *left it at the Fright Zone.”*

I lean back so we’re now directly facing each other. Her smile is still beaming even though I’m very confused as to why she left it behind.

“What!? Adora, that’s your lucky jacket. You never go anywhere without it? Please tell me you’re not going to make us go back and get it?”

Adora starts to giggle, even though I am still very confused as to why she’d leave something so important behind.

“I don’t need it anymore Catra.”

"I-I don't understand? It's your lucky jacket Adora. I've never seen you without it."

Adora pulls me closer to her, re-resting her head against mine. One of her hands gently strokes my back, instantly calming me.

"I don't need it anymore because I have you."

Okay, I'm still very confused.

"I'm going to need you to elaborate a bit more Adora."

Adora giggles once more before continuing…

"Catra do you know why I held onto that jacket for so long and wore it wherever I went? It's because you gave it to me. You gave it to me when I was sixteen, wrapped up neatly with a piece of string. If you remember, the sleeves were a bit too long for me to wear back then but I still wore it. You even added your own personal touches to it, a small rip in my arm sleeves. I wore it because you gave it to me. It reminded me of you. It kept you close to me when we were a part. Wearing it made me feel like I could take on the world. I felt that way because you make me feel like I can take on the world. Wearing it comforted me, calmed me and made me feel love. I feel all of that when I am with you Catra."

An unshed tear escapes from my eyes but Adora's hand reaches to catch it in no time, wiping it away with the gentle brush of the thumb. I lean into her embrace, waiting for her to continue…

"Before I left the Fright Zone for good, I went back to our old barracks, the place where our story began. Being in that room made me realize how far we've come, how hard we fought for this, how hard we fought to be with each other. I saw your mask and that's when I realized that maybe some part of me should remain behind too, because everything I need, everything I ever wanted, is standing right here with me."

A smile creeps across my face, my hand reaches to stroke Adora's cheek. She leans into my palm.

"You're such an idiot…"

"…but I'm *your* idiot."

Once again we find ourselves in a passionate, heartfelt kiss. It's different from all our other kisses. This one feel like freedom, the start of a new beginning. The world around us feels calm and peaceful, as if all is right in the world. If someone had told me many years ago that Adora and I would be free from all things related to the Horde and be able to hold each other, kiss each other and be able to embrace each other like we do now, I would have laughed in their face and probably sent them to the Crimson Waste for good measure. I would never have guessed that my wish to freely live my life with Adora would come true.

"So, what do you want to do know?" I ask as I move to look into Adora's eyes once more. They look back into mine like they always have, only this time they show all of the same emotions as before but now with one more, *hope.*

"I don't know. We could head to Brightmoon as their offer still stands but if you want to find somewhere else to go, I'm okay with that. I have however been having weird dreams about this glowing object and some unusual voice asking if I'll fight ***'For the Honour of Greyskull'*.** Weird isn't it? I don't even know anyone call Greyskull. *Think we should go and find what my weird dream is on about?*"

We both end up laughing. Adora and her strange dreams. Better than having nightmares though. Guess I better add this dream to the '*mission list.'*

"Honestly Catra, I don't care where we go or what we do as long as I'm with you."

"I love you, you know that?"

“Yeah I know… I love you too.”

Adora slowly walks away from me, one of her hands still laced with mine.

“Now what do you say we do this, *together*, like we always promised.”

Adora, *my world, the love of my life, my soulmate, my entire universe,* stands before me ready to official start our future together. There’s no doubt that our future will be full of highs and lows, but as long as I’m with her *I’m home, I am safe and I am loved.* I will follow her to the end of the world. There are new memories and new promises awaiting to be made.

“Together at the End of the World.”

Chapter End Notes

> There you have it. Together at the End of the World has come to an end. I can't thank you all enough for liking, following and commenting on my fic throughout this incredible journey. I have enjoyed sharing every moment of this fic with you. Please let me know what you thought of my fic. I really hoped you enjoy it. Thank you for being amazing readers.
>
> Here is the link to the prequel stories as promised:
> https://archiveofourown.org/series/2445907
> Part 2 of the series titled You & Me, will be updated every day till it concludes. That fic explores Catra and Adora key moments growing up in the Horde leading up the start of Together at the End of the World. Hope you enjoy.
>
> I do have plans for future fics but I'm not sure when they'll be up. Please keep an out out for my fics and hopefully I'll see you again in the near future.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!